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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, May 21, 2025

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pG2zNSgOZAo
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-22. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:07:24] Morning. It is 9.04 a.m. according to my phone here. I will now call this meeting to order. I'll note that I've approved the remote participation of Mr. Hanson and Ms. Ashton under the board's bylaws and 2.2-3708.3 B3 of the Code of Virginia because their principal residences are more than 60 miles from the meeting location. Before we begin this morning and get too far into things, I would like to introduce everyone to our newest board member.

[00:07:54] Dr. Beth Ackerman is the newest board member of the Board of Education. I will provide a more formal introduction tomorrow of Dr. Ackerman, but I wanted to be sure and introduce her now so that the public is aware of our newest member. I would also like to take a moment to acknowledge Reynolds Community College for their continued kindness and being wonderful hosts here for us to be meeting in this location this morning we are delighted to welcome Dr. Paula Pando the president

[00:08:30] of Reynolds Community College who is here with us to just introduce us to the area to the room to the building and for us to be able to provide just the thank you from the depths of our hearts for having us here for taking us as nomads into your building and just give you an opportunity to say a few few words this morning wonderful thank you i just wish we could have brought some sunshine for you today

welcome to reynolds community college welcome to all who are are tuning in to this meeting i will say less about the building and more about and when i say more i mean one

[00:09:09] minute about this uniquely American invention that is the community college like jazz apple pie and baseball we are uniquely American created on the principle that everyone gets a shot at the middle class whether it be through the transfer and saving families tens of thousands of dollars to achieve a the baccalaureate and beyond, or whether it's going directly into the workforce.

[00:09:40] Think of your nurses, your teachers. Think of your welders and electricians and skilled trades persons. This is the talent that we develop, and we are hyper-local in our mission. Reynolds serves the greater Richmond region, and that is the city of Richmond and the counties of Goochland, Hanover, Henrico, Powhatan, and Louisa counties educating 15,000 students every year.

[00:10:09] We're incredibly proud of the space that we hold in American higher education. More necessary now than perhaps it's ever been because we know that not having a post-secondary credential, note that I did not say a baccalaureate degree, a post-secondary credential, not having one in hand, is fast track to life in poverty.

[00:10:34] Simply speaking, you need a credential to get a job that pays a living wage. And we're very proud of holding a prominent space in higher education with that very clear mission in mind. We're incredibly happy to host all of you here today and wish you all a great meeting where we collectively solve some of our most pervasive problems.

[00:10:58] and I believe that at the core of every solution begins with education. Thank you all so much. Have a wonderful meeting. We're so happy to host you. Thank you, Dr. Pando. We appreciate it. Superintendent Gullickson, do you have any opening comments this morning? Dr. Northern, would you read our motion to go into closed session, please, so we can consider our licensure cases. I move that the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the following purposes. Discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the

[00:11:37] denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion in subdivision 11 of section 2.2-3705.3 pursuant to section 2.2-3711A40 of the Code of Virginia and consultation with counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice pursuant to Virginia Code section 2.23711A8 of the Code of Virginia and that legal counsel to the Virginia Board of Education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration

[00:12:11] of this matter participate in the closed meeting. Is there a second? Ms. Kilgore? Yes. Dr. Northern? Aye. Dr. Ackerman? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Is she on?

[00:12:36] Okay, never mind. Ms. Holton? And Chair votes aye. All right, we are now in closed session.

[00:27:42] Suant to a recorded vote on the motion above, and in accordance with the Freedom of Information Act,

[00:50:14] Section 2.2-3712, the Code of Virginia requires that the Board certify that, to the best of each member's knowledge, one, only business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter, and two, only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened, were heard, discussed, or considered.

[00:50:36] Any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote, indicating the substance of the departure that, in his or her judgment, has taken place. The statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes. Okay. Ms. Kilgore.

[00:50:53] Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Dr. Ackerman. Aye. Mr. Hanson. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Ms. Holton. I then chair votes aye okay um so we will move on the two cases that we heard in the case 2025-14 um I will entertain a motion to revoke the license of Gloria Jean Jackson so moved second

[00:51:28] um uh Ms. Kilgore ah Dr. Northern aye Ms. McPherson yeah she did Ms. Holton aye

[00:51:46] Mr. Hanson? Aye. Dr. Ackerman? Aye. And Chair votes aye. Okay. In the case numbered 2025-13, I'll entertain a motion to deny the license of Charles L. Davis. So moved. Take it. Okay. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Dr. Ackerman? Aye. And Chair votes aye.

[00:52:30] okay um we will take about a five minute break to get our um work session powerpoint presentations

[00:52:43] in line and then we will proceed in about five minutes thank you are going to return to our work

[01:03:24] session we have everybody loaded and ready i think um and so first thing this morning is item a ela and vla updates dr wallace good morning president creasy members of the board and Superintendent Gullickson. We are excited to present to you updates today on how ELA English implementation has been going this year, as well as how our Virginia Literacy Act implementation has been going this year, and finish up with what our plans are for next year to support our schools

[01:04:00] and our teachers and our students. So today I'm excited to introduce the leader at the state on this work who is miss jill negaris jill is here with dr emily salari the leader at uva with the virginia literacy act so there will be some co-presenting midway jill is going to kick us off with the english updates she and her team have been working to really get resources out to the field to support the implementation and have lots planned to to provide some supports upcoming to

[01:04:34] the field so jill thank you all right thank you good morning president creasy superintendent gullickson and members of the board as stated my name is jill no garis and i serve as the associate director of k-12 english and literacy here at the virginia department i am one member though of a team of six and you need to know that i have a phenomenal team of literacy experts who are supporting students k-12 here in the commonwealth so please know that this is everyone's work represented here and also the collaboration and work of many offices across the agency working

[01:05:11] together to improve literacy outcomes for our students. So just to give you a quick overview, we are going to break this into two kind of different buckets. We have our English language arts standards implementation and what's happened since you approved the standards in March of 2024 and then how that also works with the Virginia Literacy Act and updates on our first year of implementation for the Virginia Literacy Act. They are two separate things but they are pieces that are working together to support students K-12 and really birth to K-12 if you're thinking about

[01:05:50] the Virginia Literacy Act in our VKRP and everything that we are doing to support students with kindergarten readiness and then expanding Virginia Literacy Act up through eighth grade as we

move into the 25-26 school year. So we're going to start with English Language Arts and look at resource development, what has been created since you approved those standards last March, what resources are available for educators, division level leaders, superintendents, principals, how we are maximizing funding to support student literacy and that's where you're going to see a lot of overlap with other offices and other grants and other work happening within the agency to support

[01:06:28] literacy. We're going to show you some of the communication to the field. We've had a lot of communication to the field. So we just kind of have it in buckets based on what was looking at ELA and then what is looking at the Virginia Literacy Act. So we have those broken down and then different collaborations that we have with different offices and ongoing work.

[01:06:48] Then we'll get into the Virginia Literacy Act. We'll give some of the updates from the department side of things and the work that the department is managing. And then I'll invite Dr. Solari up to tell you about all the fabulous work that her team at VLP is doing to support k-12 literacy and make impacts and improvements for all students in the commonwealth and how that implementation is going updates on training and data and everything else and then i'll kind of come back to close things out and talk about what our plans are for the 25-26 school year and answer any questions that you may have just wanted to start off very quickly and show you that the

[01:07:28] english and literacy program here at the virginia department of education really does align to Virginia strategic priorities and really looking at priority number one, which is to set and help every learner meet high expectations. And I hope that you see that through all of the examples that we provide today. All right, so kicking us off with English. You have to make your head split in two for a little bit. So this is a timeline of events and supports that have happened since we were together last March. March in 2024, this board adopted and approved the 2024 English Standards

[01:08:05] of learning. And while I can see that the font is incredibly tiny, I hope that you're able to see it where you are at your seats. But this just kind of gives a very brief overview of a lot of the pieces that I'm going to be talking about this morning. So we approved the standards in March. We used the spring to create resources and webinar supports for our teachers and educators as they planned for the 24-25 year, which is our first year of implementation. We talked about overview of revisions. We provided a crosswalk so that educators could understand the changes and the shifts that we were making in rigor to

[01:08:43] support student success. We provided understanding the standards documents to support teachers who really needed to understand what we meant about each of the standards and the increase in rigor and what the grade level expectations were for each of those standards, but also to support teachers who might be new to a grade level they're supporting or possibly a provisionally licensed teacher or a building sub who is supporting kids this year. So we wanted to make sure that we got those out immediately to make sure our teachers were prepared to start teaching those standards.

[01:09:18] We also provided a comparison guide of the 2026 NAEP reading framework and alongside the 2024 English standards of learning so that teachers could see where there was alignment and what additional shifts might need to occur or where you are seeing those robust ties as we prepare for the 2026 NAEP. In the summer we hosted regional and literacy and math symposiums which we'll get into later so I'm just going to do a quick overview here. We started the secondary textbook adoption process and we supported our colleagues in the Office of Assessment with their item review

[01:09:53] committees last summer. Later in the summer we worked on instructional guides. We piloted those and got feedback across the state to kind of support what teachers needed, what they were still thinking they needed, what components were necessary to support implementation. We worked with the Virginia Association of Teachers of English to kind of support English supervisors and then provide general supports. And in the fall we've wrapped up the textbook process and we did some virtual support through Virtual Virginia and offering support at the elementary and

[01:10:28] secondary level. In the winter, we were able to launch our instructional guides and provide webinars to support that. And then we started work on the Virginia Essentialized Standards of Learning with our colleagues in the Office of Assessment to support the students who take that VAP assessment. And then this spring, we really honed in on the developing skilled readers and and Building Reading Stamina strand that we talked about last winter when we looked at Virginia's anchored approach and talked about learning how to read fluently and build background knowledge and vocabulary and how that would look in a classroom.

[01:11:08] And then we also worked with our partners at TNTP to create a walkthrough tool that we'll get into a little bit later to support building principals and instructional leaders as they are supporting literacy instruction in the commonwealth. And then, of course, we also supported our MOU school divisions with walkthroughs and supports and meetings as necessary.

[01:11:30] So that kind of gives you a very high-level timeline, which the next few slides will kind of break down a little bit more. I'm not going to read them all to you, but I just wanted you to have the information. All right. So thinking about resource development, all of these resources are publicly available on the 2024 Standards of Learning for English webpage.

[01:11:51] As I said, we have the Understanding the Standards document that really gets at what each of the standards mean, the depth that you need to get at, what students need to understand, and how teachers might instructionally approach those things. We also provided grade level side-by-sides to support our teachers.

[01:12:09] A lot of times, teachers go and they look at the grade level they're responsible for, but we think it's incredibly important for teachers to see where their students are coming from and where they're going next, because they have students in each of those situations sitting in their classrooms, and we wanna make sure that they're getting the supports available.

[01:12:27] So we made these side-by-sides and in grade band, even spreading elementary to middle, so that four to sixth grade band, and then that middle to high, the seventh through ninth grade. So they can see at the both middle and high school level, what students were learning at each of their feeder patterns and where they can expect students to be when they get at their schools.

[01:12:48] We also created progression charts to show the vertical progression for each of the 10 strands that we have in the English Standards of Learning. And then of course, we spent a lot of time on our instructional guides. Those were released in February. So they are in use right now in schools and they are set up to include the progression charts and the vertical alignment and teacher notes.

[01:13:13] So that is a piece that was very welcome in the old curriculum frameworks where the teacher notes about how to approach things. So that is a component we wanted to keep in the instructional guides

to support educators as they're kind of working through their instructional guides and the instructional goals for their students.

[01:13:33] It also has the standards, the understanding the standards. And then it has a whole piece that focuses on planning for instruction and integration and how you support the implementation of your HQIM in K-5 and how you fold in those other standards to make sure students are getting what they need.

[01:13:50] We've also included disciplinary connections so that at every grade level you are seeing how to bring in history and science into your classroom and looking at suggested or not recommended, but certainly sample text lists and text sets that could be used that kind of give you an idea of what's an appropriate grade level text for that grade level that aligns with the content of science and social studies and provides those text sets so that teachers can see what's the appropriate level of rigor for those grade level texts, but also how can we support building background knowledge and knowledge building in English class

[01:14:28] by utilizing those content area texts. All right, we do have a recorded overview of the standards webinar series that's posted on our site. When we hosted them live, we did have 542 educators who attended. And we recorded these and we posted them along with the scripted decks so that if you didn't want to watch our recording you could read it instead of reading the morning paper. There we go. We've also created that developing skilled readers and building reading stamina webinar series. This to us is very exciting because it really gets at all of

[01:15:08] the essentials of students learning how to read and looking at reading fluency and looking at text evidence and looking at a variety of genres and how to infer and it really gets at how to really get deep into a topic to kind of support and anchor all of the literacy learning that's happening in your classroom.

[01:15:28] And we had 840 teachers in attendance for those webinars. We did also include a feedback form that was helping to guide our next steps so that teachers could let us know what questions they still had after the series was over, what resources would support them as they're kind of getting to the 25-26 year, and what supports were necessary as we move on.

[01:15:50] So, the webinars were recorded and the scripted slide decks are posted, and we hope to get those recordings out soon. But we did have 120 educators provide feedback after those that really are helping us drive you're going to see at the end of our slide deck today in terms of where we're going next for resource and support development. You all recall that we were here last winter to approve our secondary textbooks so in the fall at the October meeting actually you looked at them for first

[01:16:25] review and at the December meeting we approved the secondary textbooks for English language arts so that is just a nod to the work that many of you are aware that we have done here but all of those correlation charts and results are posted for school divisions to look and consider what they want to adopt as they're thinking about secondary reading and writing in grades 6 through 12. the next slide is our walkthrough tool that we have worked on there are two there is one that gets that foundational reading and foundational writing skills that's available for k-3 and then there's a k-12 reading comprehension walkthrough tool and this can be used to support building

[01:17:05] level leaders, literacy coaches, division level leaders if they're walking through classrooms as to what you should be seeing if you're using high quality instructional materials and what instructional shifts should be occurring within your classroom.

[01:17:20] So it is a rather comprehensive tool. You probably wouldn't see all of that ever in a walk through for real. But you could take a piece or a section of that if you are exploring things. It is being piloted right now by TNTP as part of the Comprehensive Literacy Network.

[01:17:38] I can say that the English Office has also used it during our visits with MOU school divisions and to guide conversations with those. And we do plan to have a full statewide rollout in the fall and we will provide supports and webinars and guidance for division and school level leaders.

[01:17:55] So once those, since we're still in the pilot phase, it is not posted, but once we're ready to roll out statewide this fall. All of those resources will be posted and we will be supporting all school divisions as they learn how they can use these walkthrough tools to look at instruction in their classroom. So that kind of handles resource development since we were here in March 2024. We've spent a lot of this year looking at how to maximize funding to support literacy in the state and this is where we start really collaborating with many offices across the

[01:18:29] agency because this has been an agency priority to support literacy here in the Commonwealth. You are very well aware that the governor had All In Virginia, which provided $418 million to support student achievement and tutoring and combating chronic absenteeism and supporting the Virginia Literacy Act and learning loss.

[01:18:52] So that funding provided a lot of supports and materials that school divisions could requests and use to support students who needed these additional potential tutorings and all things necessary. So in the English office, we really look at our use of Lexia and Ignite. So those are the tutoring opportunities that are available here. So the English office has worked with Lexia and meets with Lexia weekly to make sure that our statewide initiative is supporting students and that students are seeing gains we are in a strange spot in that it

[01:19:30] is May so we don't have end-of-year reports for you quite yet so that is something we could certainly explore at a future meeting but it is something that we are constantly talking about so it does provide science of reading based literacy solutions for kids in grades K-12 and it's an adaptive blended learning model which means the students have asynchronous online personalized program and then the teachers have resources for face-to-face instruction to support those students. So we participate in an ongoing collaboration with Lexia through the weekly meetings with the team. We've also done school

[01:20:09] site visits to observe power-up in multiple middle and high schools to kind of see how that's going. Additionally we do have several school divisions and many students using Ignite Reading, and that is a one-to-one online science of reading-based tutoring that closes students decoding gaps through 15-minute daily lessons.

[01:20:30] So we do participate, again, in ongoing collaboration with them through weekly meetings, but then also have done site visits to observe Ignite in action. And again, we're getting close to that end of school year where we can really pull those reports, but we will be exploring how that is impacted and how everything kind of correlates to student success and how students are improving, not only through Ignite and Lexia, but how that aligns with what's happening with their VAL scores and potentially their SOL scores as well.

[01:21:00] But that is ongoing, so that's a stay tuned and we will come back if you decide you want us to. Okay, the other piece that you might be aware of is in September, there was a press release announcing a

$30 million grant that was given to the Virginia Department of Education from USED for the Comprehensive Literacy State Development Network.

[01:21:23] So there was information in that press release that shared that we were going to be supporting underserved populations with this. So we do have three different networks going on, there it goes, to support our students.

[01:21:40] So we are currently in year one. So we are just in year one of a five-year grant. but it has developed three networks that are using the funding in year one and the english team does provide programmatic support for those three networks we have just right readers which has 30 schools which funds just right reader decodable books that school divisions are able to purchase schools are able to purchase for those students we have a students with disabilities learning network that 30 schools are participating in and you know we have worked with them on the

[01:22:18] english standards of learning but also looking at how that works with student reading plans and ieps and supporting students with disabilities and then we have an english learner learning network that's really looking at supporting our el students and their literacy development as well So again, we are still looking at the evaluation of the effectiveness of all these 90 schools that are part of this grant just are wrapping up their mid-year progress monitoring meetings right now.

[01:22:48] We will have an end-of-year progress, end-of-year, end-of-year-one evaluation in August, and that's when we will be able to actually evaluate the effectiveness, demand, and student outcomes kind of tied to those grants. so this is year one so we will be looking at year two and who we are supporting kind of moving forward school divisions will and schools will have the opportunity to reapply for those grants if they are interested and we can hopefully encourage additional schools to participate as well so that is also upcoming information and i would be remiss if i did not say that angela dr

[01:23:25] angela birdwright is spearheading this work so hopefully she can give you a far more comprehensive overview once we get to the end of year one additionally we have another grant that we work on with the office of esea programs to support elementary school literacy implementation so this is um available to 20 title one elementary schools across 16 divisions and these schools were invited to attend the national institute for excellence in teaching summer institute last summer along with members of the virginia department of education

[01:24:03] and then school teams had two days of follow-up training for teachers at their school about how to implement high quality instructional materials and support for the virginia literacy act and so the school secured follow-up training from those professional development vendors or a vendor of their choice from that grant to kind of support implementation of high quality instructional materials in elementary school so the english team members of the english team have met with each school virtually and one-on-one in february this year to kind of celebrate grant successes

[01:24:38] where things were going and brainstorm any solutions to challenges that they were facing as they started their year one implementation of hqim and again that is still wrapping up so we're not quite at the we might be one month too early to give you updates on this so please know though that that is ongoing work of the department and that really is collaboration across multiple office is here to support then oh wow that jumped like five slides hold on you're probably like good

[01:25:11] oh okay and now just jump back seven all right once i get to it the next one is really just a bunch of links that's just for you to have i know we have many many virginia education update articles but these are the ones that align with english language arts specifically so you don't have to scroll through a whole year all right that's really just a placeholder for you but kind of looks at what has happened since you approved the standards in March, and then all the way through to where we are for funding for Ignite, Lexia, and Zern for the 25-26 academic year.

[01:25:45] So, if you are just so excited and want to learn more on Saturday morning, feel free to flip to the slide and check out all of those. As referenced in the timeline, we did also host summer symposiums in collaboration with our math team, which is really, really exciting.

[01:26:03] It's very rare that you see English and math out together. We are best friends, we're just not often together in the field. And this was an opportunity to bring both of these groups together. We hosted eight regional symposiums across each of the superintendent's regions.

[01:26:20] And so it was really exciting. We partnered with TNTP and were able to provide information on the new English standards of learning and then HQIM implementation as they prepared for year one of VLA. We did also collect feedback and that data was used to kind of help us figure out what supports were needed and whether those needed to be virtual, in-person, phone calls, whatever the case may be.

[01:26:45] But it was a train-the-trainer model and the expectation was that each educator, each school division that was represented there would go back and share their learning with their school divisions. The information also was posted on Canvas so that they could have access to all of the resources.

[01:27:02] We also, I might have even seen a couple of you there, got to hang out at the Virginia Association of Secondary School Principals last summer and present a round table. And so really it was just a 15 minute rotation where secondary school principals could come, they could learn about the new resources, hear about what the implementation was going to be, ask any questions related to questions that might come up about either the new standards or what implementation of VLA grades four through eight might look like.

[01:27:36] So it was exciting to have the opportunity to connect and talk with them, but also to hear what kind of questions they have and what kind of guidance and support we could offer as a result of their wonderings. Additionally, we supported, the English office supported other external groups and external partners over the last year to make sure that everyone had the support that they needed.

[01:28:01] We did do a professional development one day with the 21st century grant coordinators, and that was through the Office of ESEA Programs. Well, I'll just, there it goes. So we presented to them, there were about 150 coordinators present there for that.

[01:28:20] But it really gave them an understanding of how developing oral language was essential to both language comp and reading proficiency. We gave them an overview of the 2024 English standards of learning and looked specifically at that communication strand and how they could support students through their 21st Century Coordinator Grant.

[01:28:41] This is really through the Office of ESEA Programs. So that was us supporting them in that one. We also got to hop on the Virginia Alternative Learning Technology Vital Conference, which is a really cool multiple day conference. I know our contact for it is Calypso Gilstrap.

[01:28:58] I don't know who actually oversees it in totality. it might be Calypso, I'm not sure. But we were really excited to present an overview of the standards at that conference and then work with teams and let them know kind of what was going on in English and just kind of support them through kind of an overwhelming bunch of resources that we have and kind of walk them through what each one means and how it works.

[01:29:22] We also have a partnership through the School University Resource Network at William & Mary. So this is the CERN conference that happens and we had two opportunities to present with them. So it was a mixed audience of administrators and teachers at the fall conference, and that one was on the English standards of learning, and there were approximately 80 educators in attendance.

[01:29:45] And then in spring, a conference was hosted in Fredericksburg, again, to administrators and teachers, and that was on the standards of learning. Again, additionally, 80 more. It was in a different location, so we kind of captured a different audience there.

[01:30:01] Additionally, we did have the opportunity to work with the Virginia Association of Teachers of English, which is our secondary state organization, and supported them in the fall. They offer a convening for all division English literacy coordinators or supervisors where they can get together just as a group themselves.

[01:30:22] So we were able to support and talk to them about the 2024 English Standards of Learning. We got feedback on the instructional guides. They were able to ask a lot of questions. And then we did also do a more general session with anybody who attended their fall conference so that they could learn about the shifts in instruction and practices aligned with the 2024 English Standards of Learning.

[01:30:46] And then we also worked with our elementary partners, which is the Virginia State Literacy Association. And in March, several of us went to Roanoke to present an overview of the standards. There were about 100 educators and literacy leaders at that conference as well.

[01:31:05] And we're very excited to say that we were able to connect with and support several of our MOU divisions. We were able to do in-person walkthroughs in March and April this spring, which we're really excited. And then we had individualized feedback reports with best practices, next steps.

[01:31:24] We looked at the walkthrough tool. We supported them with upcoming planning and instruction, had conversations about how they are approaching instruction next year and what supports and specific supports they might need from our office. And then moving into June, we already have some division level supports in place for several of the MOU divisions to kind of work with their whole central office teams to support an understanding of evidence-based literacy instruction and English standards of learning. And then follow-up

[01:31:58] at the end of the summer once their literacy leaders are back and grade level leaders are back and working with new teachers. We're very excited about that. Additionally, we support our office of assessment ongoing. So last summer we were with them as educators looked at the item review committee meetings that happened last July. And at the final day of each of those committees, we were able to present on the English Standards of Learning, talk to them about the instructional guides, talk to them about upcoming supports they might need, and really help them understand

[01:32:36] the shifts in rigor from the 2017 to the 2024 English Standards of Learning and how you might see that addressed in an item review. Wow, did it again. Okay, let me go right past your part, Dr. Solari, by

accident.

[01:32:55] Okay, and we are ongoing. We are working with our Office of Assessment and the University of Oregon on the Virginia Essentialized Standards of Learning. That is the V-SOL that we have here. And those are revised academic content standards for students with significant cognitive disabilities who are enrolled in grades three through eight in high school in Virginia.

[01:33:19] So these are students who traditionally take the VAP assessment and looking at what the standards need to be to align as closely to the 2024 English standards of learning as possible. So we worked with the Office of Assessment and the Behavioral Research and Teaching Program at the University of Oregon, along with our Office of Special Populations and our mathematics team to look at reading and math teacher committees so that we could have experts in the field and educators support this work.

[01:33:51] We had six members on each committee. We also worked with our TTAC just to make sure that everybody was kind of looking at those approaches and where we plan to take the Virginia Essentialized Standards of Learning. That work is still ongoing. It is not complete, but we're very excited that we had the opportunity to kind of bring all of those groups together.

[01:34:11] And then, of course, in support of the instructional guides and instructional guide development in other content areas, you'll see if you look at the instructional guides for fine arts and computer science, you will also see the English standards of learning addressed within those as well. So thinking about those cross-content connections of the standards in other instructional guides. We also hosted webinars with the coordinator of multilingual learner instruction and we've worked with Virtual Virginia to make sure that there are elementary and secondary support sessions that are going. So this is the part of the

[01:34:49] presentation where now you need to switch your brain over to Virginia Literacy Act, which all comes together to support and work together to support student literacy. I'm going to start this part of the presentation just to kind of give you an idea of the parts that the department has been supporting of the Virginia Literacy Act. And then it'll switch over to, are you sure? Okay, I was gonna say, and then we're going to switch it over to Dr. Emily Solari, who is going to share everything that VLP has been doing in this first year of implementation. Before we move on, if we could just address any questions on the first

[01:35:27] part of, or comments on the first part of this presentation that might, that board members might have. Does anyone have any questions or comments here? Ms. Houlton. Thank you, Dr. Nogueira. Very helpful presentation. You all are very busy. Am I right in understanding that we are really not just on the Literacy Act, but on all of ELA in year one of a couple years of transition

[01:36:00] into the new ELA standards, right? We're not expecting, it's not all done yet. Well, yes, it is done. It is done. So that is why we made sure that we got right into resources and support to make sure that educators would have the overview of revisions and understanding the standards and the instructional guide. I guess I'm not expressing myself very well here.

[01:36:29] I'll try again. Obviously, yes, the new standards, ELA standards were in full effect this year, but new textbooks won't likely be out in the school divisions until next year. The instructional guides came out mid-year, so we would not expect to see the full impact of the new standards in our sols for this year yet in other words our we would hope

[01:37:00] that it would be an ongoing process for teachers fully working based on the new standards so um just a provider with some additional support here um so students teachers began teaching those standards this year yes we do plan to do updates to the instructional guide so they'll be kind of done on an annual basis and we'll continue to review with with stakeholder feedback in particular from some of our sessions that are upcoming um this summer that you know what supports do teachers

[01:37:36] continue to need so those instructional guides would be updated um textbooks as you know this board has adopted them we also have the new hqim bill that's going to set us on a new path of adoption of additional instructional materials so that might be what helps to address your question we have textbooks adopted already. They were adopted in December, but then HQIM will be adopted.

[01:38:00] But if I'm right, our action adopting textbooks begins the process of the divisions adopting textbooks, so it's unlikely that the textbooks that we approved in December are in the classrooms already. Probably not, but I do know that boards are adopting them. They'll be in effect for next school year. I have seen that they have been, school boards across the state have been adopting textbooks. I know that's a little fact about me, guys. Absolutely. They're moving forward. Hopefully

[01:38:35] many of them will have new textbooks in place by fall. By the fall, yes. But they didn't this past fall. Likely not. Not from the new list. And then the instructional guides, I appreciate hearing that going to update them every year that's terrific but the the initials instructional guides for the 2024 ela standards initially came out in february of 25 in other words midway through this school year so so there's lots of reasons to hope that uh teachers will be even more fully equipped to

[01:39:12] teach to the ela standards starting in fall the the 2024 ela standards starting in the fall of 25. plus um jill will update you on some additional training opportunities that will be coming for those teachers too and and then i just had one other question i'm sorry madam president may i continue uh uh the uh as we all know the all-in funding was one-time funding it's ending or has in some divisions has ended in some divisions maybe they've still got i'm not sure um uh and

[01:39:48] you also referenced a number of grants, etc. Should we worry about any of the funding or any of those resources that you're providing, whether it's going to be available ongoing? So the all-in funding, you're correct. Divisions were up fronted that money in 2023, and so they have until 2026, June of 2026, to spend those funds. Some divisions may have spent those funds right out the gate and spent all of them within the first year year and a half some of them i know still have funding because they i get the questions on what can we do to to help support

[01:40:27] our or to implement those grants um and so some divisions are planning to continue having those funds through june of 2026 where it will they will all expire at that time additionally the funding that we have to provide the tutoring supports that jill talked about um those funds we were just granted an appeal from uscd to continue those supports for one more year so we had not anticipated on being able to support those tutoring programs this year but we were able to successfully have an appeal through uscd to be able to use our late liquidation esser funds to

[01:41:07] fund those three programs through the end of next school year so those those are federal dollars that support that implementation. So terrific, as I understand it, the supports that we've talked about, the tutoring supports, et cetera, that have been so important, are going to be available for one more year. Thereafter, it's a question mark. Thank you. Superintendent Gellickson. Thank you, President Creasy and Member Houlton. Also wanted to flag the CLSD grants are five years, right?

[01:41:44] yes the clsd grant is a five-year grant and at this moment uscd has told us that that funding is stable at this moment and so like jill said we are planning with the second year implementation hopefully all of our first year schools will reapply for funds but because we're moving into the second year we kind of have more funds the first year you only have about half of your funds to spend the second year you'll have more funds so we should be able to fund more schools to support literacy implementation efforts across the commonwealth other questions miss mcfeerson

[01:42:24] are the 90 schools participating with the clsd grants is there a link on the website for which schools they are yes ma'am there's a press release that has um i'm september 20th okay yeah all right i think there's an additional press release dr northern my ears perked um when i heard about the text sets and the content-based approach i'm trying to figure out where that information is among these resources in the instructional guides in each grade level as you're looking at each of

[01:43:02] the strands it gives a sample text set that would align with the standards that are discussed in that integration and implementation section and then cross content connections with history and science for elementary because we know that our elementary schools have hqim that they are using so we really talked about bringing in text sets that really align with history and science so that we weren't interfering with obviously the use of high quality instructional materials in core literacy instruction so how to bring those in a cross-disciplinary dr northern we'll take a look i just um there's actually believe it or not a national organization

[01:43:42] that's developing new ela standards and they're prioritizing that approach so i just wanted to make sure that I knew how we had integrated that as they developed this other set thank you other questions or comments I have a few okay I just wanted to wait for everyone so first question on the webinar series that you talked about on slide nine do we have any means by which we're tracking how those webinars are being accessed like so how many people outside of the the numbers that you

[01:44:15] have are we are we checking data to know you know is it just sitting there or is it being used so the numbers that i gave you were for when we were utilizing zoom so that's who was there in in person that day um but our comms team does have the ability to pull the youtube links and kind of look and see how many how popular we are okay good that's what i wanted to know um the other thing was i just have a question about um slide 15 and 16 where you talked about lexia and ignite

[01:44:49] um why help me understand why uh 29 only 29 school divisions are using ignite and we've got so many uh using lexia so that might lend one to think one system is more successful than the other and that being said since we're providing this i assume the department is providing this at no cost to the school division is there a means by which we can talk about like

[01:45:24] what's the difference there and what are the successes and failures or you know what are we tracking data on how these two opportunities are being used and um how how best we're spending our money yes those are all talked about in each of our weekly meetings as they're showing us implementation data and how it is being used across different school divisions so i have multiple reports that i could definitely send over to you if you would like to look at those more in depth um in fact we are missing alexia meeting to be with you this morning i guess my

[01:46:02] question is where are we getting the best bang for our buck um you know are we based on the numbers here. Are we offering something that's really maybe not necessary to be offered because so many

school divisions choose one over the others is really my question. And then I just have to give the team a huge amount of kudos because it's so important for the board to see the amount of

[01:46:36] interaction you are continuously having with the field in support of everything that the board has laid out. So if I could say anything, it's just we appreciate being looped into that information. It's critical in understanding that our decisions are being implemented and acted on and the field is getting them and getting all the support that they may want and need and the feedback that you all are requesting from the field post-professional developments and webinars to support them

[01:47:14] is really critical. And I, for one, am really happy to see all of this information being provided to us, even though it may be something that we want to sit down with our morning coffee on Saturday and go through. That information is still very appreciated. So thank you so much for that. And thank you for providing us with the opportunity to serve the Commonwealth this way.

[01:47:38] Our team, we're 100% nerds, and we absolutely love all of this. And we love being out in the field and supporting teachers however we can. So we love a good feedback form, and it has really helped to determine where we're going next, which I will definitely get into. I don't want to make Dr. Solari sit out in the wings too much longer. So I'll give the quick updates from the department on VLA, and then I'm going to let her come in and really explain everything to you guys.

[01:48:07] All right, so you are very well aware that the Virginia Literacy Act is in partnership between the Virginia Department of Education and Virginia Literacy Partnership's office at UVA. So I'm just going to give a couple of updates from the department side of things, and then I'm going to turn it over, and that's when we get into the really exciting slides. So as you're aware, one component of the Virginia Literacy Act is that each school division must submit a

[01:48:32] division literacy plan as part of their comprehensive plan. And so last summer, all 131 school divisions did submit these plans. And the English team did review and provide feedback to every single division about where they were. We did offer a fall webinar. If you recall, we had not gotten to a place where we had all of the supplemental and intervention lists available. So they weren't able to address that with their summer submissions.

[01:49:02] so in the fall we were able to host a webinar and kind of give them some guidance and what we saw were some great things we were seeing across the commonwealth within the literacy plans that were submitted and keep in mind that all of these are posted on the department's website so they could go look at one another's if they were interested we were able to give some highlights some glows and some grows and best practices and we did have 195 participants for that webinar we did also record it and post it so it is available and then this spring we were able to

[01:49:38] have a webinar on April 29th where we really focused on the upcoming biennial submission so if you recall we just did a one-year division literacy plan as we were planning for implementation but as school divisions move forward it is a biennial plan and this time they are able to designate and identify what supplemental and intervention materials they are using all the way through grade eight so these are due on june 30th of this year and we will be reviewing all of those and providing feedback additionally to kind of streamline the process and support

[01:50:16] divisions we are almost in production mode we're still in test mode of an application in ssws where school divisions will be able to submit their division literacy plan receive feedback and have a

whole historical record of any communication back and forth they can update that as often as they want because as you are aware school divisions can update their division literacy plan as early and as often as they like so that'll be a place where they can do that and then they will obviously also update their links on their websites which will update over

[01:50:53] to our website as well so we had 143 participants attend that one and we're very excited about what they're going to hand in and submit at the end of june we have hosted bi-weekly office hours with in collaboration with virginia literacy partnerships where we host office hours and school divisions can get on and ask questions of the department and of virginia literacy partnerships this could be questions about training screening resources curriculum reading specialists whatever the case may be we just host these bi-weekly office hours and typically

[01:51:33] speaking we have around 100 every single time we offer these we provided sample student reading plans we worked with our colleagues at the virginia literacy partnerships office to provide sample student reading plans to help schools as they were developing the individual student reading plan we also made sure that we put the approved program guides for that k-5 supplemental and intervention that i shared wasn't ready for the june 30th submission and then of course the grade six through eight so as soon as the board has been approving these materials we've been making sure that the materials are available on our website and then the next slide is really going

[01:52:13] to oh wow shoot i got right into hers and those are the exciting ones don't look back up come on all right nope there's one more we have many many many virginia education update articles supporting the virginia literacy act so these are all the links this is for sunday afternoon So ELA Saturday morning, Sunday afternoon, you're going to check out these Virginia education update articles, which are really going to highlight a lot of the work of Virginia Literacy Partnerships and the Department of Education in supporting literacy instruction. So there are many, many

[01:52:52] there. But again, it would be hard and complicated to find them all on the Virginia education update site. So they are there for you. And then additionally, we have been providing close to monthly literacy act updates that are very lengthy sometimes 20 pages long that are really looking at supports in all of the different components of the virginia literacy act and these are built based off to the feedback and questions that are asked during those bi-weekly office hours so it is very timely it is very relevant and it is responsive to whatever the field is asking we

[01:53:28] also hosted in collaboration with our colleagues at virginia literacy partnerships two webinars in the fall one on virginia literacy act and gifted education and that was also with our office of advanced learning and then one on english learners and the virginia literacy act and that was in collaboration with our english language coordinator so those are also recorded and posted on the site as well and you can see we had well 246 on one and 261 on the other we've also been collaborating with our teach office of teacher licensure to update and make the regulatory changes necessary

[01:54:05] for educator prep programs and the board reviewed those items in october so the english office has been supporting that work ongoing as well and as you are also aware one component of the virginia literacy act is a clause about a reading specialist micro credential um and currently we have those numbers are probably a little bit off because i think i've i invite maybe seven or eight more each day but roughly there are around 800 people currently enrolled in the micro credential course with 168 who have completed it and this is exciting information and news because this is

[01:54:45] one way to get additional reading specialists in classrooms especially as we're going up into middle school for the coming year it does it's just a five-year endorsement so it does not give you the permanent certification to be a reading specialist but it is closing a gap and providing supports and hopefully these people are going to be so excited about the work that they enroll in a certificate or master's program afterwards and then of course we rounded out the end of septem the end of 2024 with our vla advisory group meetings which again include vlp the english

[01:55:25] office and then you know we have an entire page dedicated to this work group and the members of that so we hosted those in september and december and kind of worked up um finalizing what that looked like where we were heading next and there are about 33 advisory group members for that together and now the part you've actually been waiting for i'm going to turn this over to dr emily salari to give updates from the virginia literacy partnerships office joe and thank you everyone thanks for having me it's it's been a while it's great to see everyone um i doubt this

[01:56:02] is the part you're waiting for but here we go if i know how to use this how do i use this jill oh i have to be patient which i'm actually not really good at or you have to double click okay so i think as everyone is aware we have a new screening system in virginia pre-k to grade three that is currently active and in addition to having a new screening system we also have a new platform that the system was on called VA connects which will

[01:56:38] eventually have a lot of have a few different screening systems on it we were the guinea pig so the the screening the Virginia language and literacy screening system was the first one to go on to VA connects all of our K to 3 teachers and administrators had access to it this year, and they've learned how to use a new system.

[01:57:00] So currently, we are running the pre-K vows and the grades K to 3. Pre-K vows will go on to Virginia Connects next year. So right now, it's on the old platform, but it will be integrated next year. This has been a huge project. We started this in 2020 to redo the entire system. If I'm honest, we actually started developing items in 2019, knowing that we really needed to update our screening system in Virginia but we were funded for the work to totally redo the system in 2020. At the same time that we were funded to do the pre-k to grade three in English we

[01:57:37] were funded to do pre-k to grade three in Spanish. That will go live next year so fall of 2025 that will go live for our users across the commonwealth and also because of the Virginia Literacy Act and grade four to eight a screener for four to eight will go live next year as well we are still in the process finishing right now actually for data collection on four to eight and the espanol version and but it will be ready to go live next fall so just in a few short months what the

[01:58:14] screening system does for teachers is a couple of things is it provides a band of risk for each student at the individual child level so high risk medium risk and low risk high risk kids are the kids that still get the 2.5 hours of supplemental instruction through EIRI.

[01:58:32] That has been in Virginia for a long time, and so those are the most at-risk kids who are funded to get 2.5 hours of supplemental instruction, evidence-based instruction. Moderate-risk kids are kids who are not in the highest-risk category, but they're still showing some level of risk, and we need to pay attention to those kids.

[01:58:53] And then the low-risk kids are kids who are doing okay. They are still expected to get evidence-based core instruction because of the Virginia Literacy Act, but they're doing okay in their literacy development. The moderate kids, when a teacher gets a report from the new screening system, it gives them a band of risk for each individual child, and it also gives them an idea of how they're doing on each subscale or each subtest of the assessment.

[01:59:23] and it indicates whether or not they need extra instruction by subtest. So we call those instructional indicators. So a teacher can take a kid's report and say, okay, this kid really needs help in phonological awareness, or this kid really needs help in letter knowledge, or this kid really needs help in decoding. And so they know the targeted skills. So that's kind of the beauty of the new system, that you're able to do that at the individual child level and plan for instruction.

[01:59:55] I'm afraid to hit it twice, but I think I might have to. So this is sort of hard to see even for me, but I think what we do now is we collect data K, first and second grade three times per year. So beginning, middle and end of year. All kids are required in K to two to take it three, take the assessment three times a year, take the screening system three times a year.

[02:00:17] In third grade, only kids who are new to the Commonwealth or who screened at high risk in the spring of second grade are required to take it. And so what you can see on these data is that from the beginning to the middle of this school year, so the first year of implementation of the screening system and VLA, for K-1 and two between fall and mid-year, we had fewer kids in the high-risk group.

[02:00:43] So this is good news. This is really good news. It means that teachers are getting the information they need to teach those subsets of skills. The band of risk is a psychometrically-derived standard score. And then the instructional indicator score is just a raw score that teachers can understand how well they're doing in each subtest skill.

[02:01:05] And in third grade, we did not see the same drop, but it's important to know that that population of kids is different. Those kids were already at higher risk at the end of second grade, or they were new to the Commonwealth in the fall of third grade. Yep, try it.

[02:01:33] Oh, so jumped forward. Okay, go ahead and ask. There we go.

[02:02:02] Yes. So they can see it in the system and then at the school, at the classroom level, at the school level, at the division level. We also put these data out publicly. So this is on our website. And we also provide these same analyses at the division level to each individual division.

[02:02:20] And they get that from us at the end of the testing period. So on the public website is the statewide data. What the division superintendents can get is division level data. That's right. but can they also get school and or classroom level they can dig down into the we have a reporting system they can dig down into those data figure out what which classrooms are working exactly attention yep excellent yes and teachers can do that at their own classroom level from fall to middle of the year a reading specialist could do it for the entire school a superintendent could do it for the entire division or ela director they can see the data in different different ways

[02:02:57] just a quick reminder to board members please make sure you turn your mics on and get it close enough to your mouth so that you can be heard and then also parents can access the data so there are parent reports that come out of the system that we encourage we cannot mandate but we encourage that teachers um share it with parents as well solton get it closer to you though so you can be heard what

parents are getting would be the data on their own child that's right and do they also see the data on their school or school division or is that all that is not currently publicly

[02:03:35] released. See if it lets me go back to the slides. Oh, now it's going the wrong way again. Okay. The other thing that we have out publicly is the technical manual, of course. This is important for anyone who's interested in all of the data and all the psychometrics and everything that's gone into developing the screening system. We need everyone to know this is a legitimate system. It is reliable. It is valid. So that is publicly for anyone. And then as I just mentioned, the data

[02:04:13] reports are out at the state level. And we create those data reports at the close of every data a collection window. And we have the reports back to 2020 publicly available. So you can track progress over time. Just remember that before this year, it was the PALS screener and not the VALS screener. So be careful when making comparisons. And I will say there was some divisions that were a bit uncomfortable in the fall of this year because there were more kindergarteners and first graders who were identified as at risk. And really what

[02:04:50] we had was a screening system that was collecting the right data and so it wasn't those kids were already in the system they just we just the data wasn't sensitive enough to ID them last year this is also small and I apologize but four to eight timeline we've been working on the four to eight screeners since the VLA four to eight was passed we are currently in schools collecting data that will end this week essentially and we will be ready to go live next year for four to eight and

[02:05:29] we've made some decisions around, you know, because there is a lot of testing in 4 to 8. We are very aware of that. And so this will not be implemented as a universal screener like it is K to 3. We will assess kids who fail the SOL because the SOL tells us that they're not doing great on, you know, reading comprehension, but we don't necessarily know why. And what the screening system does is it goes as it assesses decoding and fluency and listening comprehension, all those things that we know are required to be good at reading comprehension so that teachers and reading

[02:06:04] specialists can then target their instruction so that kids are scoring better on the SOL. So it should not be seen as a universal screener. It's more for kids who we know are at higher risk in grades four to eight. And Dr. Solari, correct me if I'm wrong, but a parent could see the necessity for this despite the fact that their child may or may not have failed the SOL.

[02:06:31] So if I'm a parent and I'm still questioning whether or not my child needs intervention, I can make that request. And is that something that, if that's the case, is that something that we are making sure to communicate? Right, that's a good question.

[02:06:47] So a parent could notice or a teacher could notice as well, or a reading specialist said, hey, this fourth grader didn't pass the SOL, but is still having some issues in decoding or whatever it may be. So the assessment's available to all four to eighth graders.

[02:07:03] It's only required for people who failed SOL. But we are making the system available to any kid in the Commonwealth four to eight. So it can be requested and it can be used. Okay, professional development updates. As many of you know, professional development is a huge part of the Virginia Literacy Act.

[02:07:21] And we have been engaging with many, many teachers, reading specialists, administrators, and everyone across the Commonwealth on this. So under the Virginia Literacy Act, every teacher is

required to get professional development on evidence-based literacy instruction and scientifically-based reading research.

[02:07:42] But we recognize that there are lots of different groups of teachers across the Commonwealth, and there are some that have had a little bit of this training. Some have had a ton of this training. Some have had none. We also have content-level teachers. We have, you know, K-3 teachers who need something really different than maybe a fifth-grade social studies teacher or a sixth-grade social studies teacher.

[02:08:01] So we have created a menu of courses that are targeted to those different groups of teachers and administrators and reading specialists. This was a huge lift this year.

[02:08:16] We've had 56,000-plus people enrolled in our academic courses, not just people, our educators. And as of last week, 31,000 have completed them. So this is a collaboration between us, the Department of Education, and also the coaches that we have out in the field.

[02:08:39] So we have the Virginia Lerciak funded coaches across the Commonwealth, and they are helping to implement this professional development hand in hand with the reading specialists. 'Cause you might remember the reading specialists, the model was that the reading specialists were trained first.

[02:08:54] So they got trained last year and now they are helping to implement this training with our teachers, along with the coaches and other folks and ELA directors in the divisions. So this really is a partnership. And I think what's represented here is something that's unique to Virginia, that my office at UVA, we do a lot of research.

[02:09:13] We have IES funding still sort. We think we have funding from the Office of Special Education Programs to do research. And we're very, through this avenue, really quickly able to translate research findings into practice along with our colleagues at the department. So these are the topics that we have covered and this is ongoing of course. There will be new teachers into the system next year. There will be new reading specialists into the system next year and we have plans to train them. We are already working on our fall plans to get everyone

[02:09:48] into the professional development programs. Okay, we also have had in-person statewide training for for our reading specialists, for our elementary principals.

[02:10:06] It was required by the law that elementary principals were trained. However, we had many vice principals and associate principals show up to the training, which was fine. We have trained over 2,000 elementary reading specialists. We have also trained ELA and special education folks, because really when you think about literacy, all of these people are working on literacy.

[02:10:28] And so we have tried to be as inclusive as we can as the budget permits to train as many people as possible. We also had folks from our TTACs there, and we have also began, because of the four to eight, to work with our reading specialists who are in the middle schools.

[02:10:54] Okay, as I mentioned before, we also provide coaching support, and we go out to the school divisions into into schools to work alongside our ela colleagues in the division and our reading specialist to implement the literacy act and that can be anything from helping to interpret data from the vowel screener to plan instruction to working on the implementation of a new curriculum because as folks are aware in the k-5 space it was required that by this fall they had they used a curriculum that was off the approved list. So that is a huge lift for teachers. It's a huge

[02:11:32] lift for administrators. We are asking teachers and administrators to do a lot of things different this year and they need support. So part of our role is going out and supporting the implementation as well. We also have ongoing publicly available professional learning series. This this learning series actually started as a result of us changing the screener in 2020. So I you know I said to my team, I said, look, the educators and parents need to know why we're changing the screener.

[02:12:05] And so we need to have a lot of publicly available resources for folks out there. They can go and download these and have one-pagers and webinars and stuff linked to the evidence base as to why this is so important. So these can be used. These are actually used in Virginia, but they're used in many other states as well. We get a lot of feedback on these.

[02:12:26] These packages can be downloaded and they can be used for professional learning community. It has every resource you would need to implement a PD around one of these topics. And we've split them out from pre-K to three and four to eight because often there are different things going on in first grade versus seventh grade, right?

[02:12:43] So we have split them out in that way and we encourage people to use these. And they're all evidence-based. And then in addition, we have family resources. So, we have short videos on why the screener was changed, what it does for your child, how to interpret the data.

[02:13:04] We have family newsletters. We've created family literacy nights, so a school can take a package, an already developed package where they can have a literacy night at a school, and all the materials that they need are in the package and ready to go. We linked the VDOE family supports as well, and then we also have a collaboration with Virginia Public Media where we've created short videos about early literacy development. What does it look like for kids? You know, what can you do in your home to foster literacy development? And

[02:13:34] those are all publicly available. And then as we got into implementation, we quickly realized that we need special resources for our administrators. I mean, we knew that before, but we were so concentrating on getting the teacher training up and going. So we have publicly available resources that tells administrators want to know give me the one-pager on what my teachers are learning in your Canvas courses and their professional development, so we created that.

[02:14:07] We created a special resource on navigating the VLA and different things like that. So we are trying as much as we can to be responsive to the field. When we hear from the field, we need this resource. We try and respond and we develop it and we put it out. This is the part that you all are the most familiar with I would think because this has come to you many times.

[02:14:27] So curriculum review updates, this should be really brief. So we have, and you all have seen, the approved program guides that are out in the field. We have thus far over the last two years reviewed a total of 225 programs.

[02:14:48] That's of course core supplemental and intervention programs. That's a lot of programs. It's more than I ever anticipated, I will be honest about that. And we have, and you all have approved 118, so that's across core, supplemental, and intervention.

[02:15:05] We have 10 programs that are approved for use in the core K-5. We have an intervention K-8, we have 43 programs, and supplemental K-8, we have 85 programs. Is that right? 65. Sorry, this is my vision's going. 65.

[02:15:21] I mean, that does not add up to 118. So thank you for your collaboration and partnership in that.

[02:15:28] has been a big call. Are there any questions for Dr. Solari? Dr. Northern?

[02:17:39] This is my first comment. We are definitely leading the country in some of these initiatives. I think that the complaint is often that by the time they get to third grade it's too late if we haven't assessed how they're doing and then they fail the reading SOL and we didn't intervene quickly enough. So I appreciate all of this effort going in at the K-2 levels especially. My questions are, one, are these data publicly reported on the school report card? Are there plans for that? I get to

[02:18:16] Ms. Holton's questions that they, parents can see the data for their own child, but what I'm getting at is that I'm all about the transparency here and I feel like this ties into, I'd like to see these schools and divisions get recognition and incentivize them to continue to do well on these on these things particularly since they're not part of the quote school performance and support

[02:18:44] framework as other grades are so I'm just going to push on that and encourage us to do that because I feel like again K2 gets forgotten they think oh sure I'm not going to be a third grade teacher and we are trying to build in some transparency and accountability here and that's what everybody across the whole country is saying that's not being done and why we're seeing the low

[02:19:22] uh proficiency and reading scores at the third grade level so this is huge what we're doing and i'd love to see us take the next step in terms of making this publicly reportable and i'd also just encourage us again to do whatever we could on the recognition front so that schools are recognized for making gains so that it becomes a big deal if you're making progress at k2 just like it's a big deal when you're making progress at grade three through eight. You know, those these grades are equally or more important. So as we continue to think about how we use these data to make them

[02:19:57] more publicly available at all, we need to build out an incentive and recognition plan for K-2 divisions in schools as well. Dr. Northern, are you any other questions?

[02:20:17] well i'll just echo uh dr northern uh uh dr solari this the amount of effort that's gone into this yes including as you say we nobody i think anticipated that we'd have that many submissions on the curriculum but you know that this is a really first effort for virginia not only our first effort to tackle uh literacy so comprehensively but our first effort on any subject matter to have coordinated work across the divisions with this much guidance and

[02:20:54] direction from the state but still recognizing local authority and independence and it just makes it incredibly complicated but incredibly important and and you all have done you and your colleagues at UVA have done so much of the heavy lifting in in concert with the department so we're grateful. I have a few questions. The first is just kind of what's your, you know, here we are at the end of year one of implementation. Obviously, we don't have outcome measures yet, and I want to talk about that separately, but what's your assessment of what's going especially well

[02:21:33] compared to where you thought we would be right now, and what are your biggest challenges, areas for improvement that we should be aware of? It was working. I don't know what happened.

[02:21:53] Thank you, you need to support my process here. Yeah, so maybe start with some bright spots. Well, first of all, I think we need to acknowledge, and I said it once, but I'm going to say it again.

[02:22:11] We have asked teachers and school leaders to change a lot this year in literacy. I mean, you're asking them to implement new curricula at the same time they're being a brand new screening system at the same time they're required to get professional development. And it was important that all these things happen at once because you want all these things to tie together, but it is a huge lift.

[02:22:30] So I think recognizing our educators is really, really important here, including our reading specialists, including everyone. I think that we've had divisions that have certainly have done really well. I mean, I was talking to the team yesterday, the professional development team about this, because they are the ones who see every day what's happening and, you know, how this is, how uptake is happening.

[02:22:56] And they could name 10 to 15 school divisions that are really engaged, really hitting it out of the park, as you would say, sort of in the implementation. And I think it's going to be important for us to highlight that. And it's possible they're missing some, right?

[02:23:13] There are a lot of school divisions across Virginia. But I think highlighting those as bright spots and I would encourage some cross division collaboration around this because if you had a year where things are going well, your data is looking good, your implementation is, you know, your teachers are engaged, we don't need to gatekeep how that happened.

[02:23:33] We want that to happen across every school division. So it was encouraging for me to see the data from fall to mid-year, especially in the K to space, especially after we had more kids identified at risk in kindergarten, especially in kindergarten in the fall, because that was, I think, alarming to our educators.

[02:23:58] Our window for data collection for the spring ends at the end of this month, so we'll be able to see what happened middle to the end of the year, and I think that will be really telling and we are able to drill down of course to the division level and have some conversations with through the coaches and through the department with schools with divisions about how it has gone for them so i think having that data is really important um you know i think we still have an issue this is a big there's a lot of people in education here we still have an issue with communicating down to the teacher level we provide as much communication as we can the

[02:24:36] department does as well but it does not always get down to the teachers and so and they are the ones doing this day in and day out and that can create confusion and that's unfortunate um and so i think our you know we need to really work on our communication plan and being responsive when there is confusion out in the field and making sure we're all giving the same response and you know we're united front in that um because our teachers are putting in the work here um and it's it's it's a lot so salton that's very helpful uh and as you say yes not only were teachers getting

[02:25:16] a lot on this but they were also at implementing new math standards and new accountability framework etc etc our educators and administrators have had a lot on the plate their plate so i appreciate your recognition on that up the 10 to 15 soup or more super divisions um are they would you say can you characterize them are they big and small across socioeconomic statuses or are they right geographically or otherwise without without asking you to name individual yeah yeah it's interesting because we kind of we we talked about it internally and they're from all over they're

[02:25:53] both rural and more urban divisions um big and small um yeah so it's this is a pretty diverse group of divisions. So once the final data for this year is out that might be a suggestion to the

superintendent that you bring some of these superstars here to educate us also share their stories with the rest of the state and that as you say may help encourage some of that cross-division collaboration. I have a couple of questions about what are the metrics of success? We as a Commonwealth

[02:26:31] should be using for the whole VLA initiative and is that these VALS numbers that we should be seeing progress on or is it SOLs or what and I'll combine my question what what metrics of success should we be using and when should we be starting to see the impact you're not going to like my answer on this so I mean this is a huge change I think we need some years I mean when you look at data at other states who have gone through similar changes in early literacy, it takes three

[02:27:07] to five years to see change on national level assessments like the NAEP and maybe even longer and state level assessments like the SOLs. But I think that, but unlike these other states, we are unique that we have one screening system K to two that every child is mandated to take.

[02:27:31] so while the other states that have gone through this process before us had screening systems it wasn't one assessment and so it was really comparing apples to oranges across school districts or divisions so we so we do have that so early success i think can be monitored by the screening system and then eventually you want to see that translate into sol performance because that's the outcome variable right when we think about reading development what is assessed on the in the screening system are the precursors to reading comprehension.

[02:28:01] And the SOL is more of a comprehension, all of this, the social studies SOL is also heavily reading comprehension, right? The science one, you have to be able to read it to answer the questions and understand the content. So the long term, I think, are our SOLs and NAEP.

[02:28:21] And if we're continuing the NAEP, we are, that's great. And so I think those are the long-term ones, but I think we're lucky that we have this screening system so we really can figure out K to two, what's going on early, and then three to eight, what's going on with these most at-risk kids, right?

[02:28:41] The kids who are failing the SOL, how are they getting better over time? - Ms. Halton? - The, that's very helpful to understand, maybe a number of years before we see big change. Would we, would you anticipate we'd see some results SOLs as early as this year or is that just not realistic? I think it's not realistic yeah helpful to understand especially because you have to think about the population of kids that take the SOL that's our third graders and up and so for this year they haven't been going to school for K-2

[02:29:16] under the VLA yeah so it's a population issue as well as yeah one year of implementation and that year of implementation has been right training right and we also know from data that once kids reached third grade and fourth grade that it takes much much longer to intervene on reading skills we've known that for decades and so it's it's it's more you need more resources to move the needle there uh sultan on the vowels right on the vows that reminds me one suggestion i have for you

[02:29:50] that beautiful chart you gave us high risk medium risk low risk very instructive it's almost like you ought to leave a third grade year off of it since it's not comparable and I did dig into the what you you told us a little bit of why it's not comparable and then the longer report you gave us I did click on that and say there are lots of reasons why it's not comparable but I'm looking at how many high risk in kindergarten first grade second grade third grade oh my gosh it looks like it communicates the uh um an incorrect impression yeah until you read the details right yeah if you

[02:30:28] have third grade on there you almost need a big bar of an asterisk and all that um and that um the um that reminds me that with the we we have heard some feedback from the field and this may get to your communication issue but uh particularly with uh young teachers teaching younger kids the test taking time is just so substantial and i and i remember i did know when we were administering the using the pals i did have some concept that it was administered one to one right teachers house is that way and how long does it take and i understand why we're doing it three

[02:31:08] times a year and i understand we're getting incredible information out of that but what can you tell us about the amount of time necessary we are just you know between the vowels and the comparable math assessments and starting at third grade sols etc we're just taking an awful lot lot of time for assessment. Can you speak to that a little? Sure, I can absolutely speak to that. So we anticipated this for this year, especially in the fall, because it was a brand new assessment.

[02:31:38] And it does, when you're giving a new assessment, it takes longer per child. It is a one-on-one assessment for most of the subtests. And we did things, and we continue, so the screening is a living system right and we always look at the data to make sure it's functioning as it should be and that we still we need to give all items that we're giving so and what I mean by that is we have made some decisions to make the testing time shorter so we can predict like if for example if a child gets the first three items wrong it's very unlikely they're going to get any other

[02:32:15] correct and so we have implemented stopping stopping rules so that of course helps with time And then the other thing we did is when we run the analyses around the screener, we look to see which subtests are serving us and which are not. When we first implement, you implement more subtests than you will ever need.

[02:32:36] That's just the way assessments are developed. And then you pull out ones that aren't giving you essential information. And so we have been going through that process. So it took a while in the fall, and it took much less time in the mid-year. And one of the reasons why it takes much less time in mid-year is because we're only giving the decoding part of the measure, not the language.

[02:32:57] The language is only required in the fall and the end of the year. And that's because on language, you would not expect enough growth between fall and mid-year for the data to be reliable. So we are making adjustments as more and more data comes in to shorten the assessment.

[02:33:18] I said this to Michelle this morning, and I don't want anyone spending any more time on this than they have to, because I want teachers to be teaching the content, right? And I don't want to stress teachers out with assessments. So we are making those adjustments, and we are stop rules and getting rid of assessments and items that just aren't serving.

[02:33:37] And with all that, how long do you anticipate the assessment taking? What's your goal for fall of 25, how long it's going to take? so that honestly the coding part of it should not be more than more than 10 minutes per child and once teached once once kids um teachers have given it a few times we are getting feedback into rs because because we have a hotline eight to five we hear all the complaints on the screener so we had a lot of complaints in the fall and we anticipated that and then we're hearing mid-year okay this i got this i know this is going much faster um and then this the language part which

[02:34:15] which is only the fall and the end of the year, should take 10 minutes. - 20 minutes total in the fall and spring per time. - Yeah, yeah. And we're the only screening system that has the language. No other

state is collecting screening level language dedicated to, so it's unique.

[02:34:32] And I think one of the maybe surprises or complaints or whatever frustrations that were coming to teachers was before we were only collecting decoding data. And now we're asking them to do something new, collect the language, it's collecting that language data is essential for understanding reading comprehension development maybe one of the things you can i'm sorry madam president this will be my last at the moment but one of the things you can do in the communications level is communicate to teachers it is our goal to have this take no more than x meds per child right help us get there right and then i will i will also say that um we we have done a lot of surveys of teachers about their experience with

[02:35:12] with the screener and also a bunch of focus groups. And we got a lot of good feedback and we've taken that feedback to sort of change our practice which is really important to the extent that we can 'cause we wanna make sure we have a reliable and valid screener, right?

[02:35:29] But we do it after each testing window. And one of the important things we got feedback we got was, yes, this took a little bit more time than I thought it was going to, but the data I'm getting from the system is so important to my instruction it's worth the time so um so i think that's important for people to know it can be a shock oh my gosh we're testing a lot but it gets quicker over time and also the data is really important for instructional purposes i think we all agree testing just to test is not no Ms. MacPherson.

[02:36:05] Data, I love what we love what we know from SOL for a period of time. So given the fact that it looks like English learners economically disadvantaged, students with disabilities are struggling or in more of the high-risk category, is there some type of data collection where we can look at the number of reading specialists, the tutoring that's being provided, the funding that's being provided,

[02:36:42] so we can see what resources are gonna make a difference. Is there some crosswalk maybe we can build as we're going through this? - Yeah, you know, it's interesting because thinking about, and I will let my colleagues also answer this because they know more from the department side, but we do have the division literacy plan data.

[02:37:04] And there is a way in which you can overlay the screening data with the division literacy plan data of what curriculum they're using, what interventions they're using, and use that to look at outcomes for different subgroups of kids we haven't gone down that road but the data is available

[02:37:21] um i don't right i think it's it's a really good point and i do think there are data available for us to get at that earlier

[02:37:47] we just have to develop the systems to integrate them just like to make that as a suggestion and that way when we get these reports on this uva partnership they could include something that

[02:38:26] talks about what our successes are or where we definitely need them we have a little bit more left in this presentation but superintendent gallixson uh just on behalf of the team at the department we're so grateful for the collaboration and partnership with uva and your team Dr. Solari and so we're excited to collaborate on some of these next steps the board highlighted today and just thank you for all you're doing for our earliest learners especially to help them be ready for reading. Thank you and this is I think when I think about all the things

[02:39:02] I do in my day this partnership is just so amazing and the fact that we are very quickly translating research into practice through this partnership I think that's unique to Virginia so thank you all all very much. All right I'll be really really brief. We're going to get to your Memorial Day coffee look so don't worry about it. All right very very briefly putting all of this together where are we going next as VLP and VDOE and a partnership in supporting standards English

[02:39:37] implementation and VLA. So just a very very brief look. Looking at summer as I shared the division literacy plan biennial submissions are coming in so that's going to be happening. We're also going to continue those literacy office hours with vlp to kind of support school divisions as they're moving in the four to eight space as i shared earlier there we are hosting those bi-weekly right now when we move into the summer they will move to weekly so that we can support divisions and get them be responsive to their needs as they're getting ready for four through eight

[02:40:11] implementation we are also going to be speaking i also know vlp will be speaking at the virginia Association of Elementary School Principals to kind of support. We're also going to share some of the four through eight information in that space and ask them to share with their secondary counterparts so that they have that information and support. Like I shared earlier we are supporting our MOU divisions with some day-long professional development sessions and then of course we have some virtual support that we are anticipating. Looking into the fall again we're gonna have webinars and resources that that will cover the next few slides we're going to look at that walkthrough tool

[02:40:51] implementation and that's really going to look at that core curriculum and how you're using it and how you are engaging students in the work to really get at those evidence-based literacy instruction practices and supporting divisions and building leaders as they support literacy instruction again once we get through summer because we know how much is on the plate of schools and school divisions those office hours will move back to bi-weekly but if you weren't aware we do have a vla inbox where we collect questions all the time anyway and share

[02:41:22] responses as well as dr solari shared we have the vla curriculum review cycle ongoing vals for four through eight is going to start and then of course we have different collaborative support that is ongoing with the office assessment as we think about upcoming standard setting committees and item review committees and looking at that 2024 standards implementation we're supporting the office of school quality as they are reaching out for technical assistance and supporting division and then working with humanities stem and math to provide instructional support in cross-disciplinary

[02:41:57] literacy practices so that is all ongoing the next five slides this is your coffee on monday all right these are the sessions that we are going to be offering this fall that are in response to requests from the field based on webinars and virtual support and in-person convenings and stakeholder feedback sessions what do you need where are we going how can we support you this fall so this just kind of gives you the menu we anticipate this will come out in a virginia education update article tomorrow and so schools will have this before they even leave for the summer so that teachers educators reading specialists building leaders and division

[02:42:37] level leaders can sign up to attend these webinars we're going to be looking at foundational skills for foundations for reading foundations for writing in k2 and in 3-5 kind of in a three-part series we're going to look at planning for integration and how you take our 10 strands together we're going to look at purposeful planning structures and plc development and how can we capitalize on the strengths of

our teachers and reading specialists to kind of support all learners within a school we're going to look at using data to support foundations for reading and foundations for writing really honing in on text dependent questions and really

[02:43:16] looking at text evidence and looking at deep engagement with text because that is so critical in English language art we're also going to look at effective student practices for foundational skills we're going to hit up intellectual preparation and planning we're going to offer sessions on writing instruction not just assigning writing but actually writing instruction and what that looks like at every grade level and how that supports reading comprehension as well we're gonna look at encoding specifically to kind of support our earliest learners and then we're gonna be looking at analyzing and interpreting

[02:43:55] data to drive instructional practices so this is just kind of taking us to December and we will regroup because we will have feedback opportunities and surveys at the end of each of these sessions to kind of see what the next steps are that are necessary and where our teachers and leaders want to go next and so we will plan our spring based on the needs of the field based on what we're seeing from val's reports based on what we're seeing from sol results and we will just kind of go from there so these are just our next steps for the first half of the school year but we're really really excited about that excited for the opportunity and hope that you are seeing through this very long presentation that you have all

[02:44:34] been so patient for kind of a comprehensive wraparound support from all aspects of the agency many many many offices within the agency blp and the department to support literacy instruction so thank you so much again feel free to check those out on monday morning and if you have any questions we appreciate you uh scheduling our weekend out for us i got you i'm just going to make sure that i have no other plans um dr northern you the broken record what i'd love to

[02:45:10] see in the pd uh-huh is some focus on how do you develop tech sets and how do you drive instruction around a content rich approach as opposed to a skill-based approach absolutely because i've I've been talking about this for a couple years now, and I just still don't think we've hit it as hard as we can, given that what we know about the importance of content-rich instruction and having kids read all this great, enriching, exciting text, and that we lead with that instead of, you know, develop a five-paragraph essay on blah, blah, blah, right?

[02:45:48] So anyway, I feel like teachers don't know how to do that, and I would love to actually see at least some attention given to PD on that, especially since I did see a reference to text sets, but I didn't see a name of any of the text sets, how to group them together, how to make sure that text complexity builds on each other, how to make sure that the content that we're assigning actually builds on each other as well.

[02:46:12] So there's a lot packed into that approach that I would love to see someone, and maybe you hire someone that can talk about that particular approach.

[02:46:28] because agreed super important and in particular when we're working with content area teachers around because they do also have to be we have to get training it's not the same as our ela teachers but it's really what we're looking on is how do you link to other content instruction with literacy development so it is a part of the pd that our teachers are getting hurt okay thank you all so much um we're gonna take about a five minute break now so that just so that you all

[02:47:07] are aware we're gonna move to item g because we do have some people who have planes to catch that we need to move them around a little bit so some of these presentations we're gonna have to

move

[02:47:19] for time purposes we're gonna move to item g when we return thank you item g uh standard setting

[02:59:43] committee update, please. Good morning, everyone. I know. I'm trying to practice patience. Really, it's not that slow. There we go. Oh, my gosh, it is that slow. Okay. Good morning. My name is Mary Ann Perry, and I am a technical advisor to the Virginia Department of Education. I serve on technical advisory committees across the country. I'm with several different states, but I'm not on

[03:00:23] your technical advisory committee. I've been brought in specifically to work on standard setting. I've been doing standard setting workshops since 1999 was my first one, and I've worked in over 35 states, six countries, four districts, et cetera, et cetera, and NAEP.

[03:00:39] So you've heard about standard setting first from two of our TAC members, first Chris Domolesky and then Greg Sisek last month, and we're going to try and see if we can keep it a little more standard for you moving forward, that I'll just be back and you'll get to know me.

[03:00:56] At the last meeting, you asked for more information on two pieces. One was how we were going to determine reasonable ranges, and two, more information about how we were picking panelists. So I am here today to give you updates on those two issues. One thing I did want to tell you, I currently live in Kansas City, but I grew up in the D.C. suburbs, and I went to school at University of Virginia. So this is very dear to my heart to be back in the Commonwealth. I said all that.

[03:01:35] Okay, so I wanted to go back and kind of reorient us about what we're doing and what the policy is behind what we're working on. This one I'm just going to go ahead and click because there should be several things flying through here and they're not.

[03:01:53] There we go. This is the map that shows state cut scores mapped onto the NAIT scale. This is the one that has been raising all the concern because you can't see it from your seats, but Virginia is at the very bottom of here in grade four reading.

[03:02:09] And what that means is not that Virginia students are doing the worst. It means that Virginia has the least rigorous cut score for proficiency in the country. I'm on flying things.

[03:02:25] At the very top is Rhode Island and Massachusetts. There we go. So that is one of the areas we are looking for is the states that have the most rigorous cut scores.

[03:02:41] The other thing I just want to point out is what we mean by an honesty gap. is that in this particular piece, you can see we have the lowest cut score, but it doesn't tell you anything about what percentage of kids are meeting it. So to let you know, we have on NAEP, I believe it's 32% of students are meeting proficiency in NAEP and 78 on Virginia.

[03:03:07] So it's that we're getting such different information from a national test than from our state test that that's considered the honesty gap. Okay, so that's what I wanted to show you and say, this is what we're working to change and say, let's raise the rigor of cut scores in Virginia, raise expectations for students, because I think one of the lessons learned from No Child Left Behind is when we first started 2002 to 2005, raising standards actually did seem to raise achievement. Gosh, there we go. Okay, so to raise achievement, I think I went one too

[03:03:43] far. Yeah, there we go. All right, so to raise our rigors, a couple things we're doing. One you've already done, which is adopting more rigorous standards of learning that are college and career ready. So check. The other thing we do is we look at our performance level descriptors. So putting into words what does it mean to be basic, proficient, and advanced. So those always need to be realigned when you update your content standards. But we've also brought in information from those states I mentioned, Rhode Island, Massachusetts, Maryland, states that do have the more rigorous cut scores.

[03:04:19] We brought in those PLDs as well to look at them and say are there things that we could pull in from from these other states that are relevant to Virginia and would help us increase the rigor appropriately. And then finally, we were looking to run a strong workshop.

[03:04:35] So we were identifying these ranges that we were gonna say these are reasonable ranges to set the cut scores. And reasonable range means it's around innate efficiency, around innate basic cut score, but not exactly. If we wanted to do that exactly, you don't need to run a whole committee.

[03:04:51] Any of us psychometricians could just find the cut score on the Virginia test that matches NAEP. That's cheap and easy, but does not build confidence in educators, participation in the community and understanding what we're trying to do and some really good feedback that I think we need.

[03:05:08] So it's just gonna be used as a guide. So what I wanted to talk about is these reasonable ranges on a scale. What we're gonna show is the scale is continuous.

[03:05:27] So what is it, 200 to 600? 100 to 600? Zero to 600, thank you, sorry, my muse is back there. Zero to 600 scale. So we currently set a cut score at 400 for proficient.

[03:05:48] Okay, come on, this is so much easier with the visual. There we go. So what we're looking at here is we can say, how do we set these cut scores so that we are getting this reasonable range? Now, what we look at, as I said, we've got 32% of kids are proficient in NAEP fourth grade reading.

[03:06:09] So I can look at NAEP fourth grade reading and I can find that point where kids are 32% proficient. One thing about every assessment, NAEP, Virginia, NWA, doesn't matter. Every assessment has what we call standard error of measurement.

[03:06:24] Means if you take the test over and over and over again, you'll get slightly different scores every time. That's just the nature of the game we're in. So we can use that error and actually put a confidence interval around that initial cut score. And say, students who are really about at NAEP proficiency could be anywhere here on the Virginia scale.

[03:06:43] And so we're using that to say this is the reasonable range. So if I'm moving that scale, you could see I could include more students or I could exclude more students depending on whether I'm going up or down. Next, what I'm doing here with this ordered item booklet is for all of your three through eight assessments, this is a CAT, a computer adaptive test.

[03:07:06] So there is no one form of items I can grab. So we put together pseudo forms where we match the blueprint, but we really try to get a range of items in terms of difficulty. difficulty, as defined by psychometricians, is simply how many kids answer this item right.

[03:07:25] Easiest item is the one the most kids answer right. The hardest item is the one the most kids get wrong. So that's always going to be a point when we talk through with teachers that they say, this item is not that easy. Why is it listed as easy? And we have to talk through, well, why is it easy? It's a tough

concept, but maybe the three distractors are so obvious that it's an easy item. But we talk through this ordered item booklet from easy to hard. And within this ordered item booklet then we can mark sections to say here's where our reasonable ranges will be so as panelists are actually walking through this booklet and they'll be doing this electronically they can see where the

[03:08:04] reasonable ranges are short miss holton thanks dr. Perry the item to order booklet ordering you said is based on how many students get the question right and that will be based on our 2025 assessment administration, the one that's ongoing now or just finishing. Is that right? Because we do have new tests based on new standards.

[03:08:43] If somebody else knows the answer better, I'm sorry, I just want to double check because I'm a little nervous about misspeaking. But the ordered item booklet is actually based on our banked values for each item, which means they come from 2024 was the last time they were updated.

[03:09:00] When we get to the point about what percentage of kids will be in each of these levels, we'll be bringing in 2025 data. So I'm sorry, I don't understand that because the 2024 banked assessment questions, we've now added new questions and we've changed questions because our standards are different in 2025.

[03:09:22] So will how the students do, how many students get questions right this spring fold into the ordered item booklet? Yeah, we could do that. The problem was the timing. We won't have all the data in and time to actually use that to create the ordered item booklet. So we use the banked scores, so field test scores for the newer items, banked scores for the old items. We use that to create the ordered item booklet.

[03:09:54] I don't think we have field test scores from before this year. These test questions weren't created. I'm told we did, so I apologize. But yeah, we field tested in 2024, and so brand new items are being...

[03:10:10] Can we get the person who knows the answers to these questions? All of the items in the ordered item books, ordered items set, were field tested with Virginia students. So we have underlying data for all of those items, all the items in the ordered item set, that are based off of real Virginia student data.

[03:10:33] And when was that done? They would have been administered either last year or in previous years. Remember, we had to realign all of the item banks to the new standards. So any item that's being administered this year has been realigned to new standards.

[03:10:51] And in some cases, we were able to field test some items that would also have that underlying Virginia date. I didn't mean to interrupt. We can come back to this if need be. Thanks. No, these are great questions, and I apologize.

[03:11:07] I'm not as strong on the history of the item bank as I should be. I meant it to be a quick question. I know, I know. I'll save my other questions. So this is a real live example of an ordered item booklet. I forget this one has, what does it say, 62 pages in it, I believe.

[03:11:26] And so as the panelists are going through it, they're going to see white pages. And then the pages are going to turn gold. I mean, maybe a different color. I may not have the colors right, but that's going to turn to a different color. when they see gold they'll know they're going to be in the in the range of this is a somewhere in here is where basic cut score we would like to go and again they'll see more white

then they'll see blue and know that's approximately we want proficient they'll see white they'll see green approximately where we want it then so they'll have those cues um and so this is how we are implementing these reasonable ranges are just visually letting our panelists know it's somewhere in here if you if you think that this is the point in the ordered item booklet where the

[03:12:05] knowledge and skills required by the item matches the knowledge and skills of the next performance level if that matches within this range then this is a really good place to place a bookmark yeah i did that again oh my goodness i swear i only click twice come on there we go okay so i do want to just reinforce the task itself which is to remember that what we're asking every one

[03:12:43] of our panelists to do is to go through our performance level scripters and really understand and internalize what it means. What do you need to know and be able to do before I'm willing to call you on the basic level? Then what do you know and be able to do before I'm willing to call you at the proficient level? And then what should you know and be able to do before I can call you advanced?

[03:13:02] So they've got all these skills, everything written out. It has been reviewed by both our instructional and our assessment teams at VDOE. These are being used by Pearson to actually write items that measure these skills and make these distinctions. So they're looking at these performance level descriptors and then for every item they will go through from that first easiest item in the booklet through the last hardest item in the booklet and say what do i have to know and be able to do to answer this item correctly and then match it to the pld and greg went through an exercise with you last month about how this is really done but that is the exercise so as they're going

[03:13:38] through when they get to this is a bunch of below basics and basics and now we're switching between below basic and basic, and so I'm seeing that area. We're hopeful that that area will also overlap with the reasonable range. If it does not, panelists have permission to put it where they think is the best match between the items and the PLDs. The big thing on this task and what we're trying to do is what's called alignment. We want to align expectations. We've got aligning the SOLs, the standards themselves, to the test items, aligning them to the performance level description,

[03:14:13] and we've got to align that cut score to that performance level description so what these next two slides are that popped up briefly and i'm going to show you again is is how much how many items folks have to choose from to get through these reasonable ranges one thing to keep in mind i can't remember which one i put first now but between math and reading you'll see differences one of the differences you'll see is in the number of items and how much space there is

[03:14:49] between the ranges um the reason for that is reading is always associated with the passage so items are clustered so we can't just pick items that match a nice range of difficulty because then we end up with well there's 24 passages you have to read for these 50 items which is not what the kids have to do so we try and bring in passages in their clusters and then spread the items out across the difficulty so you end up with a little bit more of a of a clustered booklet math we can they're all discrete items you can pick one at a time and make sure that they really are there we go okay so reading is the one that is close together so there you can see though they're

[03:15:28] broad ranges they've got a lot of items to choose through for um basic is yellow or gold uh proficient is the blue and advanced is the green now there are fewer items in the green level so that is one thing we've just noticed for noted for ourselves is that one of the things we need to put into our to-do list as we're building future assessments is write more rigorous items so that kids up at the upper level of the

scale can show us that they have the knowledge and skills up there and they can actually show growth so you'll see we have much fewer much more many more items that are

[03:16:03] actually fairly easy and probably do not distinguish among our kids we're going to work on on changing that over the next few years but this is what we have right now this is a technical quick question It was wrong before.

[03:16:22] - Ms. Halton. - And my yellow is the basic. - Yep. - Blue is proficient and green is advanced. - Yep. - And blue proficient is what will constitute passing the SOL in Virginia. - Correct.

[03:16:39] - I was right. - Ms. McPherson. - The panel is going through questions categories. Is it a majority of the panel members that vote and that majority vote will tell you the cutoff is are you trying to find somewhere in the blue where they say maybe question number 323 yep most of the panelists thought that was the cutoff correct so what we'll do is standard setting itself almost any standard setting is a combination of individual judgments and group

[03:17:14] discussion so the very first round they'll make individual judgments about how which which pld each item matches to and then say so i think this is where the cut score would go here's some and psychometricians crunch all that and bring it back into the room and say, let's talk about the items where a lot of you disagreed. These are the items half of you thought was basic, half of you thought were proficient. Let's talk about this item. And then we talk about the cut scores and say, okay, so right now your cut scores for proficient range between item 26 and 33. So let's talk about items 26 and 33. Why did some of you put your cut score at 26? Why some at 33?

[03:17:51] Where do you really see that knowledge and skills changing from the basic description to the profession description. And so that's done over three rounds. Independent judgment, talk, do another independent judgment. I was at the question point anyway on the reasonable ranges. So you saw the reasonable ranges are a little smaller for mathematics because we could get specific targets in there. Other questions on how we're doing reasonable ranges? Dr. Northern, do you still

[03:18:23] have a question? So maybe it's not a question as much as a concern. So if these bans for advance are so much more narrower. I'm assuming that we're not going to have the power to identify as many kids in this range because we don't have as many items to measure that range. And I guess my concern is that our proficiency index, the way that we set it up, is if you go from proficient to advance, right, you're going to get additional weight for doing that. And I'm concerned that schools are not

[03:19:00] going to get that weight if we actually have a poor way of measuring advanced performance. So what I don't have in these slides is the difference between or the mapping between a cut score on the ordered item booklet to a percentage. So I don't have that information.

[03:19:18] What I do have, again, this was the NAEP advance, which I want to say was like four to six percent in Virginia. So that's where it mapped to on these items is only four to six percent will end up advance. Again, panelists will have the flexibility of saying, I want to put something a little earlier for the reason you gave. But this again is how do we map things to the NAEP standard and try and get closer to what the national score looks like. But yes, if we are finding that kids are topping out, I mean, it shouldn't, even if you only have a couple of items that measure

[03:19:56] advanced, it shouldn't top them out necessarily because you can still answer them correctly. But over the years, we absolutely need to work on writing more advanced items and getting this more

evened out, which will be easier to do once we have the cut scores, have the final PLDs, and can give that to the vendor to write items directly to that level. Anything else on reasonable ranges? Because the second topic is panelists. So I'm going to go to that next. Yep.

[03:20:23] Walton. Just so I understand, the reasonable ranges, the goal, the guides we are giving the panel participants is to, the goal is to realign our SOL proficiency cut score around NAEP proficiency cut scores, right? Where it's reasonable, yeah. And you described that, you correctly cited that on average our Virginia students' performance on NAEP proficiency is

[03:21:00] around 32% and our SOLs is around 78%. So if I'm doing my math right, we're, we're, if your panelists follow your guidance, we're going to be basically doubling the failure rate on the SOLs in Virginia. Is that a helpful way to understand this? It's a pessimistic way, but yes, I think that is an accurate way to understand it. Okay, thank you. Let me ask a question. If that being

[03:21:39] the case is that a really reliable answer though so if what miss holton said that essentially we're going to be saying that that that percentage of kids between 38 and 73 is it is it a is it a statistically accurate way to portray that then i guess we're all going to fail or those kids are all going to fail um you know it's funny under under no child left behind rules which started in know one we're now in ESSA but the word failure is a little jarring to me because we talk about

[03:22:18] below basic basic proficient advanced our tests are all on grade level so kids who are even right at the basic cut score are answering some items on grade level um you know one of the things we struggle in any kind of workshop where we work with teachers is the word should is well when you finish third grade you should know this and the answer is well yes when you finish every grade you should have straight a's but guess what that doesn't really happen so how do we take the knowledge and skills kids are gaining in grade four reading put it on a continuum and say this is the most advanced this is proficient this is basic this is below basic now in virginia you've

[03:22:56] chosen to call those last two those lower two levels failing um but these kids are still doing something on grade level so i wouldn't say these are f students by any stretch or e depending on which grade scale you use um it's just not at the level we want them to be at and i think as i said said earlier when we started No Child Left Behind is we found as we raised the rigor of the cut score achievement did go up. We did see where we failed is this 100%. And what happened when people realized I'll never make 100% proficiency is the states almost unilaterally went in and started lowering cut scores because that was the only way to get there. And we saw achievement drop after

[03:23:34] that. Mr. Rotherham. Yeah. And I mean, I guess I will remind us of the No Child Left Behind experienced the states that were saying we're never going to get to 100 they were at 30 they were at 20. that was such a tomorrow problem and yet they were here saying we can't possibly and everybody knew the law would be reauthorized it would be changed those scales but you had states that had one in five one in three kids proficient were like we'll never get to 100 and it was like can we talk about getting to 50 maybe and instead that was the pushback and can we just be on i see

[03:24:11] the game here half the kids are going to fail that's going to be the headline we live in a state and i will remind you this is grade eight math where if you look and i'd be happy we can we i think we should post this data uh more when you look at low income kids in the state only half of them uh are past basic and the national the commissioner of the national center of education statistics and ies came and stood before us and said look people can disagree about proficiency if you are below basic you are

fundamentally unprepared for opportunities that's any of the things we're talking about with the three e's that's excuse me that's your ability to have a

[03:24:51] a life of some kind of choices um half and so we consider we can play these games and so forth or we can say that if we're going to be honest in any meaningful way about how kids are doing and how prepared they are there's going to be some bad news we're going to have to figure out how to support and weather it and we're going to have to talk about what we're going to do but we're not going to get anywhere if we continue to say this this game that's been going on for decades now and not just in virginia again with the no child behind example of just kicking this off or figuring out what kind of story do we want to tell the nape tells us something it's a it's a it's a

[03:25:28] nationally representative sample of students it tells us something we should pay attention to and i don't know how anybody who purports to care about equity can be you know at all comfortable with 14 percent of black eighth graders um at or above proficient 18 of hispanic eighth graders at or above proficient and you can back out from there half below basic half of those kids unprepared on our watch on the watch of the people who came before us and so we can play these games all day long and future boards can continue to play them or we can say that if we

[03:26:05] start having standards that are actually meaningful, say where we need to get kids, that there's going to be some bad news, we're going to have to invest in this system, we're going to have to do more to help low-performing schools, but we're going to have to actually get serious about that, or we can continue to do this. And I'll just close by saying this should not be, it should not matter who is sitting on the third floor of Patrick Henry, it should not matter who is in the governor's mansion or who is in the legislature. This honesty gap nomenclature we use, that was Arne Duncan. He was President Obama's Secretary of Education, Superintendent 10 of the Chicago public schools, who a few months ago congratulated us on the direction we're going on accountability and transparency, because it's important.

[03:26:44] So this should not be a partisan issue or anything else. It should just be a question of what are we actually going to do to move forward. I'm sorry to take so much airtime, but we keep having this conversation. I've had two terms on this board where it's always about these questions about what is it going to look like and so forth.

[03:27:01] Again, we're at that gut check moment, and we're either going to say we're going to do this and we're going to really hope that future boards and future administrations uh you know support uh kids who are who are further from opportunity here address this that we actually get really serious about intervening in low performing schools much more than we have um or we can continue to go down this road and it's a it's a bad road um for individuals and it's a bad road for the commonwealth if we want to maintain be competitive maintain our business climate and so forth so i just hope we can get to the what are we going to do to help kids get there and stop arguing about whether or not we should be honest about where the bar is.

[03:27:38] Madam President. Ms. Hulten. I'm certainly, I hope we're not playing games. I don't think anybody here is playing games. I think we're all focused on how to help our students succeed. I'm most excited about things we're doing. The Virginia Literacy Act work we heard about earlier that's actually helping students learn better.

[03:27:59] I'm excited about what we're doing for teacher pay, which I think is going to help us move towards a high-quality teacher in every classroom, which is something that actually helps children learn

more on how we measure students and how we assess students. I think there's room to disagree, and I just want us to be sure that we're clear and that the public's clear.

[03:28:19] We're not talking about having a measurement where half kids fail. We're actually talking about 68% of kids failing the SOLs if they're aligned as suggested to NAEP proficiency. And that's an approach you can take to assessment.

[03:28:38] And as we've heard, there are states that have done that. But my point is, we then need to look at all the other ways we use SOLs. We're not just using them as part of our accountability framework. We use them for graduation requirements.

[03:28:55] So one of the big implications we need to consider, I would submit as a board, is does a student who has mastered the basic level of information for their end of your course but not mastered the complex, all the complex information required for high NAEP proficiency, should that child be able to graduate?

[03:29:19] And the changes we're going through, if we don't make other adjustments, are going to cause problems for kids graduating, a lot of kids. And that question really doesn't go to you, Dr. Perry. That's really how we use these assessments.

[03:29:36] But I think it is important for us to understand. We've asked for modeling, and we haven't gotten it. But it's important to understand that if this process, standard-setting process, goes as planned, then the cut score that determines who passes and who fails is going to go up such that we're going to go from having 78% passed to 32% passed.

[03:30:00] that's, you know, meaning 68% failing, if my math is accurate. I will say that I know this conversation is exactly what the panelists will be having in two weeks, is when they're looking at the final results and saying, is this what we want? Is this what we mean? So that is part of what we will be documenting for you, is how all of these panelists have felt, where they put the cut score, how they justified it, what their belief was, and why this was the best place for it. And And we'll bring that back to you to talk about their input qualitatively, not just quantitatively

[03:30:34] as well to answer some of that, because they'll have the same debate within the guidance that you're giving them. Yeah. I mean, as a technical person, I can set up a standard setting to follow any policy guidance. Policy guidance I've been given is to try and reduce the honesty gap between Virginia assessments and NAEP.

[03:30:55] So that is what this is designed to do. And I'm excited with how well I think it's working. I think the one other thing I forgot to say, and I believe, Member Holton, this came from your suggestion from last month, but the idea was, can we show the panelists actual NAEP items so they can see are NAEP items all that different from Virginia items?

[03:31:15] So during the training, they will actually see what a NAEP proficient item looks like in grade four and eight and what a NAEP proficient item looks like in grade four and eight reading. So they can look at those, look at the NAEP PLDs and say, here's what we're doing. So we're gonna have them actually practice on NAEP first and do that little exercise, sort of like Greg did with you last month, we'll do it with some NAEP items.

[03:31:36] So they get a feel for it and say, is this the level we're looking for? Before they ever even start working with Virginia items. Mr. Rotherham. Okay, while we're on this, and we'll get back, and I know this is policy, so this is not what you do implement the policy.

[03:31:52] It's our job to design it. I do think an area where there's some common ground, we are going to have to have conversations. I think Ms. Holton is right. These things, they extend out into the system in a variety of ways. We need to be thoughtful about that. That's a policy conversation that this board, future boards will need to have.

[03:32:07] And probably if history is any guide, refine. It's a constant process of refinement. I would just respectfully submit the only way to really productively have that is to say, this is what the standard is. Again, in our considered judgment, we should all have some humility about standard setting as a human process of professional judgment.

[03:32:28] Based on a number of things, including we do know these tests matter. These are not abstract things and it's important that parents understand that, that how your kid does, these things are predictive. How your kid is doing in math in eighth grade is highly predictive. Are they reading in third and fourth grade? Highly predictive for future success.

[03:32:46] So these are not sort of arbitrary things. But once we have that, then it's, I think, appropriate to make policy judgments on, okay, as kids move through the system and are doing different things, what should that look like? I just don't know how you have any of those conversations, Have any of the conversations on resources and investment?

[03:33:03] Have any of the conversations on what we need to do to actually intervene in low performing schools instead of admiring them decade after decade? How do you do any of that if you're not being honest about where we are and leveling with people? And so I look forward to those conversations.

[03:33:18] I don't think we should be setting any of this in stone, but I just don't know how we get there if we are not transparent about where kids need to be, why and where we've been falling short on that. - Dr. Northern.

[03:33:34] just have a comment and then I think a little bit of a technical question. My comment is that in just my own conversations with teachers and educators, they know that the bar has been falling, right? Like they are also frustrated in terms of kids sort of not realizing the seeing that the expectations have dropped in some cases, and some of that's been proven, right? We know that the COVID era has ushered in some lower expectations above and beyond what we had already. And everybody,

[03:34:09] the whole nation is struggling with trying to get these expectations up again because they were lowered and we didn't have a resetting. And we're trying to convince everybody like we need to do the resetting because if we don't, we're damaging kids long term in terms of their likelihood of getting a middle class income in terms of their likelihood of being able to you know support a family so on so forth um so i will say that um that that is extra important given that we're coming out of the pandemic this realigning of higher expectations because we can't set the

[03:34:45] new normal at the lower bar that we set during the pandemic because we were in a pandemic and my other point is just a little technical question i think on your slide uh where you talk about you're assuming that the i'm on slide nine where you say we assume the percentage at basic proficient in advance would change evenly for grades three through eight and the eoc yep um i'm trying to figure out i

understand that that's a an equation right and an assumption you're building into the modeling um but why would we want to make that assumption that the

[03:35:22] percentage at each of those levels would change evenly for those grade levels so a couple of reasons and this goes back to um when we're figuring out that confidence interval around um this the virginia scale using the nape proficiency we can do it straight on for grades four and eight because we have nape four and eight tests we do not have nape tests in three five six seven and of course um so what member northern is asking me about is is we have the data for grade four we have the data for grade eight so we have to impute the data for grades extract it for three

[03:35:57] and impute it for grades um four through five through seven so in this particular case couple of things one is the differences were not huge if you had 52 percent in grade four and 18 percent in grade eight we would have had more talk about how do we decide what should it be for five six and seven in this case it was really close like i think two percentage points so when we looked at at our scale, it really isn't much of a movement.

[03:36:25] So to move it evenly, one of the things we do, and I think you've heard about this in previous meetings, but we do what we call vertical articulation at the end of a standard setting, where we look to see, does it make sense the percentage of students proficient from grade three through end of course?

[03:36:43] And the reason we do that is because it literally doesn't make sense to say, 60% of our kids are proficient in grade three and 20 at grade four and 80 in grade five and 30 at grade six. Teachers don't understand it. Parents don't understand. It just isn't logical. So having a more smooth transition as our starting assumption is something we use to just say, we want this to make sense.

[03:37:09] So we want a parent who says, my child is just barely proficient in third grade. I'm nervous to see how they're gonna do in fourth grade. Will they be a high basic or low proficient? It shouldn't be the scale that throws them, oh no, they're advanced now, or they're below basic. No, we want the scale to not be the thing throwing kids back and forth into different ranges mr rotherham this is also to be clear why we use a range because there we don't want to create some sort of false precision where if you're what's whatever side of 50 or 90 or whatever you're on that it's a it's a range recognizing

[03:37:46] that there's to be noise yep absolutely yeah there's absolutely noise the confidence intervals are actually fairly broad um we've looked at it in terms of what if we pick the lowest what if we pick the highest what would the percentage look like it is a pretty decent range we're not going to go up to the percent proficient we had in the past but we may also not drop down to 68 failing i mean somewhere in between that and i think be helpful if you just explain what a confidence interval is i think there's probably people watching what's that you know so those are words whose plain plain letter meaning and how they're using this context are pretty different yeah you know i used to be able to talk about this with um current events and i've gotten so

[03:38:25] old my current events are no longer working but what i used to say see if this rings a bell with anybody is remember on men in black they had that little device we could do a blinky thing and erase someone's memory for the past hour so if i could sit you down and have you take a test give you a blinky thing have you take the exact same test give you a blinky thing take the exact same test give you a blinky thing you would not get the exact same score every single time that is what we call measurement of error error and measurement sorry got that backwards error and measurement and we put a confidence interval around that to say this is what you would get your true score is

[03:39:04] somewhere between all these individual scores you got when i kept using the blinky thing on you okay so we're putting the confidence interval saying we think your score is a 400 but it's plus or minus 20 points um and we see this all the time in political polling is probably where it's most familiar to people is because they're sampling people from across the united states not asking every single voter they are they are saying we think we've got 50 voting for this guy plus or minus four percent it's that same idea only now we're looking at the items rather than the people so i think it makes sense to go on to the committee member selection because a lot of

[03:39:42] what we just talked about came through so clearly in these applications um so we have been working through both the educator and the community member applications um we put together a very kind of rigorous application for everybody with a lot of open-ended questions and then we developed a rubric to analyze the open-ended questions and talk about what are we really looking for and i actually wanted to make sure i wasn't just remembering things from my experience and i pulled out the literature and it is we want to pick panelists uh with who understand three things

[03:40:18] one is do they know the content two is are they familiar with the students the population i should say because we use this in licensure too but do they understand the population that they're working with and do they understand the consequences of what they're doing so those are that's what sort of drove the rubric is they people got more points if they demonstrated they had experience in those three areas and with students we would ask about are you familiar have you worked with students that come from different backgrounds such as low ses we asked specifically about english learners specifically about students with disabilities and really looked for people who

[03:40:55] have experience with the wide variety of students got to start remember to push next five minutes before i want to talk um there we go okay so um when we were looking at this one really important factor was looking across virginia we wanted to make sure we had representation across all eight superintendent regions of virginia we know the largest population is up in northern virginia but we didn't want all the participants coming from northern virginia so that was true for both

[03:41:35] educators and community members educators we also gave a higher priority to those with more teaching experience they've been around longer they've seen these changes that's going to give them a little more of an edge excuse me um and we're setting up the whole thing so that we have about 70 teachers 30 community members on this panel and that's going to be my biggest juggling act over the next couple weeks is that we set it up so we invited that but of course now not everybody can come so as we're trying to jump those hoops to get this all arranged we're still

[03:42:12] still working through that. And community members, we also looked a little bit further to business community, higher ed community, and more general community. We also had some that I hadn't really thought about, but we picked a couple of them. They're great community members. They just didn't necessarily fit one of those categories of parent, higher ed, or business. And that is our military, police, and firefighting community. We had applications from those communities. Not everybody was a parent, so they didn't count there. But we also looked really strongly at those, and some of

[03:42:45] Those were chosen as well. There we go. So again, number one with educators is, do you have content area expertise in the grade and subject you're applying for?

[03:43:06] So we did have a few science teachers applying, but we were really focused on reading teachers and math teachers. We also asked them to complete an expert task. And for them, this expert task was to

be able to align, recognize what an item is measuring. So can you do the task we're gonna ask you to do?

[03:43:23] Do you know what this item is measuring? Can you tell what distractors are likely to be misleading versus the ones that are just throwaway distractors? And we looked at that as well to say, how well do they do on these items? We also asked for an interest statement from everybody.

[03:43:42] Why do you wanna be on this committee? And I'll be honest, we got several that were, I wanna be on this committee 'cause I think it'll be interesting and may help me. That got a lower priority than I wanna be on this committee because I've been teaching grade five mathematics for the past 10 years.

[03:43:58] I've seen changes in our expectations and I wanna go in there and form the next set of expectations. That got a higher priority 'cause they were in to say, what can I give to this committee, not just what can I learn from the committee.

[03:44:15] Community member. So again, this one was in some ways easier to distinguish the knowledge of subject matter because they haven't been teaching. So that's not just a check mark of you wanna do grade three reading and you've been teaching grade three reading.

[03:44:32] This is, okay, so what do you know about grade three mathematics, and of course, algebra two. And then questions about what has been your experience with students at these age, with this level of test taker. And then how do you use these results, if at all?

[03:44:48] What do they mean to you? And that's how we kind of got out the three things we were looking for for them. So our knowledge of subject matter really can be all over the place. Professors, we often just took a math professor 'cause they know mathematics. I was joking with our superintendent that we have an actual rocket scientist and of course algebra too so um north of grumman uh employee we have cpas and mathematics we have a librarian and reading a lot of people who applied as community members are actually former educators which i found fascinating they've either moved from education to either the workforce or

[03:45:24] higher ed or they're stopping out of education to have kids so they're now applying as a parent but they were a former educator so i really felt strongly that by the time we went through and selected the community members we have a really knowledgeable set of community members i think they're going to contribute a lot um people are worried that well they just may not know as much about the subject but i i think this group will um and i do want to reinforce that again back when i started in 99 this was normal every committee i put together had 30 about a third of participants

[03:45:59] were community members um it's only been in the last 10 15 years we've stopped doing it and i'm And I'm honestly not sure there was no policy decision to stop doing it. I think it's just, this is harder. It's harder to get the community members to apply. It's harder to get a good representative sample. So I'm really excited to see Virginia do this, and I was really excited with all the applications we got.

[03:46:19] I'll show you more in a minute. There we go. So where we are now is we have notified everybody that they have been accepted as a panelist. And on Monday, we did a community member training session where we had, I believe, 61 of our our 79, 76, 76 community members join that session.

[03:46:45] And we talk through what is standard setting? Why are you here? How did you get picked? What will you be doing? Is there anything you should study between now and then? Really good

attendance, really great questions. I'm even more excited about this group now. So again, we are now just going full board to get everybody registered to get our materials.

[03:47:06] And we're going to be doing our first standard setting on June 9th, which will be here before we know it. So here's a number of applications we got. 913 total, 813 total, could have done that in bigger fun.

[03:47:24] Twice as many educators as community members, but that was good 'cause we picked more than twice as many educators than community members. Let's break it down a little bit more within each of those categories. So educators, you can see math and reading, how many applied in each level, each grade level.

[03:47:42] We'll just leave it up there for you to read for a minute. And then for community members, we divided it out, looking at the higher education.

[03:48:00] A lot of our higher education people were folks focused on teacher training and the committee member I worked with committees I members I worked with to pick the applicants for them that was interesting but secondary to working directly with students who come out of high school so a community member who is a community college professor in mathematics who works with kids directly out of high school and helping them with remedial algebra that when we said this is really strong experience that can help inform this so we did accept some teacher training but we focused a lot on are you working with these kids when they come out of high school and i put a quote up there that is too small for me to read

[03:48:39] from here but it basically said that this is a person who said i see the changes i've been a community college professor and i can see the changes in the quality of the students i'm getting and they don't have the algebra knowledge they need to succeed and you know during some of this previous administration two administrations ago yeah let's back about i'm going to go back a few back when president bush started no child left behind um he would talk about you know the the soft bigotry of low expectations but one of the things we were talking about in terms of community college and remedial courses is remedial courses are high school classes you now have to pay to

[03:49:16] take and don't get any credit for we don't want our kids to have to go take remedial yes it's there yes it's meant to be a safety net but that's not what we want as our goal for our public education system uh i feel like i skipped something there but oh this was the next slide is just the list of all of the higher ed institutions that submitted a person a member so quite a few from here reynolds community college um one from the apprentice school we had our big universities

[03:49:51] virginia jmu george mason old dominion virginia tech i'm sorry i went to uva i always forget virginia tech virginia tech they all submitted applications we even got one from the university of Virginia in WISE campus. So that one is one that we extended an invitation to because we're always excited to get that reach into the state involved. Business, as I said, we had several different kinds of business leaders. We had people in philanthropy. We have people from Northrop Grumman. We have CPAs. We had a police officer. We have, but the police officer, again,

[03:50:29] his application was so intriguing because he's actually the training officer for new recruits. So he sees the applications of everybody applying to be in, and this is the state police, and he said straight out, the quality of the applications are going down.

[03:50:47] I want to look at what's happening and what I can do to help because we're having to do too much remediation, even in early training to be a police officer. So again, someone who's working with

these kids when they leave our public education system, that is his application.

[03:51:08] I just really liked his quote, so I threw it on there for you to read. Dude, this isn't the right slide deck. I have a slide to show you how many we actually have from all the regions and the different groups.

[03:51:33] You have the right one. Oh, good. Okay. Okay.

[03:51:48] So we invited 181 educators and 75 community members. Our committee size ranges from 14 to 18. We went back to the standard setting plan that had been approved by our technical advisory committee in Virginia, and they said we need a minimum of 12 to 15. We feel like we've got a good solid number that if people drop out, we're still okay.

[03:52:09] They said we're watching the numbers every single day. because we're getting the RSVPs, but having done this for 25 years, I also know that the morning of, we will get a couple of phone calls. That just happens.

[03:52:26] All right, we talked about this here, Mac. So the one I skipped, then I skipped one that I wanted to talk about.

[03:52:43] Put it in the middle? Aha, a whole different things. Yep, the two slides I wanted to talk about were in the middle. Let's go, the one that's got colorful Venn diagrams on it. Thank you, slide 21.

[03:53:05] We had a bit of a difficult time deciding if someone should be in one particular category because a lot of people fit more than one category. So I wanted to show it to you in that way, that we had 62 people who applied just as parents, 44 people who applied just as business members, 45 as just members of higher ed.

[03:53:26] But then we had 16 who said, I would be either higher ed or a parent, and some of them actually applied in both places. 44 said, I'm business, I'm also a parent. And then we had these others that again, police, military didn't really fit some of these, but brought in some really good experiences that we wanted to honor.

[03:53:44] So that's what the snapshot looked like of who the community people were. And then the next slide is what I was talking about earlier in the distribution across our regions, across our state. So the dark blue line is the percentage of our students in each of the regions.

[03:54:00] So as we all know, region four, Northern Virginia is our most populous region, but we did not want to make majority of our panelists from region four. So you can see we did a slightly better job spreading it out around the eight regions. Although again, where we have the lowest population is also where we had the fewest applicants.

[03:54:19] It was with the two numbers I wanted to give you. Now I can take questions. - Are there any questions? Ms. Holton.

[03:54:35] - Thank you for that bar chart. I think that was helpful. Your predecessors, those who presented before you at prior meetings suggested that demographic variety representation is also important. Do we have any information on the demographics of these participants, social, economic, gender, - What we chose to do is focus on the communities they represent rather than their personal demographics.

[03:55:01] And really focus on, have you had experience working with kids in different communities? Have you had experience with kids with disabilities? So we did not look at that. We didn't even collect the data. So I can't even give you a chart of what it's gonna look like. I probably can after standard setting, but I can't right now.

[03:55:16] I will say, however, I was very pleased at our meeting on Monday. That group is not a monolith. male, female, pick a race. It was clearly a good group of folks from all over the state, representing all kinds of communities.

[03:55:36] - Ms. Holtin. - If you can collect that data going forward, I think that would be important. I think it was Dr. Domolesky, though it might've been Dr. Cizik. I don't remember. We've heard from a number of folks on this topic, but specifically said that part of the whole point of this exercise is to have community acceptance of the outcome and that demographic representation important to that. We were told that was going to be one of the goals, and so I'm hoping that you gathered that and you can get us the data to see it. Other questions or comments? Just a comment,

[03:56:13] Madam President. Mr. Rotherham? I just think, I mean, this is the whole process. It's a lot of work, and it's actually all quite interesting, but I just think this step of including just such a range of people, community members, and you highlighted a few things like, you know, state police officer but also higher ed just this articulation where we're moving this out from being a very insular process to being broader so hopefully like there'll be conversations about up and down what does it actually mean to prepare students for all these various options that they can pursue after high school i just think as well it's it's unusual most it's a place we're

[03:56:49] differentiated from most states um and it's exciting to see it come together and i think pursuant to your previous comment we did get a lot of people who said i've seen the standards go down. One of our panelists is a grandmother now, raised her children in the Virginia Public Schools, is now raising her grandmother, grandmother, grandchildren in the Virginia Public Schools, and has said, I can see the difference between the two generations. So we got that from the applicants. I think they're all very excited to be here and be part of it. And we also got people who work in trade schools, who said, you know, there are kids, you may say, I'm just going to

[03:57:25] trade school, you still need a minimum amount of mathematics and reading to go into trade schools. so i think we've got a wide variety of people with different interests um again representing the entire state and i feel pretty good that we're going to have a good diversity on all of the pieces we're looking for thanks and just for that madam president i think part of the problem here also is you tell kids you're prepared and they get out in the world and they discover that they're not i mean this is not just a virginia problem they're remediating math at harvard now um and and so there's just a misalignment and so we i think we we can talk about this in a bunch

[03:58:03] of different ways but we shouldn't lose sight of the main thing which is you want kids to know that what we're telling them is actually meaningful saying you can do these things you're going to be able to actually do them in a way that's going to be recognized at whatever your next step is whether that's an employment higher ed in the service whatever it is um and and that's what so i mean I mean, I think we can pretty quickly talk ourselves in circles about aspects of this, but that's the main thing is that kids will know if we tell them that this is meaningful, that it actually is, and the people who they're gonna be

working with that are gonna be making those determinations, whether that's a professor or a trainer for EMS

[03:58:41] or somebody in the military of the trades will actually value this. And I mean, I think, I don't wanna belabor too much, but it's a really important step, and again, does differentiate us in a really good way. - Yeah, if I can just double down for a second an anecdote. One of the very first standard settings I did back in the early 2000s was the state high school exit exam. You had to pass this exam to graduate high school, period.

[03:59:03] And the state asked me to set it up so that there would be one room full of educators and one room full of community members. So again, we looked for people who were hiring straight out of high school. We looked for community college professors that were working with kids straight out of high school. We did the standard setting. We got to round three, and the educators had set a much lower cut score than the community members. So we decided, we brought them all in the room, showed them results and we said what do you think and what was stuck with me for the last 25 years is the one of the educators raised her hand and said it's not fair that these kids have worked hard for the last 12 years in school and one test is going to keep them from graduating and a business

[03:59:41] person who hires kids out of high school stood up and said what's not fair is you give them a high school diploma and they think they're ready for the world and then i hire them and they can't do the job and i think that's what it comes down to is what kind of fairness are we looking for and And that is something that our panelists will be debating, I have no doubt.

[04:00:00] Ms. Halton. I just want to correct something I said earlier. I did my math wrong. It's actually not doubling the percentage of students that fail the SOLs, but will triple them. Because I was looking at the pass rates, but the fail rates, current failure rate is 22%.

[04:00:20] And that will go up, if we align to Nate Proficient, to 68%. Madam President. Mr. Rotherham. with respect we live in a state that has told people that well north of 90 of the schools are doing fine when fewer than one in five black and hispanic kids in eighth grade are proficient this is going to be the inevitable result if we don't keep kicking the can down the road we can go round and round on this again and again whether we're tripling quadrupling one in five less than that and we've been telling everybody that almost every school is doing fine we're either going to

[04:00:55] have a reckoning for that or we're not and I mean we can sit here and we can go back and forth all afternoon we can do it tomorrow we can do it at the next meeting future boards can do it but that is where we are that is the math and there is no way that we start to be more transparent and honest about where kids are and we don't see a bump the question should not be about that it should be what are we going to do for those kids what are we going to do for those communities what are we going to do for those families those are the kinds of policy conversations that we should be having not trying to square this circle where you've been telling people that almost every school is great

[04:01:29] when you have these astounding gaps in achievement and this astounding gap overall in terms of what we've been saying is proficient and what is not and I'm happy to have that conversation we can keep having I think it's just much more productive if we start moving to the okay what now in terms of what are we going to do to actually address that situation not how are we going to continue to measure it or not measure it.

[04:01:54] Madam President. Ms. McPherson. I've been listening to both sides of the argument, and I think I understand them. You know, all of the points are well taken. You know, the students didn't fail us. We failed the students.

[04:02:10] We failed the teachers, the ones that have worked really hard to try to make a difference in a system that had a lot of failures built into it. Yeah, I think we've got to be really concerned about the policies that we develop so that we are not mistreating the students that have already tried to get through this process and because of the fact that there are a lot of moving pieces that weren't working well for them that they're not highly punished at the end and at the same time build a new system that we have confidence in and that's transparent so that's why i said we

[04:02:49] might as well roll up our sleeves because i think there's just a tremendous amount of work that has to be done we've had chronic absenteeism we've had a pandemic um we we've got students that are high tech that are engaged in a lot of social media that are now involved in ai in the completion of work we have all of those factors involved but that's why i think as we go forward and build policy we need to make sure that we are focused on aligning the resources to the places where

[04:03:23] we made the greatest mistakes and have the best outcomes we can have and be honest in the whole process okay um thank you all right thank you very much all right so we are going to take a lunch break now um and i'm going to give us 145 is that good or too long 130 or 145 130 okay let's do 130

[04:04:01] then. Thanks. And we are going to begin the afternoon session with an update from our friends

[04:43:21] at iTeach. And so I am excited to welcome here today with us the iTeach team that consists of Andrew Rozelle, Mo Gaffney, and Laura Estes. And so the three of them will be tag teaming this presentation, I believe. And we are excited for you all to be here with us today. So thank you very much. Thank you very much. Am I mic'd up? Can people hear me? Is it good? Great. Thank you so much for letting us be here today. Again, my name is Andrew Rozelle. I'm the president of I-Teach

[04:43:59] and get the privilege of leading out our efforts to help divisions around the state. And like was mentioned, I'm here with Dr. Gaffney and Dr. Estes. Dr. Estes is our program director, so she runs kind of the operations. And Dr. Gaffney is a partnership director and she works with all our divisions out in the field and they'll both be helping me tell the story of where I teach has been really over the past two years to give some context of the work we've been doing there's this a bit of delay perfect there's yeah there's

[04:44:36] I mean we can there we go just as a kind of a orientation what we'll like to do is let you know some of the program data that we've seen some context to our partnerships and our cape alignment that's forthcoming and then things that we've heard from our partners in the field. And we'll end with some of the identified needs our divisions are saying in the field to us to kind of tee those up for maybe a further discussion.

[04:45:01] But for those who might have not been here during our approval or need a refresher, I want to tell you a little bit about how our program operates. I won't spend too much time here, but iTeach was created actually by my mom 22 years ago in the state of Texas. We currently operate in 17 states across the nation. We've been given approval, earned approval by each of those departments of ed individually, which I think helps provide a context to the work as we look to see which states we feel are progressive in their work and how we can steal great things from some states, implement into other states. It provides us kind of a holistic look at the education

[04:45:39] landscape, having that footprint. But our program outline generally, as kind of a broad stroke is when someone enrolls in our program they're given asynchronous coursework the canvas LMS platform that is what's been accredited by CAPE as they look through our curriculum set it is asynchronous so individuals can log in and learn at their own pace and it is also instructor supported and graded so we have live practitioners going in looking at all the assignments the essays all the different myriad of ways we assess our teachers those are done by

[04:46:13] Virginia certified trained teachers real time throughout the coursework and then we through just the way HB 2486 established this work is we have a unique way we partner with school districts typically in 16 other other states we lead out in all the efforts for field supervision so we actually contract retired teachers and administrators we calibrate them we trained them and then they go out into the field into the school districts that we partner with with. However, Virginia is a unique model in which requires us to partner with our divisions

[04:46:49] for the in the field supervision. And I would say, having seen it work in 16 other states, I'm very pleased with the way Virginia has taken the stance to require those partnerships that I think deepen the story and the collaboration that we have with our divisions. And we'll talk more about that later. But I would say from my perspective, I think it provides a a really progressive look at the collaboration between division partners and the work that ITech is doing.

[04:47:16] And so again, kind of to wrap up our overview, they have the online courses that they go through with ITech on the Canvas platform. And then we continue the support through partnership collaboration in the classroom during two semesters in the field.

[04:47:32] And then the last thing I would say here is we actually accept individuals at multiple points of entry, but primarily there's two. there's those that are seeking provisional. And so that's us trying to build a pipeline of new teachers into the field. They don't have a license now, they might be interested in teaching. And so we can bring them into the pipeline and help train them up, prepare them for their exams, and then work with our partners to see if there's a placement for them.

[04:47:54] The other is taking individuals who are licensed that need to be converted into the full license. And so we work with our partners to identify those individuals that are already teaching in the classroom that we then can train further. The next thing I wanted to talk about just kind of the landscape and then I'll hand it off to to my colleagues for sure but y'all y'all probably know this but reported out from our divisions is the the vacancy snapshots and the where they report the current needs in terms of certification areas and then reported by this board here is the unfilled

[04:48:30] teaching positions of 3157 which represents about 3.4 percent vacancy rate right now and what I wanted to maybe contrast that with is our year-over-year growth that we've had in the state and these are real small numbers I agree with you but if you look in the far left the blue bar represents 2024 the full calendar year 2024 and the green bar represents the calendar year up to date for 2025. I apologize that is year-to-date over year-to-date so that's not the

[04:49:07] full year. That's just the first five months compared to five months. But the first set of columns is their applications. And you'll see that the green bar is just over 2,000 applications that we've had into the iTeach program for the first five months of the year. The middle set of columns is our enrollments. And so we have individuals that apply, they have to submit all their documentation for evaluation program acceptance, and then they can enroll. That's that middle section. And the enrollments year to date are just

over a thousand individuals enrolled in the program. And that last column set is individuals that have been put or earned a teaching position those are hired

[04:49:44] individuals and that bar is roughly 400 and so what this i think speaks to as i see the data is that we see there's a need for teachers in the state and i believe that this data shows that given the optionality that i teach provides we can recruit individuals to fill these vacancies in a meaningful way. And with that, I'll turn it over to Dr. Estes to talk more about our placements. Thank you, Andrew, for the introduction and background information. And good afternoon, Chairman of the Board and Board members. It's a pleasure to be with you today and

[04:50:24] speak some more into what we're doing in the state of Virginia. As you heard the recap, really, of the top 10 critical shortage areas that have been identified by the school superintendents in their reporting. What I'd like to point out on this slide is how I teach finishers are filling those top 10 shortages upon completion of their licensure route with us. And so it's a nice alignment to see that you have a need and the finishers coming out of our program are falling into those categories and addressing those needs. So I apologize. I know it's kind

[04:51:00] small, you have it on your screen and I'm sure you're familiar with the top shortage areas being in elementary and special education, mathematics, middle grades, CTE, and we're very proud to see teachers coming in and finishing successfully in those needed areas. Additionally, we often are asked, especially through ABTEL, I know has had great interest and played a role in working through you know licensure options and the question has come up about where are our finishers or where are our participants across the state and so this slide is meant to speak to that for you

[04:51:39] to highlight not the applications and the enrolled as much as our finishers and so i think it's great to see some of the larger divisions you can tell henrico has a huge amount of participation and we're going to speak to their model and why they are so successful a little bit later but then it's kind of fun to see some of the smaller divisions from around the state have finishers and you know you it just gives you a picture of where the divisions are that are supporting their folks to get them across the finish line there are many other finishers that are not on this

[04:52:15] slide but they are smaller numbers so about seven or less across the state and some of those other divisions but these are our top ten that we thought you might like to see where they are. So this slide is really to paint a picture, if you will, about the type of candidates that we are bringing into the field through iTeach, through this route. And if any of you have been, you know, in the classroom or hiring or recruiting at the division level, one of the things that people are often concerned about are teachers passing the teacher exams. Can

[04:52:51] they pass the teacher exams, the licensure exams? It feels like it can be high stakes and high pressure sometimes. And personally coming from HR as my most recent position in the public school setting, I found this to be really fascinating. Our candidates coming into iTeach, seeking a provisional license to go into teaching, are passing the teacher exams very successfully, and on average are 21 points higher than what the minimum requirements are. And I personally process those scores.

[04:53:23] And I cannot tell you how exciting it is to see the 190s and the 200s and the type of candidates that are coming in with those scores from previous work life and career fields and experience. And so it's a testament to their content knowledge.

[04:53:40] And it matches very well with us helping them develop their teacher pedagogy and professional studies. I think that's exciting data. And then I'm going to turn it over to Dr. Gaffney. Thank you, Dr. Estes.

[04:53:55] you board members and superintendent for this chance to speak I get to have the fun job I get to go out and work with the school divisions and really support their needs it's impactful work I've been a lifelong educator in Virginia since I graduated from UVA just a few years ago triple who so I like to share that data but really excited about the work we're doing so we know the praxis is a challenge to get people into teaching some would say it's a barrier we've seen great success with the praxis through our support of passage

[04:54:31] preparation and so we have a study that was done with Texas A&N it was definitely an in-house study but they supported the setup they also supported the work that was done during the study and in that study it shows it was done in Texas, it shows that candidates who went through the passage preparation were almost 80% more likely to pass on the first try. That's compelling data, and our school divisions here in Virginia are seeing these same results. Quite honestly, I was a little nervous about

[04:55:09] the pathway of you have to take the praxis before the courses, and so passage prep has really shown that that is is removing that barrier we have several of our districts because it is going so well that they have put a partnership together with passage prep because they want to be able to offer this to people who are not in I teach so we're really excited about the work that is happening with passage preparation and how that is supporting our teachers I think I push

[04:55:44] the arrow up nope it was I told you I told you Rob I'd mess it up all right um yes please thank you madam president just you said so I want to make sure you were saying that that people who how do we know did you pre-test I'm just a little confused did you pre-test these people on the praxis because you're saying they're passing at a much higher rate because of your program but how do we know they're not just candidates who are more likely to pass at a higher rate particularly Some of these, we've got one or two candidates, they probably are like, I'm really good at biology, so I'm going to go.

[04:56:22] So you were, I was just curious what's behind that claim. Great question. So the study that I'm speaking about was done in Texas. It's not a study that's been done here in Virginia. So what Dr. Estes shared, those 20 points above, that is not really connected to passage, or at least we don't have evidence of that.

[04:56:41] To your point, we don't have that evidence yet. We want to get it because we are hearing from our division partners, wow, the folks who are going through passage are really doing very well. They're passing the praxis, and so that's super important.

[04:56:58] In the study that was done in Texas, it is the first time someone has taken the praxis, so they have that data, it's their first time. To answer a little deeper about passage prep, they start with a diagnostic test, they give them feedback they set a study plan and then they work through modules very similar to iTeach so they're taking a course they're really focusing on understanding and then they also take praxis sample questions they have a huge test bank so they can go in and take as many as they want if i could interject yeah please in the texas study just we had a control group

[04:57:38] okay so okay okay sure compare okay thank you yes that was quick i went in virginia just to be clear you can't just challenge the praxis you have to go through some route whether uh traditional

certification program some other alternative route or something like passage right for the i teach the way we were approved they have to show their content knowledge by passing the praxis sultan can you i'm just not understanding what's the connection between the passage preparation

[04:58:10] program and i teach yes so we offer wraparound supports we're not just modules for the classes We know that our candidates have to pass the praxis to show their content knowledge, other than special education.

[04:58:26] And so we offer passage preparation as a tool to support them. So they get free access to passage preparation when they're in iTeach so that they are more likely to pass the praxis.

[04:58:45] - Included in what they're paying you. - Yes, yes. Yeah, great questions. Any other questions on passage prep? It's pretty exciting and divisions are really excited about it in Northern Virginia. I was asked back in the fall, November, at the VAS conference from Prince William, saying, hey, we have a lot of English language learners, a lot of Spanish speaking candidates, they can't pass the praxis, can you support us?

[04:59:12] I went back to the president of passage and said, hey, any chance this can be in Spanish and other languages? They have now put it into 100 different languages, but not the test questions, because on the Praxis, they're going to have to do it in English.

[04:59:29] But they can learn the content, and we know that's best practice for ELLs, and so they can learn the content in their native speaking language, and then they have to translate, and so they're having a better opportunity to pass. We don't have data on that yet, but I think that could be compelling.

[04:59:46] So passage is responding to the needs of the divisions. All right, I think that was that. I think that one thing is like I said, we get to share a lot of stories and this support that is happening with our candidates, we're able to hear that they get to go into teaching a career they never thought they had.

[05:00:11] And this quote here is from Walter. We just thought it would be helpful for you to see. We hear this all the time, and I'm gonna share a lot of other examples later, but I just thought it is exciting to see people having the opportunity to pass the praxis and giving them the support to do it.

[05:00:36] - I think the only thing I would like to add to round out this topic is that passage preparation is done very thoughtfully with regard to student outcomes. So it is not just about passing a test, even though that's kind of how it sounds a little bit, But they have framed it so that the teachers going through the courses are going to be familiar with the goals and the standards for student outcomes.

[05:01:00] And so it's framed in that. And I think that's a really important element because we want them to understand what their students will need to learn in their content area in which they're so knowledgeable. All right, so a little bit about advanced studies and accreditation.

[05:01:16] This one really, truly excites me. I share this all the time in our feedback. Every single candidate that finishes in ITeach completes a feedback survey for us. And one of the questions, well, there's so many, there's so many good ones, but one of them asked them about, do you intend to stay in education for five years?

[05:01:36] Will you stay for 10 years? What about continuing education? Will you go on? 73% of our teachers say they intend to pursue advanced studies, a master's degree or higher. And I think that this speaks volume to the role that we can play as an alternate route to licensure.

[05:01:55] We can help bring teachers to the classroom with the teacher pedagogy and background and knowledge that they need to be successful to start their career. And once they're there, school systems often support their continuing education financially, and they're committed to going on and adding to their knowledge and their studies.

[05:02:14] So I think that's a great bridge to higher education, and it speaks to the caliber and the desire for people to go on and continue to learn. So that's always exciting to me. I love to share that data. We encourage them to think about the universities.

[05:02:29] We would love to expand and feature partnerships with Virginia-based institutions. Of course, we have partnerships with American College of Education, who has vetted all of our coursework and offers some level of credit in college credits coming into their programs.

[05:02:49] But we recently partnered with Regent University and I'll let Dr. Gaffney talk a little bit more about that. But it is something that we feel strongly about, supporting them to continue on and make that bridge. - Thanks, Dr. Estes.

[05:03:05] Some of you recall when you were on the board when we were initially getting approved, one of the concerns was what kind of impact is this gonna have on our universities and colleges? And we were able to look at the data and say, well, they're not going there anyway. So here's an alternative route to get people into teaching.

[05:03:24] The question is, is there a way to support our universities on the back end? And I believe we're already showing that answer is yes. This data that Dr. Estes just shared with more candidates wanting to get a master's, we're seeing that with ACE.

[05:03:41] In conversations as we work at job fairs and information sessions with our divisions, engaging in conversations with our other universities, we've said, hey, we have a good amount of people who want to get a master's, how can we partner with you?

[05:04:00] And so the first partner that was really interested in this is at Regents, Kurt Creasing, the Dean of Education. And he said, he happened to say that his wife is I think a reading specialist, And I can't remember if she's in the Tidewater region, one of the larger schools there.

[05:04:17] But she had said, you know, we're getting a lot of these I teach candidates. And he's like, well, what are they like? And she said, well, honestly, they're already in our schools. They're our long-term subs or our aides. So they're great. And they love the coursework. They love the responsiveness. And so when we were at a job fair, I met Dr. Crease and I said, hey, listen, why don't we talk about what a partnership could look like?

[05:04:42] because we have people who want to get a master's we can't give a master's as dr estes said we want to be that bridge and so he was all ears they we met with them several times they met with our curriculum team they vetted our courses and they said we can give the most amount of credit 12 hours towards all different uh master options the one i was really excited about is the opportunity for leadership for developing more principles and so they are partnering with us we have a meeting Tuesday really moving this forward we've had

[05:05:19] conversations with several other universities and they just didn't get on it as quickly but we want them to so we're excited about what this is going to look like and here is the page that is on the

regents website that shows the partnership I'm going to share in a little bit a flyer a paper flyer I love paper sorry it's my age and so you're going to touch it but it'll show you the different coursework and possibilities so if you know of any universities who you think would want to partner with us please have them reach out that would be

[05:05:53] terrific any questions about that all right CAPE alignment thank you I wanted to give an update or some context to our CAPE approval for those who are unaware, CAPE is the preeminent approver and accreditor of Teacher Prep Pathways.

[05:06:16] Most of the universities in Virginia that offer teacher certification, UVA, Virginia State, George Mason, they all have CAPE accreditation. We sought CAPE accreditation back in 2009 when it was first called NCATE. They opened up, they had a change in 2009 that allowed for non-institutes of higher ed to pursue this accreditation. At the time, we were the first and for the better part of 15 years the only provider that went through the accreditation process and achieved accreditation.

[05:06:45] As we stand today, there are two non-institutes of higher ed that have been approved by CAPE. We were the first. We were approved in 2010 or 2012 was when their cycle ended and then we had a renewal in 2019.

[05:07:00] The CAPE approval cycle is seven years. It can be up to seven years if you have full approval. We earned a seven-year approval in 2019, which triggers the cycle to repeat itself in the upcoming years. And so right now, we are currently under the work. We have established an in-house team to do all the data retrieval and analysis to conduct our self-study.

[05:07:21] That will be submitted to CAPE in the spring of 2026. Then we have some back-and-forth iterations around that data set, culminating in a spring 2027 site visit and then we're confident that in fall of 2027 we will earn the seven-year approval again, hopefully with no AFIs with that approval.

[05:07:40] One of the unique aspects of CAPE as it is regarding Virginia is CAPE has determined the Virginia data set to be out of scope from our self-study. So I wanted to talk a little bit about what that means and the implications of that.

[05:07:56] First, what in scope means from a CAPE perspective is that everyone through our different programs go through the same key assessments. So we have these kind of milestones as you go through the program that are key assessments. If everyone in the population is not taking all the key assessments, it's considered out of scope because they don't have the full trajectory in the longitudinal study to go through all the key assessments.

[05:08:20] One of our key assessments in the 16 other state operations is the field experience, the pre and post survey the impact student impact system that we do when we're conducting the supervision ourself because of the rule from the general assembly we the way it was designed partnerships as i mentioned earlier are in collaborations with divisions so we do not take the lead on establishing what those key assessments are in the field placements unfortunately we just don't have that opportunity the way it was structured again i compliment virginia for restructuring it that way, but it puts in conflict the data set as it pertains to in-scope versus

[05:08:59] out-of-scope of CAPE. And so the Virginia data set, again, is not in scope for our self-study. The implications of that is this. CAPE is very clear that they do not approve programs. They approve the provider. So we have, call it 17, 18 different programs that we operate. CAPE is looking to accredit the

overall provider so it's going to take data from indiana and texas and louisiana and then based on all of the different programs roll that up into a cape accredited provider

[05:09:34] i teach will be in fall of 2027 reapproved as a cape accredited provider the program of virginia will not be in the data set for the provider accreditation that being said we've already worked and had many conversations with the Department of Ed of how we are already taking that data set. So when we actually disaggregate all the data and you look at the slides and the sheets, there's a tab for every one of our states, all of our programs. We're including Virginia all the same. So all the data that CAPE is requesting that we are disaggregating, we are doing that full measure with all of Virginia data and we will be providing it to

[05:10:13] the CAPE lead at the Department of Ed so that this is as full transparent as we can so that But the data we're working to get is being seen by the board, the department, everything else. But I just wanted to clarify as we go through the process, one of the stipulations for our approval was to be a CAPE accredited provider.

[05:10:32] We fully maintain and will be continued as a CAPE accredited provider. If anything needs to evolve around the supervision or if CAPE needs to evolve around what their key assessments are, I think those are conversations we'd love to engage with. But as we sit now, I just wanted to give you an update on where we are in the CAPE process, the CAPE cycle, and how it's kind of unique to the Virginia model. Happy to answer any questions. It can be confusing. If not, we can continue to hear some of what's happening in the field. And I'm going to turn this over to Laura. Thank you. All right. Again, from the field, I feel

[05:11:09] like I get the fun things to share with you. In addition to collecting teacher feedback from completing their programs. We ask their administrators to rate them and give feedback about them being prepared as teachers completing the I-Teach program. As of today, you know, principals are incredibly busy. This is a crazy time of year. It's challenging to get their time and energy and feedback, but I'm happy to report that we're over 25% response rate for our 300 finishers that we have to date since we have been implemented in the state of

[05:11:45] Virginia and it's really fun to see the comparison of what the teachers feel their experience was to prepare them for our classrooms and then their principals also rating them and I think no one here would be surprised principals are a little bit more conservative but if you think about the key areas where we're asking them to rate themselves do you feel prepared for the classroom are Are you knowledgeable about using data to inform your instruction?

[05:12:13] Are you prepared to work with diverse populations? And just it runs the gamut. And the teachers overwhelmingly say, you know, it's eight or nine or higher is what they're rating their preparedness as. And the principals are slightly more conservative between seven and on average eight.

[05:12:31] And so I think that that does speak volumes to how they feel they're prepared coming out of our program. And as we saw earlier with continuing education goals, we know they're not done. But that's a great start for entering the profession.

[05:12:48] Now, we often, you know, we love to triangulate data and have all of the sources that we can to buoy the results that we have. We had a lot of feedback and input from HR and school leaders at the division level prepared for you.

[05:13:05] I think Dr. Gaffney is gonna share some individual statements with you towards the end. But we decided at this point to highlight a case study for you. It's incredibly valuable information from Henrico County Public Schools. As one of the largest participants in this route and the largest number of finishers, as you saw earlier, their information is really valuable to us. And they began with their first year. They decided to focus on secondary only. At that time, they only used our pathway. And as some of you

[05:13:40] may remember, we were working through clearing up information and strengthening our special education route, elementary as example. And so they focused in on secondary. And then this year, they added in and folded in more elementary and special education participants.

[05:13:58] And so the data that they have, we actually partnered with them recently to present their model at the vast conference. Thank you, Dr. Gaffney. And so this is really their work. I'm highlighting their work for them. I feel like this is not just I teach work. This is their work. But what they were focused on when they implemented this route was not just recruiting teachers. They were actually really focused on reducing teacher turnover. You know the amount of cost that goes into training, onboarding and getting someone started as a new teacher. And when they choose

[05:14:36] not to stay after a couple of years, it's an incredible loss. And so their focus was on reducing that turnover and increasing the teacher rate. And so some of the data that they shared that they were most excited about was we all experienced a greater, you know, exit from education post COVID during COVID and post COVID. And so their data points here were that they are reducing the retention rate or reducing the turnover rate and increasing the number of teachers that are staying on pre COVID levels, and then continuing to increase

[05:15:14] that success. And so they were excited about this. I think the other thing that they were really excited about was the number of teachers who were on provisional license. You know, that's a huge task to help people clear the hurdle to get their fully renewable license. It's a tall order. And so they were excited to see that while they had a large number of people teaching in the school system on a provisional license, that this pathway was clearly helping them move to the finish line, finish their requirements, and be fully licensed. And so it's been a wonderful

[05:15:51] partnership. I do believe that Dr. Gaffney likes to add a few more details. So I'll turn it over to you because I know you want to add. Well, I think what we see is, to Andrew's point, we're doing it different in the Commonwealth. And that's not a bad thing. My doctorate's in curriculum instruction. I had a student teacher. I had a teacher beside me the whole time I was learning how to become a teacher. Our teachers don't have that. So the divisions are having to provide them that mentorship and that support. Now, oftentimes the candidates are older,

[05:16:29] so they're a little more experienced than we were in our early 20s. But Henrico is what I would consider the model here in Virginia. And you should have seen our room at the conference where everybody came to see what they're doing so they are great about sharing the work out with everyone but basically they provide mentorship and they have monthly meetings and they offer this ongoing support and they know are these teachers that we can develop or are they not and by looking at that

[05:17:04] data you can see that they're really having a great experience with it we have so many uh and I'm not going to read all of these to you. I'll give you a big one. What you're going to get is 25 just letters of support from some of our divisions who had time to put a letter together, who are passionate about what

we're doing. The top is just a flyer with Regents that they're sharing out, and so all the rest are just letters of support of the work that we're doing. Dr. Estes

[05:17:41] and I spend most of our Saturday mornings going to job fairs across Virginia and we get to hear the stories. I was at Newport News about two weeks ago and a candidate came up to me and she said, I'm a special ed aide and I really want to be a special ed teacher. She said, I was on the provisional. I took the one course you need to become a special ed teacher. I took that course, but I couldn't afford to do the rest of them.

[05:18:13] And I looked at her and I said, I'm about to make your day. And she said, really? And so I said, here's the deal. I said, first of all, Newport News is going to pay for you to be in this program. So it's not going to cost you another dime. You're already on a provisional.

[05:18:28] You can be teaching right now. So I said, Kim Hammond, HR super, get over here. I've got a teacher for you. This teacher went Saturday from an aide to Monday to the classroom lead teacher. Do you know what a difference that is in that person's life?

[05:18:48] How that helps them get in compliance? We have story after story that we get to hear. And it's part of why we jump out of bed at 6 a.m. on a Saturday morning and race up to Fairfax and Loudoun and down to Newport News and Virginia Beach.

[05:19:05] and we meet with these candidates because one they want to see a live person they want to tell us their stories with all the federal layoffs in northern virginia fairfax had a fair for them and they came and now they have the opportunity to become a licensed teacher we had a candidate in arlington who was a department chair there they had a doctorate in physics and they could not get licensed. So it was there last year. iTeach came on, he finished the professional studies courses,

[05:19:39] passed the praxis in no time, and now is able to remain a licensed teacher. So we have these compelling stories, story after story, and Dr. Estes is going to share a little bit more about what we hear from our HR directors on a daily basis. I think it's very common sense, you know, They see this as a route that's helping them meet their needs in many ways.

[05:20:08] And then they're very transparent with, well, we could use you for this too. We could really use this. Do you have this? Could you support us with these areas? And so we get emails regularly, phone calls in person when we're out on site. We hear from large and small districts.

[05:20:25] And we also hear from other institutions, private accredited schools and public day schools. And so we'll talk a little bit more about those things. But I think it's important to recognize that this route that you all have approved and offered to our school divisions is making a difference and so much so that they're now back asking, can you do a little more?

[05:20:49] Can you help us in these ways? And so we have requests from the divisions for elementary add-on endorsement and special education add-on endorsement. And so I know I'll turn it back over to Dr. Gaffney in a second to add on to this, but what I can tell you is that people often will choose a pathway and teach and then realize, oh, I really like working with this population.

[05:21:16] And so could I just add on, you know, can I take a few more classes and change my license to add that on? And so we get that request. We're very happy to explore it with you and ABTEL in looking at

how might we meet that need and recognizing the content areas and the time teaching in order to make those transitions.

[05:21:37] And so that's one of the main asks that we see regularly. And I'll let Dr. Gaffney speak to the rest of them. - Thanks, just to, I mean, every day we get asked about early childhood. I mean, they just cannot fill this position. So I know Rob, we've talked a lot about what that can look like.

[05:21:56] There's certain requirements for that that aren't for other special ed areas that seem to need to be addressed. So we're excited to hear about that. CTE agriculture is the one, I was at region six meeting on Friday of last week, and they are like, we have got to get ag teachers.

[05:22:15] We have people qualified. We have people graduating from Virginia Tech thinking they're gonna be able to be an ag teacher. They haven't had the professional studies courses. All we need from you is the professional studies courses and for them to pass the praxis. We know they're qualified.

[05:22:30] And so there's a lot of frustration about that one. We also hear all the time from our public day schools and from private schools. People want to get their license. We know that licensed teachers impact student learning.

[05:22:48] We know that putting in front of our children licensed teacher is oftentimes going to be more effective in the classroom and so we hear about this New Horizons Rob is price sick of me putting it in his inbox but they reach out all the time saying you know we work with Hampton they're approved can our teachers go through I teach Williamsburg but they put it in their letter they're like we have got to get New Horizons able to have their teachers license so we hear these things day in and day out and so

[05:23:20] we do want to support in other areas and our divisions want that as well so thank you so I get to close this out I appreciate the 30 minutes or so you gave us I think I was told 20 so I was I took too much time and I apologize for that I'd like just to you can read the closing bullets there but I would say this is I'm extremely proud of Dr. Gaffney and Dr. Exodus what they're doing in the schools I'm extremely proud of our instructors who labor day in and day out with our students being trained and with our partners who are taking an innovative approach to I think mold and train, cultivate great teachers for the sake of students. I have three little boys

[05:23:59] and I take very personally the work that I give teachers every day to do and help educate my boys so I take it very personally and the idea of being asked to do more is kind of a resounding thing not just in Virginia. I was in Baton Rouge last month and I was talking to Superintendent at Cade Brumley, and his quote to me was, I need you to do more. And I was like, can you explain what that means more? But there's an ask that I teach, continue to help strive to improve the teacher education landscape. And I think my maybe proof point of all this happened this morning. I

[05:24:36] was taking an Uber ride, and I haven't even told the ladies here. I was taking an Uber ride to meet them for lunch, and my driver asked what I do for a living, and I get to, with great pride, say, "I hope to train the best teachers for students." And he said, "That's interesting. I just heard that Chesterfield is getting better teachers these days."

[05:24:55] And so I was like, "If I can be a part of that context and that story being told, then it's a good day's work." And I'm proud to be able to stand before you to tell you what work we've done and our commitment to continue doing even better work in the future. So I appreciate it. Thank you all very much.

[05:25:12] - Are there any questions? Ms. Holton. - Hi, thank you for that presentation. It's terrific to hear the feedback a couple of years into your work in Virginia. One specific that we discussed when you all were back before us almost two years ago was that there were gaps that the department had identified in your special ed curriculum in terms of matching, aligning with what's required by our regulations.

[05:25:43] And I believe the department, the superintendent, the then superintendent was setting you up to work with CSEP on helping address those gaps. Can you update us on your progress on that?

[05:26:04] Thank you for that. Proudly, when CSEP reviewed our courses, a couple of findings they have, and I believe it's on the VDOE website or you had it there for a while, a couple of things they shared about the review was they felt like a lot of the competency areas were in several of the courses. It wasn't just one, but it was in several. That is the same as what our professional studies in elementary showed as well. They did recommend two additional courses, and they recommended that we have our language arts course and our math course be part of

[05:26:41] the special ed curriculum. We added that in, having those additional courses. They don't take a praxis up front, but we do have the course that they need to take. Quite honestly, to get on a provisional through iTeach for special ed is a little more challenging.

[05:26:57] The traditional pathway, it's one course. For us, it's that course, plus an introductory course to online learning and licensure, how to be a professional teacher, all of those nuances. And then the other course is our TCVA 5100 that really focuses on school law.

[05:27:15] It focuses on classroom management, how to design and set up your classroom, how to establish the first 40 days and the rules for your classroom. That is an excellent course. We get such great feedback. So to get on a provisional with special ed, they do need to complete three courses, no praxis.

[05:27:33] They do take the reading praxis on the back end, just like everybody else does, and they do have access to passage preparation to help support that. So you've implemented the CSEP recommendations in full, And have you gone back, has CSEP gone back and done an evaluation confirming that you've met their recommendations?

[05:28:01] So other than they use us regularly to have their candidates in, it actually was not completed the approval until it'll be one year in January. And so they have not gone back and looked again. That was their recommendations. We implemented it, and it's going forward.

[05:28:18] It does take our elementary and special ed candidates 18 to 24 months to complete the program. So when you look at the data and you say, well, not that many people have finished, it's because secondary they can do in a year, but elementary and special ed with the additional courses.

[05:28:35] And our elementary language arts courses all line up with the Virginia Literacy Act. They have science of reading in them. I hear from HR directors and curriculum leaders saying, We love that you all have the Virginia Literacy Act embedded.

[05:28:51] Our teachers and I teach, they understand science of reading. They're implementing that in their classroom. They're also engaging in discussions and professional learning with other faculty members. Madam President. So thank you for that very useful information.

[05:29:07] I'm not competent to judge the curriculum of your special ed programs or anything else really but but it would be lovely if we had CSEP or frankly the department staff who flagged the issues in the first

place go back and just put that issue to bed I'm hearing you say you've met that met all the suggestions from CSEP so it would be lovely if somebody who is competent somebody independent who is competent to judge could go ahead and clarify that for us given the issues that were raised back when you all were coming through it.

[05:29:42] Go ahead, Dr. Ackerman. You actually addressed slightly one of my questions about the reading assessment. I didn't see the data for how they're performing on the reading assessment on your slide 9. I don't know if perhaps you didn't collect that yet, but I was happy to hear you had a preparation for it.

[05:30:02] Yes, I'm happy to address that. As part of the program requirements to enroll and ultimately finish, they must pass their content area praxis. is the main one that we collect. The teaching reading elementary exam is in addition to for elementary folks and for special ed general curriculum K-12. So I honestly did not ask for that data, but I can certainly see if we have it available. I think the trick is they don't have to report it to us because it's not part of our licensure requirement, but we could certainly consider that, collecting and having that for you. And if I may, I know

[05:30:41] We don't have the specific information, Ms. Holton, that you were asking about in terms of updated ratings on how the special ed teachers are doing, but I do have one data point that I did not get to share with you, which is when you ask the school principals rate how you feel your IT teachers are doing in terms of impacting student achievement, it's an average rating of just over 8 out of 10.

[05:31:08] And so I think that does speak volumes to our finishers, including the special education teachers as well. MS. Rob, you might be able to answer this question. But would it be just easy enough for there to be, I don't know, if the ITH team submitted a letter to CSEP to say we implemented these things, and whether or not there was any response from CSEP, which would have made, hopefully, a difference to clarifying what Ms. Holton was requesting.

[05:31:39] Okay. Thank you. MS. Dr. Northern? So I realize that the program is different in Virginia, and that's what I want to talk a little bit about.

[05:31:57] I did bring up the study in Texas just because I was curious about it, and it's mixed. Obviously, you guys have read it. One in four Texas students are being taught by teachers prepared fully online, more than I thought. I don't know what we are in Virginia. That would be a good statistic to know.

[05:32:14] Students taught by teachers online exhibit comparable levels of achievement to those taught by uncertified teachers but they underperformed compared to students taught by teachers from other preparation pathways and they have a higher turnover rate so i guess you know i know you guys do your own due diligence and collect your own data but what are you seeing in virginia on turnover rates relative to uncertified teachers relative to teachers who are traditionally prepared that's a great insightful question dr northern is that the ut study okay so a couple

[05:32:47] things one the ut study includes one of the other providers in the state of texas that is actually i'm sorry i didn't mean to interrupt it's okay texas tech it's the jacob kirksey yep yep i've definitely met with jacob um they they include uh one of the other providers in the program that's three times our size that's currently on probation with the state um and so i think that might skew some of the data if i'm being just candid with you on terms of retention i think the data point shown earlier within RICO is since partnering with us the last two years we've dropped their attrition by a third in terms of the teacher turnover and so anecdotally sometimes tracking

[05:33:26] teachers longitudinally becomes challenging but what we're seeing in the Virginia partnerships is great impact on teacher turnover and keeping teachers in the classroom and I would say I can send this to you but Louisiana Board of Regents did a retention study and we performed at least as well as all other university routes in the state of louisiana in terms of the three-year and five-year retention and so i think there's there's other data points that we can look at dr northern are you good and do you have any data on relative to the students performance

[05:34:01] we do not have a concrete impact of student learning data in virginia yeah but again the same report from the board of regents shows our impact of student learning we actually outperform on the compass measurement in louisiana most of the other programs in the state of louisiana so where there is impact on student learning data being each state kind of does it differently and i think there's some successes and misses but where we do have the ability to get that information it is pretty positive when looking at our marks last question does the doctor um maybe this is a

[05:34:38] question for the superintendent do we collect data on our it teachers like do we know which which ones are being prepared from iTeach? - Rob.

[05:35:15] - Okay, that'll be great to do going forward, awesome. - Any other questions or comments? - Superintendent Gullickson. - Thank you, President Creasy. I just wanna reiterate what I've heard from the field, being able to engage with principals and the superintendents who are so grateful that this is an alternative pathway to get high quality candidates into our classrooms.

[05:35:42] And it has not even been two years since you were approved, which I think is important. And Member Holton, thank you for flagging that. July marks that vote 'cause that was my first board meeting from the Secretary of Ed's side. And so I think demand is through the roof.

[05:35:58] I think you had one bold superintendent or a few that first meeting in July of '23. And so this is a testament to the fact that your program is very high quality. I've heard rave reviews, so we look forward to continuing to look at next steps on the department side and collecting more of that student data to help tell that story of impact.

[05:36:18] So thank you for all you're doing. - Thank you all so much for being here today. We truly appreciate it. Okay, we're going to go to item B.

[05:36:34] Do our item B presenters need time to, and we do have some snacks and other rations over here in the room to the left.

[05:36:52] Maybe we ought to give it three minutes

[05:36:55] to get our presentations for item b up okay three minutes guys we are jumping back in to item b

[05:43:48] followed by item c and then we will wrap for the day we will move item d and item f to tomorrow so that everybody is aware of that we will do um item d item f tomorrow um and we're going to put this tomorrow too or we will um have concluding remarks after item c today thank you it's all you dr wallace

[05:44:21] right well not all me it's all my team so i am excited again to bring to you updates this set of updates will be from our history and social sciences team i am really excited to have dr bird Wright with us. She has been leading the history work in the department. And as President Creasy and some others of

you know, we have been very, very deep involved in the instructional guides and providing those to the Commonwealth. And we have also started doing some training around those

[05:44:59] guides. Dr. Bird Wright is going to bring you those updates from the history team. And she's also going to tell you about these wonderful booklets that you have in front of you that RBM provided through our VA 250 program. But this is a very, very special booklet. So she's going to talk to you about that. And we had a press, we actually had a presentation yesterday of the artwork at the Capitol where families from across the state came. And we did a press release on it. So hopefully you're able to check that press release out. Maybe this evening after

[05:45:35] you're recuperating from the meeting but without further ado I'm going to turn it over to Dr. Bird Wright and she's going to provide you with an update from our last meeting where we talked about the instructional guides how they were being developed and what we were doing with them and where we're going from from this point forward. Thank you. Thank you Dr. Wallace and good afternoon President Creasy, Superintendent Gullickson and to the board. I am very pleased to be before you today to give you a status update about the release of the history and social science

[05:46:10] instructional guides, as well as the professional learning plan for leaders and educators across the Commonwealth. And there's the pause, and now it's back.

[05:46:26] And now we're back. And so in summary today, you can see the overview of the presentation. I will be reviewing the purpose and the components of the history and social science instructional guides, the timeline of communication and professional learning plan for the field and ongoing feedback and support from our external partners and our division leaders.

[05:46:46] I first certainly want to acknowledge the tremendous work of our history and social science team that's led by Kristonya Brown, our history and social science coordinator, as well as our specialist, Andrea Emerson, as well as Brandy McCracken.

[05:47:05] So the work of the history and social science program is aligned to Virginia's strategic priorities, particularly priority one, to set and help every learner meet high expectations. And so as you can see on the slide before you, we've identified those high leverage actions that are denoted in bold that ground the work within the constructs and context of the Virginia's strategic priorities.

[05:47:31] So to recap the purpose of the History and Social Science Instructional Guides, they were approved April 2023. The standards were with expected full implementation to take place beginning the 25-26 school year. The history and social science instructional guides, they elevate the previous curriculum frameworks.

[05:47:50] The components of these guides help to support local curriculum development, the application of history and social science skills, and use inquiry-based practices that signal the use of information sources, questions, and tasks. You'll see those components come up as we get into that a little bit later in this presentation.

[05:48:08] There is one instructional guide per course or grade level, and the instructional guides were released weekly on our History and Social Science webpage. The structure of the instructional guides is similar across content areas and familiarity from the previous curriculum frameworks.

[05:48:28] So in continuation there with the purpose of our instructional guides, one is really to have an increase in rigor and depth, and those are the global revisions that you will will see within those instructional guides. And I know Jill talked about some light reading. Well, you all are in for a treat because you certainly can take, let me see, I think she said Friday, Saturday, Sunday, so now you've got the rest of all of the week of Memorial Week to continue on reading our instructional guides if you have not dug into them already.

[05:48:56] But the global revisions really are there to increase rigor and depth and improve vertical coherence. You'll see that between the great levels and the courses. The application and connections of concepts and themes within and across grade levels, as well as incorporating inquiry-based practices and embedding the social science strands into history content, including the civics, geography, and economic strands.

[05:49:22] So just to recap, you remember during our March 26 board work session, the timeline of the development of the history and social science instructional guides began soon after the adoption of the 23 history and social science standards of learning.

[05:49:39] The milestones here are denoted for you to illustrate that development has been underway for two years. I also wanna get into our feedback loop here with our external partners and division leaders.

[05:49:54] Again, that work is not new. That work started spring of '24 from April to June 2024. And you will see that input and feedback has been provided by over 40 external partners. And I'm just going to name a few, Virginia Association of Museum Educators, the Virginia Tribal Consortium, and the United Jewish Federation of Tidewater, just to name a few. Surveys were also conducted with various teacher leader groups and were provided to inform and support questions about the instructional guides and the expectations for implementation throughout. The feedback received informed the

[05:50:31] development of an extensive FAQ document, which you can also see on our History and Social Science webpage just above those wonderful instructional guides. And that is also found on our webpage and supports the implementation and the appropriate use of the guides.

[05:50:47] And I want to stop there just for a moment. It's very important that people understand the appropriate use of the guide for implementation for instructional delivery. And I'll get into that shortly as we talk about those components. I also want to share with you that we have already been engaging in regional professional learning and support. In fact, just yesterday we had 126, I'll repeat that, 126 division leaders with us to just start to unpack the components of the instructional guides, which was wonderful. We've already started with regional development, particularly just this

[05:51:22] week, with regions 1 and 8 as well. Throughout the course of the spring into the summer and into the fall, we've been working with our regional history and social science leaders, Assistant Superintendents of Instruction, to begin to have those meetings put in place on our calendar, and I can tell you we are chock full.

[05:51:40] So we will get our mileage and our ways we'll be going over the next several weeks here. I also want to bring your attention to our partnership with Virginia 250. So now you can go ahead and pick up these lovely booklets that you see before you.

[05:51:56] We had the awesome experience of working with about over 100 students that had submissions to the Expressions of Freedom competition, so students had the opportunity to submit either essays,

artwork, poetry, to talk about what does freedom mean to them.

[05:52:16] And when I tell you, yesterday was such a moving ceremony to honor 11 students. We had eight regional representation from our superintendent's regions, and then we also had three overall winners representing from elementary, middle, and high school.

[05:52:32] But if you just take a gander to go through the booklet, and I certainly won't do this. This is, again, attached to your light reading with our instructional guides all of next week. But please make sure that you take the time to read those artist statements. In fact, just before coming out here, we had a wonderful testimony from one of our parents who said, and this is from one of our fourth graders, and she said about her daughter, it's very emotional, it's very moving because we've worked with these students, and she said, my daughter felt so validated and honored just to be recognized.

[05:53:02] This was a fourth grader. Our First Lady Youngkin was also present, as well as Carly Fiorina was also there, who is the National Chair for America 250. So we really had the opportunity to engage with the families. But again, we're working with our external partners and they are providing contributions as well and will be with our external partners and organizations process that we will engage in over the summer as we are gathering additional resources to support our instructional guides.

[05:53:31] So please keep this as a keepsake just for you and know how much this work has meant out for the field as well as for our families. We look to have this as an annual event. This was the second time and so we look to continue that tradition moving forward. So for the instructional guide components, you will see that we've moved from a static to a dynamic document as well, filled with primary sources.

[05:53:54] And so you see each of the components that are provided for you, the changes and revisions. This section provides a summary and overview of the changes, the revisions, the additions, the deletions, and the moved content. And for a complete list of the changes of the standards, we also have an embedded crosswalk that shows the difference between the 2015 standards to the 2023 standards of learning and really delineates with greater specificity the changes for each course.

[05:54:22] You'll also see there the skills and practice, that is the history and social science skills continuum. Again, that's going into framing the thinking around the themes that are used there for critical thinking to assist in the learning transferability of content and that vertical articulation piece to which I spoke to earlier.

[05:54:40] the standard. This section includes the history and social science understandings and the key concepts that assist teachers in planning the standards focused instruction. And then we have our concepts and connections. This section outlines the concepts and the supporting questions that transcend grade levels through the K-12 program as appropriate at each grade level. These concepts are big ideas that are interrelated and again support connections to illustrate commonalities and relationships, reflecting the content and practices that build within the discipline as well as connect across disciplines.

[05:55:16] And then you'll also see the last piece there on additional resources. These areas here, and you'll see that embedded under each standard, each of those sections will be expanded as we move forward with resources from the history and social science partners and educators, as I just referenced a little bit earlier.

[05:55:34] And after consultation and feedback, it's expected that this section will first be updated by January 2026. We already have a work plan in place. We are meeting with our external partners, actually

June 9th, and working with them in person as well as a virtual concurrent session.

[05:55:50] We have some of those that I just listed previously as external partners, but we certainly have quite a few that are going to be working with us to be providing resources, but again, staying out of the frame of our work of providing curriculum. So again, they're going to be providing resources to support. And then we will begin, of course, working into the board approved textbooks and high quality instructional material support, of course, after the review of that legislation and how it will impact us in history and social science.

[05:56:20] So the release of the instructional guides, well, you remember we were together March 26th? We provided you with the schedule and I am happy, very happy, to report that our instructional guides were released on time to the field with great feedback from the field from superintendents, assistant superintendents, and our teachers. We are excited. Oh, certainly you can applaud. Thank you, President Creasy. You definitely, certainly should be applauding with that. But we are so pleased that those have gone out to the field. There was a hunger for that. And we appreciate

[05:56:57] President Creasy, Superintendent Gullickson, but all of your support in helping to ensure that that happened for our team and for our teachers and leaders in the field. Jump in really quick. You certainly can. Yes, ma'am. I'm so incredibly proud of these instructional guides. I was a curriculum framework girl, and I truly believe the crosswalk that is here in every one of these instructional guides for history and social science makes the work so much more it's just

[05:57:37] so clear to teachers if I had been teaching this particular SOL and there's no change to that that particular content in that SOL I don't in that particular standard I don't have to I don't have to change my instructional practice with regard to that that particular standard I can move on to the next standard and see, okay, I've got to, I've got to add this here. I've got to add that there. That in particular, I feel like is so incredibly helpful to the field. You know, I know

[05:58:10] we had a lot of angst over the implementation of these new standards, but the work that the department staff has put in a labor of love is really not exactly saying I mean blood sweat tears and all of the other things is really what happened but I this is this is something that I am just truly and deeply incredibly proud of this work especially because I know it's going to support you know my friends and colleagues who are still in the classroom teaching this and

[05:58:49] those who are like, Grace, this is going to be crazy. You've got so many new standards. No, this is so helpful. This is game-changing work here. And so I just want to just double down on my thanks to you all. Thank you so much, President Creasy. And I will certainly echo that, you know, with our feedback that we had yesterday throughout the webinar that we had with our division leaders.

[05:59:15] They were typing in the chat, they were calling afterwards just saying, oh my goodness, thank you all so much for the ability to have questions that help us to frame our thinking, skills and practice to help us double down on the content, but then being able to interweave the appropriate skills to ensure that we are in alignment with the rigor and the relevance of what we have going on cognitively for our students.

[05:59:38] So I believe that this, I'm going to use your word and take it and coin it, it's a game-changer and we are excited about it. Thank you very much. You've coined it for today. Next is our timeline, just to let you know, so after we left off together in March, and how we're progressing forward.

[05:59:54] So you can see that timeline there, again, our History and Social Science Instructional Guides were released to the field as expected. You'll also see there that we have worked on an evaluation tool to help to vet resources as they are coming in. We're meeting with our external partners as I mentioned already in June, and then we will continue our summer of learning events going on throughout the course of this summer and then moving on into the fall. We are making sure that we share that information through all of our multiple means of communication, including the Virginia Education Update newsletter, as well as our social media platforms to get the word out

[06:00:33] there. We have ongoing professional learning that will take place around inquiry-based and instruction beginning in the fall, and then as I said before, we'll have our large-scale technical edit with those embedded resources beginning in January. So we're excited about what's coming forth and the communication that's being provided to the field.

[06:00:51] So our professional learning plan, we've already started, and as I've already mentioned that earlier, and that is we started in May here with our in-person and virtual regional professional learning events. We started just yesterday and a few days before that, but some of our major work here this this week and then they're already preparing, in fact they're doing some regional training today, the rest of the team, and then we're heading into tomorrow.

[06:01:13] But one of the things I want to just bring note as you're looking at this particular slide is always our alignment to the strategic priorities of the board and the comprehensive plan that's always articulated to our respective teams so they can understand the why behind the what and the how and how we plan to move forward.

[06:01:32] And then you'll also see our summer and our fall professional learning, we have some options now going by course. So we're really taking a stance and looking at those gray bands and going with some specificity there. So you'll see when those are going to be offered during in June and then we'll cycle back around in August so we can make sure we can hit those school divisions that may start a little bit earlier in the cycle and those that may start a little bit later in the cycle there. That's already been communicated to our division leaders through email, through social media, and again through our Virginia Education newsletter.

[06:02:03] And so we're excited about the responses and they have been quite many to join and be a part of this professional learning opportunity. And then as I said to you all too in the fall, we'll begin with our inquiry-based learning and you can see those items there that will be addressed during that time.

[06:02:20] Again to close that feedback loop, wanted to make sure that you see the support from our external partners. So we'll continue to provide and you'll also see when you cycle back one slide, we also do a needs assessment and survey just to understand what are the needs of the field. keeping our ears to the ground of what folks need to help to design, modify, or to adjust professional learning and how that will move forward with our instructional guides, the resources to inform that, as well as the side-by-side support that we will be giving to school divisions.

[06:02:49] External partners and organizations will contribute to those standards-aligned resources and we'll be using that evaluation tool. We're very excited about that as well. Then we'll continue to incorporate our work with VA 250, with their Education Steering Committee, who will also be a part and provide some continued impact and support with those resources as well. So we are excited in history and social

science. And with that, I believe that I am finished and certainly can stop to take any questions at this time. Are there any questions? Ms. Holton? Thank you, Dr. Birdreich.

[06:03:25] And I know the field is very grateful for the instructional guides and appreciate the work particularly that Superintendent Gullickson has done to help expedite the work, getting the work that you all have been working on for so long out to the field.

[06:03:42] I see in your final slide you made a reference to external partners and a vetting tool for reviewing external content. There is so much good content out there. I just had one comment and then one question.

[06:03:59] In my comment, I just wanted to share with my board members. I promised a group I spoke with on Saturday that I would report back to you all. I had the privilege of being part of a Brown v. Board of Education commemoration, not the one here in Richmond with all the governors, but I was in Harrisonburg.

[06:04:16] Yes, ma'am. This was really a remarkable student-led initiative from the students in Rockingham County who have an ongoing, the teachers there have an ongoing multi-year partnership with the Moten Museum and folks telling the Prince Edward County Brown v. Board story, but they have over the last couple of years uncovered the story of a judge and plaintiffs who brought cases from Charlottesville and Warren County to the Harrisonburg County Courthouse. And that judge actually, Judge John

[06:04:53] paul in 1956 and then again in 58 and 59 issued the earliest orders in virginia seeking to establish compliance with the brown v board finding and these students have gone back and found these plaintiffs and done this incredible professional quality 30-minute long documentary of oral history telling these folks story they have now gotten through the many many hoops they had to jump through to get a Virginia historic marker, which we unveiled in front of the courthouse on Saturday

[06:05:28] morning. And they've now got an exhibit at the Rockingham County History Museum, Rock History. All of this, you know, successions of students have done this as part of their civics and history education in high school. It's quite remarkable work. So I promised I would tell them, I would tell you uh you know we worry a lot about what's going on in public education these days and what's going on with our kids and cell phones etc my conclusion from watching these young people at work is the kids are all right our future is in good hands we just have to unleash it and enable it

[06:06:09] leading to my question i'm concerned that we i think i understand correctly that we don't yet have links in these guides to the incredible material that our museum educators and other external partners have out there i am from i've been helping the virginia museum of history and culture celebrate the virginia 250 through a number of different events i've been to there and uh and i've seen a little glimpse of what they've got ready you know they've got lesson plans they've got slides they've got activities they've got things that connect to museum

[06:06:44] experiences all aligned to the SOLs and ready to plug into these guides. What is there a problem? Why can't we get that done? And I don't mean just the Museum of History and Culture. I mean all your museum educators, all your partners. It feels like, you know, we've adopted these standards two years ago. I would love to see them yesterday embedded into these guides. Can you help me on this? I'm going to speak to that first because you sound like Secretary Gadara. Yes, I know.

[06:07:17] I see you at the 250 events all the time. However, what I'm going to tell you is that, yes, the main resources that are currently embedded into the standards, a lot of them are very direct primary resources.

[06:07:35] The secondary resources, if you go and actually look at the document, the instructional guide document, it notes at the bottom in each section that high-quality instructional materials and other resources are being built out there and we are in the process and these ladies, these beautiful ladies are working hard to put them all together and categorize them appropriately because exactly like you said, we have these types of opportunities that you spoke about in Harrisonburg. Those things come across all the time. These documents do have to be in something,

[06:08:12] you know, we talked about it being a living, continuing work in progress. And so those things are happening. Dr. Wallace spoke to it earlier, that these guides in every content area are being reviewed on a constant basis to add more to them. And upon release that information, when more is added, that's going to be communicated to the field via the newsletter that Superintendent Nick Gullickson sends out and then also on their content area websites to say hey newsflash there is more that's been added here please go back and look but we needed to get the the base level work

[06:08:51] to the field as soon as possible so that that crosswalk referencing for teachers on the exact standards and how they needed to be implemented for instructional purposes absolutely had to be in their hands so that they could prepare over the summer for what they had to do in the fall and so that was the immediacy of the project now um i don't want to use the word fluff but those abundant resources that do have the things like the materials that museums and other um you know other opportunities around our very full of history and culture state has to provide to

[06:09:31] our schools, they are able to start flooding us with that stuff at the department to say, here, we have an actual lesson plan from our museum that we do on, or that we've now aligned with these new standards that is on standard VUS 2, whatever, I'm just pulling one out.

[06:09:52] And so all of that is being sent to the department, and they are using and looking through those to make sure and the term vetted means they're going and putting it in the appropriate location it's not just kind of a throw it up against the wall and here's everything that teachers have to go through themselves we don't want them to have to do that work and so that's what our teams at the department are doing and they're continuing it every day but again that main document with at least as many resources as possible based on the timeline that we had that we wanted to commit to

[06:10:30] the field, it had to get done. And so these ladies, the work is not over, in other words. I may just have a, just clarify it with a follow-up question. I appreciate, and I think you're absolutely right, that these guidelines focused on what was most urgent, and very much appreciate your effort and Superintendent Gullickson's effort to, I know these, the department staff has been working hard, hard, hard on this for two years now, and that you all pushed to enable that to expedite this final step of getting these materials they've been working on for so long out to the public. But I also know that they've been working on, I suspect they've been working on

[06:11:09] these, how we get the external partners. I heard them say they've been talking to the museum educators, etc. But then when I hear vetting and a tool, etc., etc., is that going to take another two years or can we get a timeline maybe can we get a timeline for when the guides will be updated with those external partners just as we did you know Superintendent Gullickson's timeline that she issued when she came on

that got us expeditiously to where we are now can we get a timeline for for the next round it's just too much good material out there to be wasting yeah we

[06:11:46] we do we have a timeline and you know I'll let dr. Byrd right speak to that timeline because she probably has the dates in her head better than i do but to let you know what the process you know it was a very detailed process just to get the primary resources linked into it was hours and hours and hours of dedicated work over the last six weeks to make sure that we have those quality primary resources in there for teachers so they can just click on something you spoke about brown versus board of education there are several links linked in there specifically to support that as an instructional team and with the hqim bill we are working on a new rubric much

[06:12:26] like the textbook adoption rubric but this is specific to high quality instructional materials that is part of the vetting process that we will use with the already created wonderful resources but we do have to make sure that they are aligned to our standards if we're going to link them into our documents and so that is part of that vetting process with our external partners and we've got a training coming up with our external partners museum partners included so they can see this rubric we're piloting it with history because as we we want to you know test it out make sure it works good and we're continuing on that work like we're already

[06:13:04] starting the work with hqim evaluations and then we're continuing that as we roll out through the different content areas according to the legislation timeline so it's kind of interconnected with all content and then i'll let dr birdwright talk about the timeline specific to history sure and so um as dr wallace mentioned and president creasy we are meeting with our external partners and organizations beginning june 9th they are actually going to be trained on this rubric so they will understand specifically what does it mean when we talk about standards alignment what does it mean when we talk about accessibility and usability and providing access and opportunities for students

[06:13:42] so they know to make sure that we are not going into some areas that we should not things and so we want to make sure that when we're when they are providing us resource because our name is there we represent that we want to make sure that it's appropriate and age appropriate and content appropriate and standards alone so we're going to be training them and going through that process they'll be submitting their items through using the Go Open Hub as well. So a good accessibility there to provide that and we'll be linking that back in. As far as process timeline, we're starting in June and then we plan to really be in a really good spot between November, December and then we'll

[06:14:22] be looking to post by January. So soon right into that. So we'll be working with the partners. We also have some committees of some division leaders, educators that will also be a part of this process too to really give that practical sense the usability to look at it as well and provide us feedback not only on the tool that the evaluation tool is being used for those resources but also to help partner with our external partners I think that's building capacity and understanding and mutual knowledge about what's really happening on the ground in the classroom and what's happening in the field and how can we marry those two together and so that work just as we articulated

[06:14:57] there into the instructional guides we plan to be right on schedule as we've communicated and promise to the field and so we're looking to be able to do that um with our process timeline there believe you me the history team has we can work a timeline i tell you we can i promise any other questions for me

dr northern this is just a silly question but um let's say you've got 12 museums across the state give you a lesson or resource for brown versus board of education for instance

[06:15:32] and you're trying to embed i'm assuming the links on the word brown versus board i mean what are you doing when you've got more resources than links so we're using the go open hub and that's where we'll be categorizing as president creasy spoke to so at that bottom part where it talks about the high quality instructional materials it's actually going to be going out to the hub where it'll be categorized by content so then so you i saw the oh so you're so you can visualize it and see it so then when they click on that link it's going to take them and it's going to be categorized by that standard. So when they go out to go open, it'll be VUS 0.12. And it'll have all the resources

[06:16:12] that are curated that way, which is why we're also during that training going to be sharing with our external partners about go open and what that's going to look like. So all of that's included in our June training. The vision that I had two years ago for these documents. We are making it coming to life. I'm sorry, just to follow up, the embedded ones that are already in there are they going to stay yes and then the other ones will go on go home that will be the secondary and then there will be a link a section section like so there's the standard and then there's the skills and content you know the skills and practice and all of that that's listed and

[06:16:48] that's where the links are right now if you can just kind of envision that and at the bottom of that section um is where the additional hqim and resources will be linked to go open for them to link to go so it's going to be still embedded within the instructional guide itself so teachers aren't having to remember oh i have to go to go open it's still going to be linked there and then link out to the hub with the resources northern so is this happening in other subject areas these resources are linked or is it just history and social studies so right now we are linking it

[06:17:24] mostly with history and and social studies and the reason is when you look at high quality instructional materials high quality instructional materials are readily available primarily you know with english k5 we have a lot of them you saw the list earlier um and then with our math there's a lot of high quality instructional materials companies that produce those history has the least amount of textbooks and high quality instructional materials um i think maybe you know zero that are aligned to virginia standards so that is the the main reason that we need to

[06:17:59] get these resources out on the hub. The other content areas and the instructional guides are going to have links where high quality instructional materials aren't embedded. So for example, if we have asked our English K5 core, you know, to follow a core curriculum, we don't want to confuse them with a link out to other resources that then confuses their implementation of a valid curriculum. So we have to be cautious in where and what we share within each instructional guide set based on the content. Science is another example. There's like one good high quality

[06:18:37] instructional material out there for science, right? And, you know, we're, it's just, it hasn't been built, right? And then with Virginia, our standards are very specific, and particularly in history. That's why there are so few in history, because all history standards are different in every state. So, yes. And so we'll have some links like computer science, for example, you're going to hear from them. Their instructional guides are going to have links to some lesson plans and resources and things like that, because there isn't a textbook or a high quality instructional material for that. So it's really based on the content, but I appreciate your question.

[06:19:14] So much. Thank you all. It's a really exciting day. So I will remain and we'll transition to our next group. And this is, I'd like to introduce Dr. Ann Peterson. She is our director of STEM.

[06:19:40] So she has the next two presentations on first math and then science. I will, after she finishes math, kind of do a little precursor to science though. But her team, Dr. Peterson oversees not only math and science, but also health PE and driver's education. And I think maybe some of got to interact with our driver education staff at the Teacher of the Year celebration last week.

[06:20:07] And so they are a huge part. They do a lot of work in the Office of STEM, and they also support other content areas and other departments across the agency. So with the math updates, we're going to focus on where we have come from the adoption of the 2023 math standards of learning.

[06:20:31] and look at what we've done thus far and then again looking towards where we're going. We're going to touch on some of the legislation that's been recently passed and what we're doing to support that and that does cross over into other presentations as well. So without further ado, I will turn it over to Dr. Peterson. So good afternoon, President Creasy, board members, and Superintendent Gullickson. First of all, I'd like to say I appreciate the banner for the School of STEM right behind me. Well planned. And I hate to say, I hate coming after Dr. Birdwright

[06:21:06] because she is so dynamic. I will try my best to keep up the momentum. So we're going to start with the update for mathematics. And okay, I was going to say down, over. As with everybody else, we're trying to align to board priorities. The work of the mathematics team supporting the following board priorities through providing support for strong instruction of the 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning. This support includes professional development, resources, and technical support to divisions to help meet these priorities for mathematics.

[06:21:44] Our mathematics team is led by a wonderful mathematics coordinator, Vicki Bohidar, and we have a team of two full-time mathematics specialists, Jessica Brown, Dr. Jessica Brown and Donna Snyder, who is out in the other side of Virginia supporting our divisions. And we are bringing on a full-time secondary mathematics specialist, knock on wood, by the June 10th, we'll hopefully have somebody in place. We also have a part-time person who is actually part-time for our department, Dr. Regina Mitchell, who is working with

[06:22:20] the Office of Student Populations as well. Although they are a small team, they're a mighty team that that are doing a lot of work. So, first I'd like to introduce some of the things that have occurred since the inception of the 2023 standards in August of 2023.

[06:22:42] At that time, we were rolling out resources starting in January every two weeks to support the teachers with the implementation of these standards. These resources include exemplar MIPS, which are math instructional plans. You will find that the math and science team not very creative because the science instructional plans are called SIPS, the math ones are MIPS, and the computer science ones are CSIPS. So if you reference those, we just aren't creative.

[06:23:11] We also rolled out initially the understanding the standard docs, and those were rolled out in January and February of 2024. Those became embedded into the instructional guides for mathematics later on. We had the concepts and connections articulation guide that was rolled out in March of 2024 and the K through three mathematics achievement sample records that were also rolled out in 2024. Just like

with history, we have the instructional guides. Now the background on the instructional guides is really stemming from public comment and actually conversations

[06:23:48] with the board that elementary teachers have a lot on their plate and they have different structures within the different disciplines to support them within instruction. And we tried to brainstorm, how can we make things more consistent across those boards for those elementary teachers that are teaching a variety of topics?

[06:24:09] And so, cohesiveness and consistency across the instructional guides was one way that we could do that. So, our instructional guides are composed of the same sections as the other ones and look very similar to the other ones. Our initial release of the instructional guides occurred in May 2024, And we're proud to say the updates are going to be coming out May 30th of 2025.

[06:24:33] Those updates include technical edits that we found when teachers were working with instructional guides, leaders. They needed to massage some things, maybe provide an additional support, or we realized there were gaps after we actually put them in action. We have the inclusion of the content connections.

[06:24:51] Though the content connections originally had connections to science, I will say math is the language of science. For those of you that are mathematicians and scientists, you realize that. We wanted to make those connections explicit. As an elementary teacher, and my background is high school. You'll find that high school teachers are very conceited, we run the world type of people. I taught AP chemistry, so I'm even worse. But for elementary teachers, they may not have efficacy in one or more content areas, may have majored in history, and then coming to teach mathematics, maybe those connections aren't as visible between math and science or from

[06:25:29] computer science and mathematics. So we tried to make those as visible as possible. When the computer science standards were updated, we had to update the instructional guides to reflect that. We also included the digital learning integration standards, and we have updated the documents overall to increase the accessibility of the documents for all of our stakeholders.

[06:25:56] Another resource provided by the state of Virginia is, and through all in Virginia funds, is Zearn. Zearn is an online platform that allows personalization for students to address gaps in their understanding, work towards learning recovery, or actually accelerate in certain concepts.

[06:26:17] Currently, 108 divisions use Zearn in the state of Virginia, and on average, and this is based on data from the last four weeks, Each student is engaging in an average of 45 minutes of work with Zearn per week. So this augments their traditional classroom instruction and hopefully with careful planning, the teacher can look at what is being taught in the classroom and compare it to Zearn and use them collaboratively to provide all those supports the students may need.

[06:26:45] Currently, as you heard prior, the approval for Zearn is gonna be for the 2025, 2026 school years. And as of last week, we had 95 divisions have responded. They will use and continue to use XERN to support their students.

[06:27:02] So XERN usage, you know, for math and science, we really appreciate a good graph. It's always fun to analyze what happened in January of 2025, and we can guess that any, I'm sure you can guess what happened in January of 2025.

[06:27:20] We had a little bit of snow. So the usage dropped dramatically during that time. You could kind of see where Christmas break occurred, some fluctuations with spring break. But overall, you see that many months we reached 100,000 students using XERN within those month periods.

[06:27:40] As you know, in switching gears, in the past few months, we've been to the board with lists of approved textbooks and instructional materials. So we are very excited to get those approved. From our end, we have ensured that there are procurement and pricing information for those approved materials on the BDOE website.

[06:28:02] We also have included the Mathematics Review Committee Correlation Reports. So those are available to divisions. When divisions start the process of looking at different materials, they can go to their reports and there have been over 130 educators that have worked with us in reviewing those, where alignment occurs, determining if it sufficiently meets those mastery expectations that are reflected in the standards of learning. That is the first step, and I would hate to say it, we did the easy step. The next steps is going to

[06:28:40] take several years, and that is actually the divisions, looking at the materials, looking at the correlation documents, figuring out what are the needs of my students, what are the needs of my teachers, and which best fits those needs, and then as you know Virginia standards are unique they are best-in-class standards however the textbooks may not be a hundred percent aligned so they might have to go back and determine where their gaps in that alignment and provide resources and we will help facilitate that process this will take seven several years to get rolling and will take significant amounts of once

[06:29:18] it's adopted planning and PD for the teachers and that has to be ongoing PD on how to use those resources effectively. I tend to think of HQIM as a three-legged stool. One leg is the actual materials. One leg is the professional development that is needed to implement those materials.

[06:29:39] And the third leg is that principal support and the ongoing feedback on how the implementation occurs. If those three legs are present, then you can have positive student outcomes. So how are we supporting those in the three legs?

[06:29:55] Well, the first is through stakeholder webinars. We have division support specialists for those division leaders, math instructional coaches that are leading the work in the division, a high-level look at the mathematics textbook and instructional materials adoption process.

[06:30:12] For parents, for board members, for school board members, for teachers, an introduction to HQIM. What is it and how can it support student outcomes? This will be differentiated.

[06:30:29] based on the audience that we have. We also have developed the Mathematics Textbook and Instructional Material Implementation Tool that is going to be upon final approval of leadership, will be available in June and we will have a recording on how that tool is to be used.

[06:30:47] We will also provide professional development across the state on the use of that tool. The Mathematics Implementation Playbook is with anticipated final approval in June 2025, will mimic that of the VLA playbook, will provide best practices for implementing mathematics instruction.

[06:31:08] And then we have the mathematics walkthrough tool. Now, when Jill talked this morning, she said that UVA helped develop the literacy walkthrough tool. We don't have a UVA for mathematics, but we do have a group of vetted stakeholders.

[06:31:23] And one thing we wanted to be very important, principals are walking into all sorts of different classrooms. We have to have portions of the walkthrough tool that is consistent, because good instruction, the topics may change, but good instruction is pretty consistent.

[06:31:40] What are those things that we value highly that principals should be looking for in the classroom? And we divided the rubric or the walkthrough tool into three parts. Part one is looking at the management, looking at student engagement.

[06:31:56] Part three is looking at the use of resources. The middle part is gonna be discipline specific. And that middle part for mathematics is gonna focus on the process goals. We worked collaboratively. It can't be just one group making this.

[06:32:12] So we worked across the disciplines to get buy-in on the different components so that we can have a consistent document so a principal isn't using this type of walkthrough tool here and that type of walkthrough tool there. We developed it. The next step is let's have principals try it out.

[06:32:28] You know how much you can develop something and then you put it in action. You're like, "Ooh, that was really hard to measure." not sure exactly what that looks like we have to figure out what those kinks are so we are going to ask principals to pilot this tool in the fall we'll get their feedback we'll revise and then do a state rollout in the spring of 2026. throughout all of that professional development will be provided for our pilot programs we're going to have them do training where they're looking at videos and applying the tool they'll be able to ask the questions We'll be able to engage.

[06:33:02] We want to be on site, walking through with them, not only to use the tools ourselves, but to see it in action and use that to inform any updates that need to be made. Once that rolls out, we'll also do multiple webinars in January to support principals.

[06:33:18] Multiple webinars because principals are a little bit busy. That was a little bit of sarcasm. So finding times to get them to meet is difficult. So we want to make sure that we're available at the time they can meet. so we will offer multiple opportunities. In terms of parental engagement with mathematics, parents have been involved in the process all along the way. We had the development of the mathematics standards, which was informed and went through the public comment process, or the public hearing process, the public comment process. We had stakeholder groups working with the mathematics

[06:33:53] team to develop the standards. The same thing with the instructional guides. We had parent groups working with us on the instructional guides they were changed to reflect what are the priorities of leadership what are the priorities of getting students engaged with mathematics what are the priorities of parents and that all informed the instructional guides and we will continue to garner parent feedback as well as other stakeholder back as we go through and implement these different items we do have some legislation coming and I'll go through

[06:34:26] that in a minute, and it's going to have parent involvement in that as well. So ongoing professional development. We are currently hosting division leader webinars, and these are monthly webinars that we plan to continue through the 2025-2026 school years.

[06:34:46] They're targeted to inform systems level mathematics leadership. We plan to have regional breakout sessions for leaders to connect and collaborate. So those in Region 8 who may have similar issues that they are facing, you know, maybe capacity for mathematics teachers in high-level mathematics

courses, or maybe issues with the HQIM, maybe using, getting divisions together, utilizing the same HQIM to be able to work with each other, develop resources, would be a way to reach those division needs, and

[06:35:23] we can do that through these regional, or division-level webinars. The topic so far in March, we did using BDOE resources to support strong instruction in mathematics. We have done strengthening and understanding measurement in geometry and probability in statistics.

[06:35:40] You're wondering why that one? That one was actually generated at division leader requests. They said this is something that we are not familiar with. We need support in making sure that these changes to these standards are implemented with fidelity in the classrooms.

[06:35:55] We are doing in May 2025, the updates to the instructional guides, and then in June, in collaboration with the Office of Advanced Learning, we'll be working with the Accelerated Mathematics Pathways. For principals, we need professional learning too.

[06:36:14] So in our principal professional learning, we're going to have professional learning targeted to principals with supporting teachers with mathematics instruction. So what does good instruction look like? What should we look for? What are things that you go into a classroom and the kids are all talking together?

[06:36:30] Is that good practice in mathematics? Yes. They are engaging in discourse. They're talking about mathematics. They're justifying mathematics. Perhaps they're developing models to show their mastery of a concept. So being able to see what that looks like is very important.

[06:36:47] And then webinars on how to support teachers with mathematics textbook and instructional materials and using the mathematics walkthrough tool. All of these we'll offer, as I said, multiple times, but we'll also record them and make them available for principals who are not able to attend. And then again, the other stakeholder webinars, that introduction to HQIM, why do we need it?

[06:37:08] And I think if we can't answer the why, it will not be valued as much. So that is very important at this part of the process. Good professional development is not a one and done. Good professional development is sustained.

[06:37:25] It's having the conversations. It's engaging the stakeholders. it's using real student data, it's taking things back and implementing them in your classroom, and then having the discussions afterwards of what worked and what didn't work. So to facilitate that, the mathematics team has developed professional learning modules, and these modules are intended to be taken back to the divisions and be led by either instructional coaches or a principal or a lead teacher to facilitate professional learning communities.

[06:37:57] These materials include the slide deck, a complete facilitator guide on how to do it. For those that don't want to read about how to do it but listen to it, we have narrated overviews of the PowerPoint so they can do that. We have had division leader webinars on what this module is about and how to implement it.

[06:38:15] And also there are links to additional resources. We currently have six published. And again, these are based on the needs expressed by the field. So developing a culture of mathematics. How do you provide that culture in the school?

[06:38:32] How do you develop a vision and make sure that vision is carried out in everything that you do? Looking at the vertical articulation of concepts. And that is really going to inform our work as we move towards accelerated coursework or compacting courses.

[06:38:48] What are those foundational things that I need to have in place to be able to build on? Because you miss one part of that foundation and that building is going to crumble. So really taking a close look at that. Implementing the data cycle.

[06:39:03] So the data cycle is not just being given numbers and told to manipulate them, but having the students ask questions, being able to either use datasets that are existing or collect the data themselves. What a wonderful opportunity to collaborate with your science classes, right?

[06:39:20] To be able to get that data, to be able to visualize that data and make conclusions based on that. formulas to strengthen student understanding, obsession on computational fluency or a module on computational fluency, and developing number sense through estimation.

[06:39:39] Estimation, as I said, I taught chemistry for many years, and estimation is something they struggle with, particularly, well, we just put it in the calculator and that's what it gave us. Does that even seem feasible? If you are so reliant on the calculator and you don't have those estimation skills, you You don't know that maybe something you put in the calculator is way off, so that estimation needs to be developed.

[06:40:03] We're in an era when kids are afraid to be wrong, so it's easier to rely on the calculator than try to estimate, but it's a very important skill. We have a lot coming up. We have a lot of work underway. There are several legislative items that came out.

[06:40:20] The first is HB 1829, which are add-on endorsements for mathematics teachers, and this was to build up a cadre of expert and informed mathematics teachers at the middle school level to impact or to help with the acceleration.

[06:40:40] These add-ons are geometry add-on endorsements for K through 8 teachers, and then they amended the add-on endorsement requirements for Algebra 1. We won't have any impact on that. We can help inform the process, but that will basically be done by the Department of Teaching and Licensure.

[06:40:58] 686 requires each school board to develop and adopt a policy that sets forth the criteria for students in grades 5 through 8 to be eligible to enroll in accelerated mathematics. This one's huge. This one allows those students that score in the upper quartile on the SOL test to be automatically accelerated in mathematics.

[06:41:20] Now, students or parents do have the option to opt out, but it does promote those upper quartile students. Now, does everybody need to be accelerated? I would say no. I mean, every kid comes in with different opportunities, right? I will say I was the youngest person in my class, and spatial relations kicked in late.

[06:41:43] Geometry, I could not take the 2D and make 3D, not because I didn't understand the concepts, because that part of my brain hadn't matured. So we have to think about each student. What are they bringing? Where are areas where we can accelerate? If it's appropriate, let's do it.

[06:42:00] Let's figure out what those components are, what those criteria are. We can advise or provide guidance to divisions as they make their policy and determine what's best for their kids. So, part of this is

the automatic acceleration.

[06:42:16] It requires each school board to report to the department data related to advancements, and it requires each school board to create policies. We will provide technical assistance, documents to support divisions in doing that. The big question is though, if we accelerate in middle school, are there options in high school?

[06:42:36] If we accelerate and the kids finish all the options by sophomore year, that probably isn't the best thing. And a two year break will result in gaps when they get into higher ed. So we're looking at that end too. And some of the legislation you're gonna see will help address that.

[06:42:52] So middle school math acceleration grant program. This is actually built into the budget versus a bill. So if you look at the budget language, the department shall oversee and track math instruction, assessment scores and learning outcomes to identify potential areas of improvement.

[06:43:14] We do that already. We will keep embedded in that type of work. Identify best-paced practices, evidence-based proven best practices to improve mathematics instruction. We have embedded those in the instructional guides, but we will continue to do so and continue to address gaps in instruction by, or gaps in the instructional guide by adding more best practices as they become available.

[06:43:42] Establish and oversee a framework for the support and implementation of professional development, which is what the team is engaging with right now. And then the big one, administer state funds to school divisions as appropriate. So there are two big grants that are outlined through this legislation.

[06:44:00] I'm going to go into that in a minute. And then we're going to collect data to report to the General Assembly annually about the progress. So one of the big things that comes out of this, we are legislated to have a mathematics task force. And this mathematics task force is composed of specific audiences.

[06:44:21] We have to have parents, we have to have educators, instructional coaches, school leaders, a school board member, should have them memorized. Other stakeholders are all going to be part of this task force group.

[06:44:37] With that, there are several objectives that are going to be met. They have clear goals that they're going to inform. You know, what does HQIM look like? What does that implementation look like to support work with that? You all have already approved HQIM, but maybe providing guidance on how that could be help implemented in schools, as well as other tasks.

[06:45:01] There is also funding to expand advanced mathematics coursework and expand math experts, which goes along with we need to make sure that we have those add-on endorsements available to middle school teachers. So in that accelerated mathematics middle school, first of all, my collaboration with Office of Advanced Learning and the Virginia Advisory Council of Advanced Learning has been huge, and I'm thankful for the leadership that Amanda Nevitrol has provided through the Office of Advanced Learning.

[06:45:34] The resources support divisions with this, we are working on resources as we speak. One is the accelerated math pathways, a technical resource guide for school divisions. they have to have policy in place for the next school year.

[06:45:50] And so any resource or technical support we can provide, they are gonna take that resource, technical assistant document, massage it, figure out what works best for their students and their teachers and determine their paths. But we will provide any supports that they need.

[06:46:06] We're also coming up with sample, accelerated math pathways, parent resources, so that they have communications that they may use and adjust for their parent population. will provide professional development on accelerated math pathways, and we're gonna be presenting it, I think at almost every conference available this summer to get the word out.

[06:46:29] We also have the middle school acceleration grant. Oops, I went to a different, I'm not touching it anymore. Okay, so the math implementation, it's just moving.

[06:46:47] Oh, okay. The math implementation grant is gonna focus on HQIM. So it's $10 million. It provides, it's gonna be an award basis. We'll have an application process that will be opening up soon.

[06:47:03] They can purchase HQIM with it. They can develop curriculum that embeds the HQIM with resources to address any gaps. They can look at moving towards more of a competency-based model for mathematics in middle school.

[06:47:25] They can provide opportunities for developing curriculum that's compacted, which means that if you're accelerating math, first of all, sixth grade math is important. Seventh grade math is important. Eighth grade math is important. They all provide the foundation for success in high school.

[06:47:40] But if you accelerate and compact things correctly, you can take that sixth grade content and perhaps half of that seventh grade content and do it in one calendar year, test the kids on the sixth grade content, and then the next year do the second half of seventh grade and the eighth grade content content and have them take the 8th grade SOL.

[06:48:06] That takes a lot of planning, a lot of manipulation. How do I lay out those concepts, those vertical concepts, in a way that makes sense instructionally and provide those support for teachers? So that can be done with that mathematics acceleration grant. And I think -- thank you, gentlemen, for moving it forward.

[06:48:24] I think just the last few slides got popped off, perhaps. Yeah, I think it was just the last few slides are not in the presentation, but that's fine. The mathematics acceleration grant is a $1 million grant and it allows for two different things.

[06:48:43] One is allows for students to take virtual courses if advanced middle school coursework is not offered in their middle school. So if the school doesn't have compacted curriculum and doesn't have the time to put it together, they have the option of taking it in virtual Virginia.

[06:48:59] If the school division doesn't have it and they want to download it from virtual Virginia, they can do that as well. So let's say one teacher is teaching five classes, volunteers to teach a sixth class using the compacted curriculum from Virtual Virginia, part of that funding can pay for her to teach that sixth course.

[06:49:19] So it doesn't supplant the money that is used to pay for teachers, but maybe provides that opportunity for them to teach an additional course. If a division chooses to use a MOP or some massive online provider or some other vetted program for mathematics, they have the opportunity to do that. We

aren't putting guardrails on it. We want them to be innovative with the different ways that they can address this.

[06:49:44] The second part is, it's great that we have advanced math pathways in middle school. What happens when they get to high school and we don't have the teachers trained in this? So they may choose to send teachers to AP institutes to get them trained to be able to teach those upper level mathematics courses. It may be to send teachers to college to take maybe a probability and statistics course so they can brush up to be able to teach those higher level courses. So those opportunities are there as well. So you have two grants. One is more for the

[06:50:16] structures and supports to implement high quality instructional materials and to be able to provide that robust curriculum to support the mathematics standards. And the second one is to provide opportunities for students through either online platforms or for training teachers so they can provide and extend those pathways further that is it um and i know it's a lot to do but um what

[06:50:47] questions do you have for me all right so um awesome awesome awesome um i've been following these policies nationally because i do research um and i think one thing we ought to be aware of is in washington state they implemented the same policy we're about to implement in 2014 and there's a call to report by dan goldhaber and some other people they did a difference in differences study which is very rigorous and they found i just brought it up so i could get it right

[06:51:22] they found only 14 of students who qualified for advanced mathematics courses actually enrolled in it that was a huge opt out from parents right and it wasn't a qualitative study so we don't know know what's going on. They were hypothesizing, like, is it a capacity issue? Is it that parents don't understand, you know? And I just think that we need to couple this policy, because clearly 2014, they've had an effect for a while, and they're still trying to figure out why opt-outs are so high on the parental end, and they're saying it's disproportionately opt-out from students with families of color. So that's another, like, equity issue we're going to have,

[06:52:00] you know, need to kind of be on the lookout for. So I would just say, as we roll this out, we really need to have a parental information involvement campaign. I know we've got an office that handles that. But I do think they really need to understand the benefits for their kids in these advanced courses. Because, you know, if their kid comes home, I don't want to do that.

[06:52:21] You know, I mean, we just don't want them throwing in the white flag so easily. So that's my biggest thing. I mean, and when they looked at ELA and social studies, because Washington State actually has these same policies in multiple subject areas they found that the ela and social studies kids were uptake the uptake was much higher but it's just a lot lower in mathematics and we don't know and whether that's a capacity issue in districts or whether it's the parents aren't aware of the benefits for their kids we don't know but i do think that we ought to pay attention to that research um given that they are so far ahead of this thing than we are i think i think it comes

[06:52:56] too with efficacy about mathematics for teachers I mean or for parents I think so many times you know you you can talk to people and they don't want to say I can't read but very easily say oh I don't do math I can't do math I hate math so I think that is an obstacle one thing that we're going to try to do is develop we don't want to stay or give divisions pathways because divisions have latitude determine their own pathways or provide sample pathways for divisions and parents what can this look like what does

acceleration mean and then if we can do a really good job let's turn uh tie in those high paying wages high demand jobs either workforce or higher ed

[06:53:35] i mean my son did not go to college is workforce and is out earning me don't even get me started but saying this going this track this is the way it could look in high school and these are the opportunities it could bring i think we're going to have to do a really good job of marketing for both of those reasons yeah looking at the middle school math acceleration grant program can you tell me again how much is in that so the acceleration grant program is only only

[06:54:12] a million dollars so and and that and i thought that's what you said so i'm just wondering i'm looking under the the goals of that grant program that is labeled middle school math acceleration grant program the part of the priority is to oversee a mathematics grant program or math curriculum HRIM competency-based mastery support to improve instruction for high-need school groups and so the grant is to prioritize schools identified as off track need intensive support and have

[06:54:47] performance gaps in overall grade level math so it just there's a dichotomy there on one hand you're trying to accelerate math but yet at the same time you're trying to provide financial support for programs that are going to assist most in these students right and then that's the grant with the million dollars in it so i'm just saying i mean i think it's really really good that we focus on advancement but you know we don't want to leave kids behind so i just going forward

[06:55:22] i'd like to see how that money is spread out and making sure that at least the school divisions are aware of the fact that this grant is not just for acceleration but it's also to make sure that we have basic math performance for these schools i think you've got the fat math grant and the skinny math grant so the fat math grant is the 10 million that really can support those structures and particularly address those learning gaps and they're both in the same area so it makes

[06:55:59] it really confusing the skinny grant the million dollar grant is more of the acceleration so i am very happy to see that the 10 million to really provide those you know funding for curriculum to get the teachers and it just could be the write-up not a problem i mean i'll look at the grant specifically i just want well we want to do whatever's best exactly yeah i just wanted to point that out. School divisions would know that it's not just for this acceleration because I want them to be aware of wherever the money is that they need to make sure that we bring the

[06:56:34] students on. Absolutely. And we are also just in the beginning, I mean, Ann and her team, it would like to look at those funds, but we're still finalizing what those applications will be and the focus areas and priorities for our school division. Mr. Rotherham.

[06:56:51] I thank you, Madam President. I just have a comment, and it's not like a question masquerading as a comment or vice versa. It's a genuine comment. Like, I think this is exciting. I'm excited to see the focus on acceleration. And also, I don't think I'm giving away any state secrets to say we're a little behind here where we wanted to be. And so it's really exciting to see the momentum. And I'm really pleased when, you know, when I was reading the deck and you could you could see it. And that's also true, actually, of the previous presentation. They're not here right now. But it's really great to see this kind of momentum and coming into next school year what's

[06:57:24] going to be on tap and so thank you. Ms. Holton. Thank you. I have a little question and a big question. My little question is the you know we don't know if you were here when we had our Literacy Act

presentation earlier but you know we heard a lot about the vowels and what it's able to tell us about our earliest learners and i know there is a math equivalent uh emas i think it's called something like that the math test for uh math readiness yeah so it's and is that just

[06:58:03] kindergarten unlike the vowels it's not k12 but it is at least now it may not have been it is a beginning of the year and an end of the year assessment for kindergartners so that's a place where we don't have UVA as a partner, but I would love to see whatever data you have on who's coming in at what level of risk, and what do we know about them in the fall, and what do we know about them in the spring.

[06:58:34] Just as one piece of the puzzle that we assess, how are we doing on math, and as with literacy, if we're not getting those foundations solid in the elementary, early grades, then we're not going to be able to build on it and accelerate in middle school or build in high school so that's my little question my big question is really you know i read this legislation excuse me this action embedded in the budget establishing a math advisory task force implementing grants correcting the

[06:59:08] department to assess data you have and what what lessons we can learn from it is you know i would love to see this as a first step towards a math literacy act similar to the virginia literacy act and i dare daren i i'm reluctant to say that out loud because i know our our division folks are working so hard and it's so challenging to implement the literacy act now but you know that was i think that act was passed in 22 and now three years later it's really hitting the field it's even for that but i i would love to and i wonder if part of what the legislature had in mind

[06:59:48] is that to use this task force and this grant program as a way to build towards a math equivalent to the virginia literacy act and as you know our math scores are not what we want them to be our math performance has slipped and and has not rebounded from the pandemic it was slipping even before. And meanwhile, we have seen other states, again, as with the Literacy Act, some unlikely states. Alabama, I think, is one of the ones that I've seen data suggesting folks are using the

[07:00:22] evidence to help develop curriculum and professional development in a unified way all around how to teach our kids in the most evidence-based ways and the most successful way. And they're getting results so i guess my big question is is there a way that we can use this it's not a huge amount of money but the million dollars to the department and the 10 million to the i'm not talking about the acceleration grant now i'm talking about the math part embedded in the in the budget that use all of that 11 million as a stepping stone towards what might eventually become

[07:01:03] an equivalent to the literacy act and that in the premise of my question is that we need something like that and i don't mean to assume you agree with that but would love to hear your thoughts on that so actually legislation was introduced and it did not go through and i think people valued that so much that it was introduced in the budget this way so this is a minute portion of the legislation that was introduced and and it's money-wise only a small piece but that's why i would love to see so even the 11 million is not a lot of money but if we could use that in a way

[07:01:37] that would help inform something that might then grow into a math literacy sorry i didn't mean to interrupt your answer mr ather i may be playing the part of dr northern here she may chime in but um i would i think it would behoove us to absolutely take steps to support math instruction whether that's professional development there's you you can see a range of things we could do to help improve math achievement in the state particularly for kids um who right now are the lowest achieving i would be really cautious though to draw the parallel with science of

[07:02:16] reading and science of reading was a body of research over 50 years old that had just been widely ignored in our sector because of politics because we had decided there was democratic and republican ways to teach reading for some reason um and the science of reading was an effort to undo that and some of that research is new but again a lot of it I mean this dates back not just the stuff that like George Bush was doing in Texas but the stuff that was happening in the 60s you just don't have that same body of evidence with regard to math um and so I think we want to be really careful about what a uh what a science a a math bill with I mean I'm I don't

[07:02:55] want to fall into the nomenclature of saying that just put up what a math bill would it would not include otherwise we might inadvertently frustrate teachers we could inadvertently codify things that we don't want to codify and in fact I think we could inadvertently call into question the science of reading because then people would say well is this and we've made such progress there as we just heard today and continue to so I would just urge us as a policy matter support math education absolutely there's a lot that can be done both here and at the agency and also in the general assembly assembly but be really careful about this like direct linkage to um uh to science of math

[07:03:33] well i may i stand miss holton i stand informed by mr rothrake's comments but i do think there are states that have made dramatic progress i do think there is evidence out there about what works it may be not as solid or as comprehensive as the evidence on science reading but there is evidence about what works on math in teaching basic math skills and i think that the purpose i think what seems to be embedded in this budget action is let's do use this money to figure out how we can be using those evidence-based solutions in a more comprehensive way and and i worry that what i've

[07:04:12] heard here is i'm not sure you all have a plan to use it that way i don't see this as a comprehensive plan to how do we reform how we're teaching math on a compren on a comprehensive basis in virginia moving us towards better outcomes and so you know i don't even see the assessment nothing that we've heard here assesses where we are and so where are we where do we think we need to be and what's the plan to get from here to there how can you use this opportunity both money that's coming to the department and the money that's going out through the grants to the field

[07:04:50] to help inform that conversation even if the outcome wouldn't necessarily be a science of reading comparable legislation and i agree i think we're working towards you know we have the instructional guides which we really were deliberate about adding best practices into how do we marry that with hqim how do we marry that with professional development to create a cohesive vision to really move things forward and that's what we're working working towards developing with the team and i agree we need to think you know how are we using data to inform this process

[07:05:26] how are we messaging it to all the different stakeholders and this is what we're working on right now just remember we're in the beginning phases we still have to chat with our agency leadership and you know also really get a good plan for for how those funds are being used and i don't mean to be being critical i'm just hoping that we use this opportunity we hear you yeah we do more broadly dr northern one piece of low-hanging fruit that i might suggest is the zern data we've

[07:06:01] got 108 districts using dirt learn right that's a lot of kids and i'm sure that zern is you know providing teachers with you know skill based evaluations of how kids are doing um but that would be a piece that we could evaluate too right like what are we seeing in terms of patterns of kids who are participating in zern at what dosage levels i mean zern gets a lot of money right and and there has been

one evaluation of zern that said it's um that it's effective but um we are we're heavy zern users right so we really ought to be able to answer the question fairly soon

[07:06:38] whether or not those kids are improving compared to a comparable uh control group um on the skills that they're and i think once those sol scores come out we'll be able to do some of that looking at the data. Let's cross-reference the data, figure out, you know, who's using it. If there are specific areas in Zern that are being used, let's look at the comparable strand of the mathematics standards and see how that's being done. Because there's 108 and not all kids use it, we can actually create almost like control groups to compare with and without Zern and be able to do that definitely. And, you know, they're math people. They're going to love the data.

[07:07:14] But for instance, you could use some of this grant money, some of the criteria for the grant money could be two divisions. Use this to accelerate what you're doing, but study it. Yes, definitely. So that's what we're working with. That's results that we can translate. With Dr. Wallace now, you know, how are we going to build that application to get where we want and the data that we need? So it's almost like backward planning. What is the vision we want to get? How do we build this application and the parameters of the application so it can get us where we need to go? Definitely. Thank you. Sorry, I got excited.

[07:07:48] She gets a little excited about talking. Superintendent Gullickson. Thank you so much, team. And I want to echo all of our grants now have student outcome-based data capturing, analysis, and comparison, not just on this team.

[07:08:06] New norm since March. And so we, a sneak peek to my presentation a little bit, but we also are working on streamlining grants. So I'll talk more about that in a little bit. But it's a critical component for our team and the cross-collaboration on not just having that data live in someone's inbox or an Excel spreadsheet, but then how are we using it to inform policy and more practices and future grants out the door. Okay, thank you. So, we're going to transition to science, and I just want to do a little brief intro. It's still going to be Dr. Peterson delivering the science,

[07:08:45] and then she's got a science team member out in the audience as well. So, we have also been, as you know, SOLs go on a review process of every seven years they are reviewed. We have the 2018 Standards of Learning for Science. As you also know, our typical at that time rollout for Standards of Learning was usually a cross, so it's approved in 2018, and then in 2019 would have been like a crosswalk year, but the first implementation year in 2020. We have this little

[07:09:21] tiny thing called the pandemic that happened in 2020 that kind of delayed how the standards were going to be implemented fully because kids kind of stopped going to school in March. And so we shifted things at the time in the field as to when the 2018 standards of learning for K through eight content areas, as well as high school biology, chemistry, physics, and earth science were going to be implemented.

[07:09:57] Those are the current standards. We did some work with the field, beginning that kind of review process, and it was really determined that they never got to implement the standards the way that they needed to be implemented.

[07:10:14] was a large there was a review that took place and overwhelmingly we decided and the field decided we'd like the new the new format that the sols were laid out in and you know they're they have this little green leaf in it the green leaf indicates this is an activity a hands-on learning activity for kids it's

really a user-friendly document from that information we have determined that we're not going to revise or making recommendations to revise those standards however we will be presenting to the board recommendations for new standards of learning and that's what Dr. Peterson is going to talk to you about today as she does her update

[07:10:53] I wanted to just give that base level information because other people when they hear it's really kind of confusing to get wrapped in your head like what standards are you talking about I didn't think we were going to update standards we're only going to recommend new standards for for those content areas in high school that didn't have standards of learning previously.

[07:11:14] So these are level two courses. So like your anatomy, your chemistry two, something that might be a higher level meteorology that follows our science. We will be recommending that those content areas now have full out drawn standards of learning.

[07:11:35] We had guidance for teachers and schools previously, and Dr. Peterson will talk about that. But I really just wanted to lay the foundation and the background of where we're going with this presentation, that it is about totally new standards, and we're not updating our current 2018 standards that exist, okay?

[07:11:57] So I just wanted to lay that out, and then Dr. Peterson's gonna go through her presentation, much like she did with the math. - Okay, and our sole audience member is Laura Kasdor. who is the science coordinator at VDOE, and we are very glad to have her. Her leadership has been outstanding. So, again, we align to the agency priorities, and those are to implement with fidelity the 2018 standards of learning and to provide guidance on the 2025 science standards of learning once they're approved by the board.

[07:12:29] There's an additional priority here, and that additional priority is to advance safe and healthy schools. As science teachers, as science leaders, we realize that safety in the laboratory classroom is critical. We provide supports to divisions through professional learning, but we also have a science repository on Virtual Virginia, which gives sample chemical hygiene plans, which are required by OSHA.

[07:12:55] It gives walkthrough tools. It gives all sorts of different supports so the divisions can ensure the safety of their classroom environments. OSHA very much drives the work of Science Laboratory, just like it does with CTE and some of the other areas, and we want to make sure that divisions have support with that.

[07:13:13] So in this update we're going to talk about, as Dr. Wallace said, what has happened, what is the timeline of what has been done, and what is coming soon. In the end we're going to talk about some awards and recognitions because it's always good to hear about excellence in both science and math education.

[07:13:30] So in February of 2023, we introduced to the Board a timeline for the revision and development of the 2025 standards. When we originally came to the Board, it was a two-year timeline.

[07:13:46] The two-year timeline was because we had 11 Board-approved courses that do not have standards. That meant that any division could teach whatever they wanted. And we wanted to make sure that there were commonalities in what students were provided in terms of science instruction.

[07:14:06] We also wanted to make sure there was rigor. And we wanted to make sure it aligned to those national SCED descriptions that are available for each course. In June 2003, we met with teacher teams to

develop the 2025 standards for those 11 courses.

[07:14:24] In fall, we had multiple opportunities for stakeholder feedback, primarily higher education feedback because they are going to really be, these courses feed into higher ed programs. So we wanted to make sure that the content was accurate and that the performance expectations reflected what was appropriate for an upper-level high school course.

[07:14:48] We're also very informed by the AP coursework. We were informed by NAEP, we were informed by other state coursework, and we were informed by syllabi of higher ed institutes in Virginia.

[07:15:03] In summer of 2024, Ms. Kasdorf met with teachers again, but this was to address the K through physics standards. At that time, we were still working towards revising those standards. So she met with the teacher committees, developed, got feedback, revised the standards, and then based on decisions and feedback from the field, it was decided that we would maintain the 2018 standards. But I tell you what, there was a lot of good work done during those summer committees. So we said, how can we manage that good work? How can we elevate the work they did in a meaningful way?

[07:15:40] And so we are going to incorporate that work into the instructional guides. So in Fall 2025, the final drafts were made, and then they decided to integrate into the instructional guides. So what What are those 11 courses?

[07:15:58] These are the Bio II courses, so Advanced Survey of Biology Topics, Anatomy and Phys, Ecology, Genetics, Chemistry II course, Earth Science, Advanced Topics, Astronomy, Geology, Oceanography.

[07:16:14] The one course that's kind of an outlier is Environmental Science. Environmental Science can be taken at any grade level in high school or even eighth grade. It's a course that goes beyond a lot of the science courses, because it's not a peer course.

[07:16:34] Environmental science is a blend of the earth sciences with the biological sciences. Because of that, the endorsements are a little different, both in biology and earth science endorsed teachers can teach that. We did that deliberately. Earth science teachers are hard to come by, so we wanted to make sure that we had teachers to be able to teach a course so allowed either endorsement students can also earn graduation credit in either the earth science or biology discipline through this course so it provides flexibility for students and it's also a primary area of interest of you today and then of course

[07:17:10] we have the physics too now what drove what is in those courses are something we call the sked descriptions and so you have national descriptions to each course so if a student is in environmental science in GALAX, and they move to Virginia Beach, or they move to Texas, the general content of the courses is provided in that description, so that it carries over.

[07:17:37] Or if a student chooses to go to college, that descriptor goes with them, so college knows the basic content that was in the course. We wanted to make sure that these courses reflect those national guidelines. It also allowed for multiple avenues for students to engage with science.

[07:17:56] There's all sorts of different, I think we have more alternatives than almost any discipline because there are so many different areas of interest depending on your personal interest as well as what areas of the state you're in. The 2018 standard had a traditional format.

[07:18:13] That traditional format was focused on content. The students' expectations or performance expectations were included in the curriculum frameworks, they were not in the standards. The scientific and engineering practices, again, were in the curriculum frameworks.

[07:18:29] We use that leaf to indicate that the students are engaging with the scientific and engineering practice. In the new format, we intentionally integrate those SEPs, scientific and engineering practices, into the standard themselves, so that teachers wouldn't have to go from this document to this document to determine what student mastery looked like.

[07:18:51] It also reflects the performance expectations, as I said, of students to demonstrate that mastery content. So what does that look like? Well, first of all, what are the scientific and engineering practices? These are the practices that scientists and engineers engage in, in the fields, but also different things that we have to do in real life.

[07:19:09] We are constantly analyzing data, evaluating data. We're constantly constructing, critiquing conclusions. I love the one developing and using models. I think the best model assignment I ever saw was in kindergarten, and it was have the child draw a picture, where does a puddle go?

[07:19:31] My mom was like, where does a puddle go? But it is an actual really good way to do a pre-assessment on what do they know about the water cycle. And as they draw that, they can explain the different scientific concepts behind it, and it grows and progresses as they go through K through 12.

[07:19:48] So these practices are embedded everywhere we go. In the math instructional guides, you saw the skills and practices or the math process goals, and some of these are really similar because we're very close in construct. In science, these are the scientific and engineering practices that were informed by the 2012 Framework for Science Education and are also the basis for the NAEP revised assessment for 2028.

[07:20:19] So here's an example standard. For all of those that really love chemistry too, you will probably resonate with you. As you can see, the STEM, the student will investigate and understand. That stays the same from the 2018 standards, and it gives the onus of learning to the students.

[07:20:36] The STEM gives the general content that is being taught in that standard. And then to demonstrate the mastery, they are to develop and use a model to explain changes. So the teacher is not developing and using a model.

[07:20:52] The student develops the model. Make and support an evaluated claim about classification of reactions as redox or non-redox reactions. These are the things that students in a Chemistry II class should be able to do to demonstrate mastery of the course.

[07:21:09] It also helps when you're selecting HQIM. It helps when you are determining what assessments look like to look at these standards. What is also hard, and this is something we struggled with with the math HQIM, when you elevate things to plan and conduct. Hard to see in a textbook, per se. Really hard to see on an SOL assessment. Justify. This requires a higher level of student and teacher engagement.

[07:21:40] And it does provide some problems. That's what some of the PD we're doing in math is addressing. What does that look like? How are they going to assess this on the SOL test? How do I see this in HQIM? That's where that leg of student performance requires that a teacher PD, how do you set up your classroom system so that you can allow the students to be able to engage in these activities.

[07:22:06] So next steps. In June 2025, Ms. Kasdorf is going to put the announcement in town hall that public hearings are coming up on the 2025 standards of learning. We plan, she plans to present to the board in 2025 the proposed draft standards for those 11 courses and immediately we'll open public comment and have public hearings.

[07:22:30] So for those of you not planning vacation in August, we have some road trips for you. In early 2025 we're going to be going around the state, we're going to take the feedback from both the public hearings and the public comments to revise the standards to be able to submit them to the Board for final review in August.

[07:22:52] With that tight timeline, we are not going to expect implementation to until 26-27. That being said, divisions want these. They aren't tested using a traditional standards of learning test.

[07:23:07] These provide parameters and guidelines for the instruction of these courses that have never been there. So as a first-time teacher way too long ago, I was told to teach oceanography. I'm from Colorado. We don't have oceans.

[07:23:23] I just took a textbook and the night before, learned oceanography the night before. I didn't have these structures. This will so help teachers in deciding what to do and what those experiences should be. In fact, people keep asking, can you just leak a few drafts out?

[07:23:41] This is how much they are wanted. And Laura smacks my hand every time I do. In terms of current support, and we're going to shift gears, the science team has been been working very hard on the instructional guides, and I would say a majority of their time has been focused on making sure that information in that instructional guide is as accurate as possible.

[07:24:06] I'm going to jump into that structural guide in a minute, and you're going to see some amazing stuff that they have done in there. Throughout this year, they have provided division webinar support and mainly that VDOE Safety Science webinar that is being used across the state as a way to make sure that regulations are in place for science safety.

[07:24:26] They have been doing specific division support as requested, and they have also been doing presentations at all the science teacher and leader organization meetings. Coming soon, the instructional guides.

[07:24:41] The standard is staying the same, and that's on the left. That's skills and practice. Notice we got the leaf. We asked. We said, the leaf is going to appear on every single one of them. Are you sure you want the leaf? And our stakeholders said, we love the leaf.

[07:24:56] Background on the leaf is the only thing we could miniaturize to the size of a bullet without losing the integrity of it. So that's why we have a leaf. If you look at the SOL assessments reports by question, there's this limp-looking leaf or egg-looking thing that is their widget of a leaf.

[07:25:16] Because we said the worst thing that could happen is if we say we value this, but it's not in the assessments, then it won't be done. So our assessment team stepped up, found the cheapest widget they could find, and made sure that leaf was clearly evident on those SOL tests.

[07:25:33] So that leaf will stay. So instead of moving objects have kinetic energy, the students are going to identify objects that have kinetic energy and describe the motion in terms of direction, relative speed and

position. That really ramps up the rigor of that standard and really tells teachers what are they supposed to do about moving objects have kinetic energy.

[07:25:56] When it says friction is a force that opposes motion, have the students plan and conduct an investigation to determine the effect of friction on moving objects. Let them determine the problem. Let them ask the questions. Let them collect the data. We can't do that for all labs.

[07:26:11] We have to make sure maybe there's some experiences that precede that to enable them to do that. But we need to have students plan and conduct versus giving them worksheets with the steps And they don't really gain anything from the end. And we have to follow up to make sure that the students understand the science concepts that led to that and the results of that experiment.

[07:26:34] So really drawing it out and having them be explicit on what science concepts were involved and what that planning and conducting an investigation was. Now, this is the fun part. In the concepts and connections section, now the math, you're going to look at the math instructional guides.

[07:26:53] You're going to look at the computer science instructional guides. You're going to look at the science. They all look the same. We're very in-line people. And as I said, we have no imagination at all. But in this section, we have common student misconceptions. These are very informed by research.

[07:27:11] And so we identified through research the misconception. And then we put in what is the real scientific explanation. I will say one of my colleagues, I'm not going to say which division he's from, He took our misconceptions documents.

[07:27:27] We had one for life science, for earth sciences, and for physical sciences. And he made them all true-false questions and gave it to all of his high school teachers. They failed. They are common misconceptions for a reason. So just identifying it as a misconception won't do it.

[07:27:44] We have to say this is what it really is. And then hopefully provide those experiences in the classroom with a common phenomena. And for students to experience it and be able to tie that understanding, too. Just telling somebody that's a misconception doesn't work. We have to provide those learning experiences that helps them reshape their thinking.

[07:28:04] We're including the cross-cutting concepts. Again, this is informed by the 2012 Framework for Science Education. And they built in something called cross-cutting concepts. There are six cross-cutting concepts. Six overall. Seven.

[07:28:19] Sorry. I always leave out the computational thinking. There are seven cross-cutting concepts overall, and the content can be taught through the lens of any of those cross-cutting concepts. However, the science team identified these are two lenses you can teach this standard through and this is why.

[07:28:37] And then those connections. First of all, the one thing that a very positive thing about the 2018 curriculum framework was the vertical alignment component. What came before this instruction and what is coming after? So then the teachers knew, if I'm going to give a pre-assessment, they should know this information and if they don't i know i have to address that gap some teachers like to over teach and extend beyond you know where are those parameters what is coming up next and how can i shape that to help fit where they're going to next um we also put um the cross content areas

[07:29:11] as i said mathematics and science are tied computer science all of us use data all of us use algorithmic thinking how are those connections so we tie to those standards specifically. We have also

integrated the ELA. That took a lot of work because in K-5, you have adopted HQIM. So we had to go through the different ones and find areas where we can match so that if you have this HQIM, here's an area where you can have some integration.

[07:29:41] If you have this HQIM, you can have this area. We have also putting in the Digital Learning Integration Standards and are currently working on building in WIDA supports. So these are all going to be in the instructional guides. If you've seen instructional guides and say, this is the next American novel, just realize there's a lot in there and it's really powerful stuff.

[07:30:04] The timeline for these, the video team developed drafts instructional guides, but we need to make sure they're as accurate as possible. We need to make sure they resonate with what stakeholders need. We're finalizing things in the instructional guides. We've had new standards come out. We have just finished up work with WIDA and we still have to implement that in, Laura is going to be rolling them out with different stakeholders to get more feedback.

[07:30:29] They're currently with the Virginia and Math Science Coalition and they're looking at stuff now. These documents are composed of the same part. We have the understanding of the standards, the skills and practice, concepts and connections so it does resonate with the others to support those elementary students that are teaching so many subjects across the board.

[07:30:50] In terms of professional development, we do have professional development coming up. the science team has a whole series of professional developments they hope to offer monthly starting August of 2025. The first one that always rolls out is safety, but hopefully the standards will be adopted and we'll be able to do an introduction to the 2025 Science Standards of Learning webinar. And we'll have it differentiated for different stakeholders. Parents, this is what they are. This is the opportunities provided. This is how it could potentially lead to different fields or different academic programs. You know, teachers, this is this and these are

[07:31:28] the constructs of the understanding, the standard documents are going to support the work. Board members, this is what needs to be considered when adding these to your program of studies. In May and June of 2025, we are currently doing a supporting implementation of science standards of learning professional learning course series. And this is being conducted through monies funded by the Office of School Quality. And we had 641 people register for

[07:32:02] the courses. We had 71 slots. But we pointed them in another direction. We do have STEM Professional Learning, which is building discipline mastery through integrated STEM instruction. And these are for grade-through-8 teachers. They are occurring this summer. If you'd like to go to any, I'd be happy to have you. They're face-to-face. We have webinars. And it's a true collaboration between the Office of STEM, the Office of Educational Technology and Classroom Innovation, and Career and Technical Education.

[07:32:31] So all of us came together to provide PD for teachers across the state. We are going to continue that learning at the webinars through the four disciplines and integrate STEM topics in the fall as Laura also rolls out the PD for division leaders.

[07:32:48] And then with science, a lot of our rural divisions do not have science dedicated instructional staff at the division level. So providing teacher supports as well. So teacher PD in the afternoon, division leader PD in the morning.

[07:33:04] And we're going to be providing ongoing professional development planning and support as requested by the Office of School Quality. Last but not least, we have a couple awards. We have the Presidential Award for Excellence in Mathematics and Science Teaching. And I'm excited to say this year we have five teachers recognized, and we're harsh.

[07:33:24] They have to be the best. And we have a team of stakeholders that are educators, prior recipients, people from out in the field that are a part of the evaluation team. And we identified two mathematics teachers, Jennifer Feehan from Fakir and John Micah from Fairfax as our mathematics teacher representatives for Virginia, and the three science representatives are Russell Cole from Massadnutton Regional Governor School for Integrated Environmental Science and Technology, longest school name ever, Kristen Salonga, a science teacher at Justin High

[07:34:00] School, and Daryl Smith. As I said, they're going to be coming to the board later, and you will get to meet them, but they're very exciting, passionate educators, and we are excited to have them as representatives. And the last award is the Virginia Green Ribbon Schools. This award application is insane. It is composed of three pillars, the amount of data that must be submitted to be even considered for this ward. The applications are 20 pages long, and they have to compile what is the energy usage in the school, what is, you know, exactly what are the water-saving measures, how is

[07:34:39] your pest control management, what staff resources do you have to support their wellness, what does instruction look like? It is a very extensive application. Belmont Elementary School in Prince William won it this year and Cardinal Ridge Elementary School in Lauderdale. So we are very excited to have these schools recognized for such a high level of commitment to our environment.

[07:35:05] And that is it for science. What questions do you have? Questions on science. Thank you so much. Awesome. Thank you. Thank you. Okay. Do we need to take a quick break before we try to finish

[07:35:24] some things up. Yes? No? Quick break? Yes? Okay, five minutes. Next presentation. Okay, great. So since

[07:44:10] most of my team has given you assignments over the holiday weekend, Calypso is coming in with AI performance or AI information to help you read through those, speed through those with some good stuff. So Calypso Gilstrap is over the Educational Technology and Classroom Innovation office. They do a lot to integrate. I think you've seen that throughout the day, how they integrate in the other content areas. And so she's going to just talk to you today about the computer science, where we're going with those standards, and then what we've done

[07:44:46] with artificial intelligence and where we're going. So, let's say. President Creasy, board members, and Superintendent Gullickson, I'm here to tell you about our team's diligent work in implementing Executive Order 30 and how our external partners are seeing how Virginia is leading the way in AI strategy for K-12 education. To prepare students for high-demand careers while ensuring that they have digital wellness, we have to integrate the technology thoughtfully.

[07:45:27] We also need to make sure that our computer science and digital learning strategies are embedded into the curriculum, not like the icing on the cake, but the salt in the cake to enhance their technology interactions with real world things. Today, I'm going to talk about our efforts and the impacts being rippling around the Commonwealth with the strategies we've been using this year. Now, AI and computer science affect everything. So we feel like it hits most of the priorities of the board and also

supports the Virginia Educational Technology Plan, which you guys adopted in December of 2023 as part of the board's comprehensive plan.

[07:46:04] We are going to specifically talk about AI in the area of use, which promotes the use of a variety of innovative instructional strategies, practices, and resources that are developed with current emerging, that's what we're talking about today, is emerging technology, and then making sure that is accessible to all of our students through innovative instructional approaches.

[07:46:28] So under Executive Order 30, the VDOE is directed to develop and issue tools instructional resources, and to help integrate AI into education at all levels. The guidelines for AI integration in education focus on the responsible and effective AI implementation across Virginia schools. In April, the Advancing Artificial Intelligence Education for American Youth Executive Order was signed by President Donald Trump, which focuses on embedding AI education within U.S. schools and workforce development programs. As you will see through this presentation Virginia has already taken a significant steps towards this

[07:47:05] direction first we have the Virginia 2020 digital learning integration standards of learning which actually have been adopted in different varieties since 2005 and they establish a strong foundation for AI literacy by focusing on key liter key digital literacy competencies they equip students with essential skills for an evolving world ensuring that they become ethical informed, and technologically proficient students. They need to be digital citizens, knowledge constructors, empowered learners, creative communicators, global collaborators,

[07:47:42] innovative designers, and computational thinkers. Those are all skills that we need when we're using technology. In the front matter of the 2024 computer science and English language arts standards, we highlight the importance of AI integration with digital technologies in teaching while while we also address the risks of using technology technology has transformed how people read write and communicate and with AI it's going to be further amplified with this shift students engage with AI driven tools and academic integrity is going to become more and more essential we need to

[07:48:20] ensure that we have responsible users that they are properly attributing where they get their information and that they have a critical evaluation when they're looking at AI-generated content. Integrating ethical practices into digital literacy prepares students to navigate technology with the accountability while enhancing their learning experiences. However, we have concerns about privacy, security, ethical use, and managing the integrity of those learning processes need to be prioritized. Students must learn to engage with tools thoughtfully and ethically to ensure their responsible utilization is not only in

[07:48:56] education, but also outside of education in their personal lives. The standards of digital learning, computer science, and then also our English language art standards, and the rest of the standards we adopt in the future, are going to make sure we have a balanced approach to make sure technology is integrated thoughtfully, and that we are also prioritizing innovation and ethical responsibility. So our computer science standards establish a strong connection between core computer science concepts and ai we are the first commonwealth state in the nation to adopt ai standards in computer science we were the first state to have computer science standards

[07:49:32] and now we're the first one to have ai explicitly in them so in algorithms and programming students develop computational thinking skills and they learn programming constructs decision trees and

flow charts these are all essential in understanding how ai drives neural networks and mimics human learning behaviors computing systems introduces perception automation input output functions and it lets the ai's ability to process and analyze data cyber security is about protecting data addressing algorithm bias and promoting ethical usage of ai and understanding privacy

[07:50:09] law user agreements and ethical and considerations ensure that students responsibly engage with ai by machine learning applications. The integration of these computer science standards must be used to harness the potential while they're navigating the risks of using technology.

[07:50:25] So here's an example of a lesson that we might see in a school. So this instructional plan exemplifies an interdisciplinary approach that we wanna see connecting computer science, math, and English. So in fifth grade, students would learn about data sets and be introduced to machine learning.

[07:50:42] In sixth grade, they start curating, creating their own data sets. And by seventh grade, they understand how data sets contribute to computational thinking, helping build machine learning and artificial intelligence systems. So in seventh grade, they would create their own data set by maybe being in a PE class and making an individual screen time log.

[07:51:02] Then in mathematics, they would take that data and study trends, creating neural networks and understanding how the decisions could be made in that graph. And then in English, they could interpret the AI and the data and the ethical use, helping them understand when do I use AI, what kind of privacy would I want to have my private data put into the AI machine to be shared. So this is what we want to see happening by integrating computer science, digital learning into our other standards. So to prepare our educators for this world where we have integrated computer science and digital learning standards, we have worked with Germanna Community

[07:51:41] College, and we had a creative revolution workshop with our educators. Over three months in the fall of 2024, we had 360 educators participate in person and remote learning sessions, gaining insights about AI's theoretical, ethical, and practical aspects. Now, this was a train-the-trainer model, so those 360 educators then went back to their school divisions, sorry, 560 educators go back to their school divisions and train the teachers in their own schools. Educators received resources they compared ai they were able to get prompting guides and rubrics on how to select ai how to use it in their classroom at the end of the show at the end in march we had a showcase

[07:52:21] we had 70 different educators who took the um training come back and show us what they learned and what they were doing um our feedback was overwhelming uh with positive things like 89 of the people said it was an excellent workshop which if you've ever run a workshop you know that's That's a really great statistic, but this was most impressive.

[07:52:41] 100% of our participants said they want more training. So we know that that's a need that we need to provide for. 85% of our teachers felt comfortable with using AI in their classroom after taking the training. So this is one of the projects that our educators showcased at the showcase in March.

[07:53:01] And that was basically they showed us how they were using AI to become more productive. So for instance, they were able to automate routine tasks, personalized learning for their students, enhance their classroom management, and they were able to look at data-driven insights based on their students' data.

[07:53:20] We also worked with our leaders, the Virginia Association of School Superintendents in collaboration with the Virginia Department of Education, worked with advanced learning partnerships to create this super awesome, innovative way of training 75 of our Virginia school systems who came together in cabinet-level strategic planning meetings.

[07:53:39] There were four days in which they came together, and we worked on understanding what generative AI is, evaluating AI's role in education, and then this was probably the most fun part, and that was playing with AI and coming up with practical applications on how we would do things in our schools.

[07:53:57] Our superintendents went from 34% to 88% feeling comfortable with integrating AI into schools after that. We also were able to take everything they created and put it into one website. So any of our school divisions, even if they didn't participate, are able to have access to vendor letters, parent letters, policies that they created, procurement guides, those type things.

[07:54:21] So both our educator and leadership upskilling in AI digital literacy and CS allows schools to focus on fostering responsible and purposeful technology use. Digital citizenship programs, clear guidelines, structured integration on tech-based learning can help students develop self-regulation and professional etiquette in those digital spaces. When we embrace technology and education, we are creating a workforce that is ready to go to work in a digital world. In this slide, I'm not going to make you watch it. Instead, I have homework for you. Sorry, Dr. Wallace.

[07:54:54] You guys need to listen to our podcast, Activated Learning. Episode 206 has Louisa County Public schools and how they're integrating AI into their CTE program. It's super cool. And if you're not listening to the podcast, highly recommend subscribing. That one's a lot more fun than reading policies or something like that. So alongside with our AI initiatives, we also are supporting the model policy concerning internet safety by providing professional development, assisting school divisions with implementation and maintaining curated internet safety resources, which now include AI-related materials on the VDOE webpage.

[07:55:30] You're going to hear more about this tomorrow, but we did specifically seek feedback when we're revising the policy and making sure we integrate AI into that policy. As AI continues to evolve, we want to make sure our parents and our guardians really understand the implications and also really encourage responsible use of AI.

[07:55:50] To advance that goal, VDOE is going to spend the next six months developing resources, including videos interactive tools and printed materials that we can give to school divisions so parents understand how does ai come into school and then how can they help their own child understand what ai is use at home so specifically related to computer science we have all these different things going on here to help our educators be able to implement in a structured system so we have instruction data collection educator assistance we are working on getting better at accessibility and technology integration where we're collaborating with those school

[07:56:30] divisions on how do you best have a ces ready school and then we are working really hard with vcu right now to create a common computing in the commonwealth dashboard where we can really see and spotlight those areas where we see computer science being really successful we also have the advancing computer science education grant last year for the fy25 appropriation we gave out one million ninety seven hundred thousand dollars to 16 different school divisions if you listen to the podcast you'll

hear some of the cool things that we're doing with that axes grant we also were able to give out i think amanda's going to talk about this more we were able to give out 320

[07:57:08] 000 to 11 schools to advance ap computer science with that axes grants money we also work with partners like code va the virginia commonwealth university and the advancing rural computer science education grantees who they basically take what our dreams are and make them come true we also have honored a computer science educator of the year so the day after our virginia educator of the year was honored we were able to honor our cs champions these are teachers who are working in regular classrooms and integrating computer science the way we want

[07:57:43] to see that happen and then our digital learning program we have driven all over the state supporting our itrt's and school librarians making sure that they are ready to lead the way with professional development with our regular classroom teachers we also have collaborative relationships we don't have a consortium ourselves instead we go to the eight regions and visit their collaboratives to make sure we're meeting them where they're at and we also have developed an itrt best practices course which also includes how to integrate ai into the classroom and this is my office thanks everybody on my office who's doing great work um and if i you guys have any questions

[07:58:23] or comments i'm happy to take them or i'll ask chat dpt and he'll get back to you you're the best dr norther all right i just want to know like the elephant in the room is how our kids we've got 56 percent of kids in college saying they're using ai to cheat so obviously the numbers that we're seeing at the high school level are creeping up so what are we doing around you know kids who are using ai to cheat so uh as of right now most of our school divisions have blocked chats from a school device now we know that doesn't circumvent all cheating on a personal device but we know

[07:59:01] school divisions are trying to be more intentional about the way that they are training but also that's why the educator training is going to be so important we're working with school divisions really hard to have those like really clear acceptable use of when we're allowed to use it when we're not allowed to use it we think it's really important for workforce development that we teach kids how to use it not block them from using it we know this is kind of different than all other emerging technology like parents don't know what ai is teachers don't know what ai like we're all kind of learning at the exact same time what it is that's why we also would say computer

[07:59:40] science standards are so important because kids are learning to leverage ai instead of cheating with ai so i guess our answer is cheating's been happening forever and we need to teach kids why we want to learn things not while we want to just get the grade to pass things i do know our teachers are very aware though that kids are cheating using lots of different ways and that's where rapport relationships with kids are going to be really important because you know it's ai when you read it and you don't hear that kid's voice and when we give those high quality questions and critical

[08:00:16] thinking computational thinking designed lessons and assessments then it's harder to cheat because you get to see that work of like they got to pick something they really are interested in i saw first draft and i saw them brainstorming and outlining and those type things so that being said i have a kid in high school and she was using an ai yesterday to come up with interview questions for her ap u.s history assignment and it was a very thoughtful to watch her prompt engineer like my mom was born in 19 something or other and i want to ask her some questions about history what would be some good examples and then it popped out some questions for her and then she was able then

[08:00:55] to go and use her u.s history resources to do some more research about 9 11 and those type things so it is a collaborator we just need to teach kids what are the boundaries the guidelines and when is it not okay to use because we are concerned about them taking personal information dropping that like i didn't appreciate that my birthday got put into chat gpt last night um but that's okay so but we but that's again relationships building those kind of things cheating is definitely not okay and educator training will hopefully and you know student conduct creating acceptable use policies updating the internet safety policy hopefully those type things will help us have

[08:01:33] that messaging on when we can use it, when we can't use it. Mr. Rotherham. Thank you, Madam President. First of all, CLIPSA, thank you. What a great presentation. And this is exciting. And one of the things when you ask, if you ask AI which states are leading, it puts Virginia up in the top five. And I think there's a lot of reasons for that, including I'm doing some work with NASB on this. And our executive order is like, it is comprehensive. It's a model.

[08:02:01] Other states want to know what we're doing because people are trying to figure this out. And so it's great i just want to put a word in for i think uh i think ai is great i think you're what you what you just said a moment ago about we have to make sure kids understand it from an employment standpoint it is i think it's going to be more disruptive you're already starting to see this if you track layoffs and so forth it's going to be more disruptive than than it might appear at first glance may also create other jobs but we we certainly can't not let kids understand it and know how to use it and all that i do think there's two things that are really important that that are

[08:02:33] not ai specific but um that tied at one is the problem with with the shortcuts on ai is this idea like you you learn by productive struggle we do hard things we get good at things then you go do harder things and so forth ai just obviates that completely right and that's a big problem for how people learn and so it's really important we train our teachers to make sure that they are doing that and and we do have this sort of ethos that kind of bubbled up with 21st century skills and everything else that like oh who needs to like teach content because kids can look it up

[08:03:07] on google like that kind of got thankfully beaten back but it's coming roaring back now with ai who needs content because kids can look it up on on ai and so if we're teaching this stuff we're wasting everybody's time we're gonna have to push back against that that's my second point like this makes the work we're doing whether it's on hqim on standards on content it makes it even more important that we really anchor in a knowledge-rich curriculum because ai is great but also it's not hard to make it hallucinate it's not easy to see that if you have a if you're using it for things we have a trained eye and the only way you have a trained eye is that sort of content knowledge and

[08:03:43] so i really hope we're going to hear about how ultimately this is being sort of integrated across the agency um and it's not like ai is over here and curriculum everything else over here that we're linking it because i i think danger lies ahead if we're not really careful we already have enough of a sort of content problem in general um uh that danger lies if we don't really keenly so that's that's just a push to keep doing what you're doing i think it's super thoughtful but make sure we're doing it it's a great way thank you and the president uh well miss mcpherson

[08:04:21] thank you on the ai perspective you know given the president's executive what i just want to say as you move forward if you look clearly at ai and workforce development because we're going to have all of this equipment that is going to need high level skill training to operate ai equipment so i'd like to see as we

go along how we look at ai and workforce development and you know funding in that area i also wanted to kind of like your presentation was great i want to give

[08:04:57] a shout out to the 2025 computer science um winners because we talked about the ones that were in in math and um i'll let you do that because i i just think we got to always promote the people that are doing such a great job so well we close out we're hoping in november they will be at the board meeting for computer science week and we'll be able to honor them then uh and if you aren't on the board then we still invite you to come back to come to the meeting and celebrate them um so we will and we will make sure they'll also all be on the podcast just to you know plug the podcast

[08:05:33] again um so but yes we absolutely have honored them we have been to their schools and videotaped them and our but we would love for you to meet them in november thank you my team is really good at giving assignments to um enhance your prior knowledge um our last presentation for you this afternoon is the advanced learning instructional update. I'm really excited about this program or this program update. Amanda Nevitrol is our director of advanced learning. This office has

[08:06:11] had somewhat of a transition over the last few years and just in the past it hasn't the office itself has not been really in the community of the schools and Amanda has taken this program to a totally another level she's out there in the school divisions all of the time working with governor schools and gifted educators and always trying to figure out how she can reach those and provide support to those gifted directors whereas that has been from a division perspective coming from the division recently kind of a underserved group of individuals at the

[08:06:48] division level particularly if you're from a rural school division and your gifted programs might look very different than say a school division that's in an urban area so i introduce amanda and really give her kudos her team of two she and one other individual have been doing mammoth work across the state with advanced learning and certainly does connect to other areas that you've heard today thank you president creasy board members and superintendent gullickson i'm amanda

[08:07:24] of Vetrel and I'm pleased to be with you today to present an update from the Office of Advanced Learning. I know you've done a lot of listening today. We are a new office and we are super excited to be here. Our office supports division leaders and programs around the Commonwealth that meet the needs of Virginia's advanced learners. I would like to thank Kevin Carr, the specialist with the Office of Advanced Learning, for his support with this work. The growth of advanced learners is important and outlined clearly in the board's strategic priorities. Gifted and advanced learners

[08:07:59] deserve to thrive and experience academic growth in a classroom environment where high expectations are prioritized and innovative pathways are crafted and implemented to meet individual needs. Our office is pleased to have offered professional development for our gifted coordinators this past year in the areas listed on the slide. Most recently, we have been working closely with the math team in the Office of STEM to support divisions with the implementation of HB 2686,

[08:08:34] which promotes enrollment in advanced or accelerated math courses for students in grades five through eight through auto-enrollment and other means of eligibility. The Code of Virginia requires that all school boards develop, approve, and implement a local plan for the education of the gifted. Every plan is reviewed on a five-year cycle and a technical review process. This school year our office worked with divisions in regions five and six to train over 80 division personnel on the technical review protocol and provide valuable peer feedback to school divisions

[08:09:09] regarding their gifted education programs the code of virginia also requires that data is collected annually on students referred for gifted education services and students identified for gifted Education Services, in addition to division-specific programmatic data. This report is publicly available and currently consists of a static PDF state-level report. In collaboration with VDOE's data team, we are excited that this data will be displayed in a Build-A-Table format beginning in Fall 2025. This will allow for stakeholders to actively engage with state and division-level data

[08:09:48] in a new way and increase transparency for gifted identification across the state the virginia advisory committee for advanced learning met last week to provide feedback on a technical resource document that will support divisions in the implementation of hb 2686 and a companion family document that will guide parents to understand more about advanced and accelerated math pathways i would like to thank all members of this committee and especially the chair mark Levy for prioritizing this important work. We plan to release these resources to the field in parallel

[08:10:23] with upcoming webinar trainings that will support divisions in the refinement or creation of accelerated math pathways. As we move into the summer and next school year, we are looking forward to further exploration of seat time flexibility for advanced learners, including the potential to pilot innovative ideas in our academic year governor schools, and supporting school divisions and implementation of more rigorous standards in history, English and mathematics that allow for students to demonstrate competency and proceed on personalized learning pathways. We are working closely with content teams as

[08:11:00] well as the Office of Accountability to support divisions and acceleration efforts in middle school and math, social studies and science. One of the highlights during my past two years at the department has been visiting all 19 academic year governor schools and seeing firsthand the learning opportunities that are provided to advanced and gifted learners by the directors and staff of these schools. In collaboration and partnership with the Office of Educational Technology and Classroom Innovation, the directors of the academic year governor schools and PBS Appalachia, videos promoting the opportunities that each governor school offers are being filmed and curated over

[08:11:40] a two-year period to be used on VDOE's website and media pages and for school divisions to better communicate these programs to students. To ensure alignment to best practices for gifted and advanced students, each academic year governor's school receives a full-site evaluation every six years.

[08:11:59] In 2024, the guidelines were updated to include standardization for the collection of achievement data, implementation of a stakeholder survey to drive strategic planning, utilization of common interview questions, and a rubric that was updated to reflect alignment with the National Association for Gifted Children's most recent programming standards. Finally, I'm excited to announce there is a proposal for a new academic year governor's school on deck for June 2025. The new River Valley Governor's School is an effort between Radford University and five local school divisions to offer an advanced program for students interested in the arts

[08:12:37] and humanities in southwest Virginia. Tomorrow, I will present an update to the procedures for initiating an academic year governor's school to support the new River Valley Governor's School Planning Committee and other future committees in this work. The Office of Advanced Learning coordinates and supports school divisions in offering advanced juniors and seniors the opportunity to apply for and potentially attend one of seven summer residential governor schools.

[08:13:05] These 637 seats are highly competitive and attract many public private and homeschool students from around the commonwealth. Our office works closely with our partnering universities to select students based on applicant score and graduation year while ensuring a commitment to regional diversity. In summer 2024 our office was pleased to partner with Radford University to offer the medicine and health sciences program after a five-year hiatus.

[08:13:34] One of our proudest accomplishments in the past two years is working to update and streamline the application process for increased usability. Changes included moving to a digital version of the application, implementing in partnership with Radford University, who hosts our visual and performing arts program, a virtual adjudication process.

[08:13:54] We also realigned the application to include the addition of a personal narrative and the the elimination of unnecessary barriers, including additional testing. To support school divisions in implementing these changes, we added extra supports, including videos and technical support documents on our advanced learning Canvas course.

[08:14:12] In summer 2025, we are looking forward to an additional partnership with PBS Appalachia to produce videos for each of these programs. Similarly, these videos will be available for school division use to advertise this opportunity to students.

[08:14:27] The Office of Advanced Learning also supports summer regional governor schools as well, which are funded through the General Assembly to provide enrichment programs for advanced and gifted students connected to their region. Most programs are focused on elementary or middle school students, but several offer opportunities for high school students.

[08:14:46] Although all programs will not operate this summer, we were able to reallocate funding to operating programs to increase opportunities for those students. Our office supports advanced placement, international baccalaureate, and Cambridge programming across the Commonwealth.

[08:15:04] I'm going to review some highlights from the past year and then share some enrollment data from each of these programs. One highlight included developing the process and procedures for the implementation of the AP/IB Cambridge Fee Reduction Program included in the 2024 budget bill.

[08:15:21] This appropriation provided funding for a reduced exam fee cost for economically disadvantaged students. 40 school divisions applied to receive funding and requests exceeded the appropriated amount, prompting an additional $150,000 in funds for this purpose added in the 2025 budget bill for fiscal year 26.

[08:15:41] In December 2024, our office worked with the Office of STEM and Humanities to assist the board in adding additional IB courses to the list of board approved courses for graduation, allowing greater flexibility for IB diploma students and other students wishing to take an IB course and have that course count for graduation.

[08:16:00] In April 2025, changes were made to the SCEDCO document to better align the middle year program or MYP IB courses with the International Baccalaureate program. And this was prompted by both school division requests and from the International Baccalaureate organization.

[08:16:17] We are also currently working closely with SHEV to improve the transferability of IB credits to Virginia universities. I am also pleased to speak about a collaboration with the Office of Education

Technology and Classroom Innovation to expand AP Computer Science coursework in school divisions, using funding from the Advancing Computer Science Education Appropriation.

[08:16:40] In total, 14 school divisions applied to receive funding to expand access to AP Computer Science principles and/or AP Computer Science. Specific examples of how funding will be utilized is noted on the slide.

[08:16:56] Here's an overview of advanced placement enrollment and achievement from the past five years. Although COVID influenced numbers, AP course enrollment is continuing to rebound and experience growth. Looking from left to right, the number of students enrolled in at least one AP course is displayed, followed by how many courses are being offered, and then on the far right, the percentage of students earning a three or better on an AP exam.

[08:17:21] Here's an overview of international baccalaureate enrollment achievement displayed in a similar way, although the department has only one year of IB testing available on this slide. Here we also see a pandemic-related dip, but expect a gradual rebound in divisions that choose to offer this program. The Cambridge Advanced International Certificate of Education program offers students an opportunity to earn college credit and currently is only offered in Prince William County. A little over 1,000 students were recorded by

[08:17:54] PWCS as being enrolled in an AICE course in school year 23-24. No testing data is available currently, but the department is working to gather testing data for future years. Our office works closely with the Office of Career and Technical Education to nominate outstanding Virginia students for the U.S. Presidential Scholars Program, a program started by an executive order in 1964. In April 2025, the 10 semifinalists from Virginia were announced by the U.S. Department of Education. Finalists will be named in late May 2025. I'm pleased to

[08:18:33] share the 10 semifinalists from Virginia and join the board and Superintendent Gullickson in congratulating them on this remarkable achievement. Finally, I am thrilled to continue to support school divisions including principals division leaders and teachers and further engagements this summer and beyond i really appreciate your time today and i'm happy to answer any questions i have a question yes i would really like for you to come back and talk to us a little bit more in depth about um ib programs across the state uh specifically how many schools or school divisions

[08:19:12] are engaging in myp i know you don't know that off the top of your head but that's um a really interesting angle to sort of solving i think a lot of the problems that we talked about today uh specifically in our um reading and our uh our new vla four through eight i i just think that there can be a lot of fusion there with myp and how we address kind of overcoming some of those

[08:19:46] barriers in ensuring that our students in those middle years are getting to the place that they need to be to be reading and to be kind of making those cross-curricular connections that oftentimes really do assist in comprehension and um you know i think to some degree deep in brain development but uh but i do think that that would be an interesting presentation to have you all have you specifically come back and provide us with a lot of that um kind of in-depth data and

[08:20:25] information around the ib program and its use in virginia specifically since you have seen i'm glad that you guys are working towards this in enhancing what chev is accepting and how can we sort of be

leaders in that in that realm of pushing those credentials those credits to be transferred into our institutions of higher education so i appreciate that absolutely happy

[08:20:57] to do that any other questions or comments dr northern i am so excited you're here um i am just thrilled because we have been you know trying to get vacal going i think i heard you said vacal met we did last friday awesome and your national experts were fantastic fantastic okay that's good um what i realized as i was sitting here earlier is that like the big thing that everybody

[08:21:31] recommends is using universal screening in K-3 with a diagnostic or interim assessment. What do we have in Virginia? We have a diagnostic or interim assessment that we use in K-3. So we could be doing, like, honestly, that's like low-hanging fruit. We could be universally screening all of our kids in the early grades, right, to see if they can be identified, right?

[08:21:56] Because what happens, as you guys know this, is that kids don't get identified unless they've a pushy parent sometimes and a lot of kids who otherwise should be identified um are not being identified so we want a fair universal screener that goes to all kids period um and so i would love i don't know if our national experts brought that up or better even know that we already we do we're ahead of the curve on many states with that um so that would be really exciting if we could use like another make another use of that universal screening in in the early grades to identify kids

[08:22:31] who would otherwise not be identified because we want to get them quick quickly right because again catching these kids early is so important in terms of developing their talents um and then the um the subject acceleration is another one that i hope that we can talk about you know sometimes we parents are reticent to have their kids skip an entire grade because of developmental issues or they want their kids to be with kids their own age but the subject acceleration is another one that's really popular among parents because they know their kid loves math or their kid loves science and and they could be doing the next the next subject in that um in the queue um so those

[08:23:09] are just two areas that just dawned on me as you were talking and congratulations for getting the committee together and i'm so glad to see the forward momentum here thank you uh miss holton thank you just in follow-up to dr northern's point uh amber are you saying that the vowels screener you're asking whether we could explore using the vowels screener or as in somehow to use it as a gifted education that's right as a universal screener for because a lot of states don't have an interim or diagnostic universal screener at that young of an age i mean it's just

[08:23:45] literacy it's not that's right it's just literacy it's an interesting idea that we might might be able to find ways to build on but my question was going to be to slide 11 that's the data on ap participation and that uh it's uh my comment first is it's very exciting to see that enrollment in both individual courses by student or by courses uh obviously dipped during the pandemic but um it was a year delay after the pandemic so that's a little bit of a mystery but then has rebounded

[08:24:21] significantly so it's now well above pre-pandemic level if i understand that correctly yes that's terrific and yet I see that the percentage passing at a level through a grade three or below has slipped so I'm not you know the math of that is more students taking it fewer student smaller percentage passing just you have any thoughts on what's going on there and what we can do about it well one thing that comes to mind is really utilizing and expanding knowledge and access to some of the tools that College Board offers in particular I'm really thinking about AP Classroom, which is a digital platform

[08:25:00] that school divisions, teachers, students can access for practice test prep questions, essay prompts, daily videos about the content. And I meet with College Board Monthly, and we talk about how to ensure that all of our advanced placement teachers, students, division leaders really know about all the tools that College Board has to offer.

[08:25:27] And I think that's certainly something that we can continue to push on because it is a very helpful resource for that. - Ms. Holtan. - Yeah, I think that's a great idea. And that prompts one other question, which is have we looked at percentage of kids who are taking the AP courses, are taking the exams?

[08:25:48] 'Cause obviously you can't get a three or better if you're not taking the exam. And there is, we've heard some suggestion, including from our Student Advisory Board last year, that the cost of the AP exams is a barrier for some students. I do think there's been some limited state appropriation to help address that, but I don't think it meets the need.

[08:26:08] So do you have any sense of what the need, is the cost of the exams a barrier that's preventing some of these students from passing? Or do we know? - So I feel like I heard two questions. The first being, I do have access to that data.

[08:26:24] I don't have it off the top of my head, but looking at how many students are enrolled in AP courses versus how many are taking the AP exam would be certainly something that we could bring back to the board at a later date. You know, this was the first time in Virginia that we had that appropriation to help support exam fee costs.

[08:26:41] And we did receive an overwhelming number of responses from school divisions requesting funding that, like I said in the presentation, did exceed the appropriated amount. We're excited to have that additional funding for next year, but also really want to ensure that all of our divisions know about this opportunity.

[08:27:04] And as we communicate that more, I'm curious to see when we put this out in fiscal year 26, what divisions will respond and what requests will be made. I would just suggest that if you can document what the gap is between enrolled in the class and taking the exam and document that you've got more demand than you can meet with the existing appropriation and especially if you can crosswalk that with demographic data geographic socioeconomic etc would bet that would be a you could make a very effective case to general assembly to expand

[08:27:41] that appropriation that would be fantastic thank you okay final comment unless mr rotherham has a comment go ahead question madam president is that okay please it's in the traditional form it's actually it's an it's an interrogative okay um actually i have two uh one is on ib we um we went to um uh you know we we went and crosswalked at the end of last calendar year um on ib to help kids were getting that qualified for the advanced studies diploma that have to take extra classes

[08:28:16] there was then some confusion about that in the IB community and I think some potentially confusing communications. Has that issue been resolved and is there is there clarity? So we have tried in our communications to make it as clear as possible the kind of the crosswalk between the IB diploma and the advanced studies diploma. Truthfully a lot of the barriers we I think IB communities are feeling is that the standards of accreditation have certain requirements in them that prevent ultimate flexibility for IB diploma candidates. And that is something we're actively working on within the

[08:28:53] department. Thank you. My other question was just, are we looking at other, there's a test that I'm not super familiar with, but I'm hearing it come up, the classical learning test. I think there's a bill in Congress to try to link it to the service academies. And, you know, again, I'm not familiar with it, but are we looking at that or any other sort of tests on the horizon that we could see incorporating?

[08:29:18] And if we did, what would be the validation process to make sure it's actually a good assessment and is comparative with things we do next? So we have definitely heard about the classic learning test, and it is new to me and new to the department, but we have a meeting with them actually next week to explore a dated sharing agreement.

[08:29:36] And we'll certainly ask questions about validity and reliability at that point. Okay. Final thing. When does VACAL meet again? We anticipate the fall, but we do not have a meeting on the books as of yet.

[08:29:56] Okay. Because one thing I really would like for them to talk about is additional screening and repeat testing. Because a lot of our school divisions are a one and done. And that's often really effective in the early years.

[08:30:12] And then just brain development, student development, interest development, all of those things really shift and change. And some of those students start to fall off of that track for one reason or the other.

[08:30:28] And so I'd really like to hear that discussion with those particular experts. I think that'd be great. Absolutely. Thank you so much. Thank you. For the presentation today. Okay, so it's 5.30.

[08:30:47] What is the will? going to continue to hammer yes all right um you're up mark it's 5 30 i hope you're caffeinated

[08:31:04] let's go let them see you ready all right are we ready okay good afternoon or good early evening board president creasy superintendent gullickson and board members thank you for having us here today i am mark jennings executive director for the office of accountability yeah there's two we're

[08:31:44] gonna do the first one you're right on track and i'm joined by my colleague today dr anthony Williams the director for the office of career and technical education he'll be providing information as we do our second presentation on 3e readiness indicator and high quality work based learning first i'm going to share some updates on the implementation on the school performance and support framework and that is the first slide deck you see there so i want to begin with our overall guiding principles for our work i know the board has seen these the board helped develop these as we do webinars and speak to the field we go back to these because these are they help in

[08:32:24] in our work, not just for implementation, but how we develop accountability practices. And you've heard these themes throughout the presentations today. First, we begin with the North Star is our high expectations for every student. We've been talking about proficiency standards and definitions, determining standard setting.

[08:32:41] And so again, that North Star of high expectations that we wanna see for all students. Number two, we talk about transparency and access to actual information. And so when we think about data and reporting, We talk about internal and both external reporting. Again, we want to be very clear with the public about the results, how we're doing, but not only how we're doing, what can you do with that information?

[08:33:03] What are our next steps? Third, student academic growth and proficiency are both vital measures, but the system must prioritize getting every student to proficiency or mastery. And so we've seen that through the framework, the development of the framework. We heard comments around that today.

[08:33:19] That helps in the development of our work. Fourth, we see the importance again of trust between schools, parents, the community. Again, you see that word transparency, concrete and easy to understand reporting, which I'll talk about later. And then fifth, stakeholder input is critical.

[08:33:36] And so as we've gone through this process, both in the development, but now in the implementation stage, I'll share with you some of the stakeholder input we have currently, and then plans for future stakeholder input as we move to future implementation.

[08:33:51] So this is the Virginia School Performance Support Framework, you see on the left side of the presentation, on the right is our accreditation system. We've talked quite a bit about bifurcation, that earlier in the old system, accreditation wrapped many things. It included components from the standards of quality, components from the standards of accreditation, also wrapped in there were student performance outcomes.

[08:34:14] And now we've separated them. And so what you see on the left there is our flow chart of the framework. We've got our models for elementary and middle school. We have our model for high school. That information flows down to provide a score out of 100 that gives you a performance category.

[08:34:29] That same information is used for federal identification. So schools may or may not be identified, but it's one cohesive system. And then that, if they are identified, leads to additional funding from a federal government and support from the Office of School Quality. That's that OSQ support.

[08:34:49] So I want to give some updates. We continue to hold weekly office hours. We held them today, actually. We do them every Wednesday. We've been doing that since November. We usually have around 80 participants. It varies. Right now we're heavy into testing season, so today was a little smaller. But they submit questions in advance or they come with live questions, and we work with other offices to provide answers.

[08:35:09] It's a great way for us to see trends across the state, you know, what questions they have, where are there still gaps in understanding, and how can we be most responsive. In addition to that, we've done dedicated trainings. We've done trainings just for superintendents. We have training for division leaders.

[08:35:25] We've gone to conferences and organizations. And then we've also reached out to individual divisions. Well, they've reached out to us to say, can you do a training for our school board? Can you do a training for our division leaders? And we've been, our calendars are getting appointments for the summer to do more of those as they really wanna make sure their administrators and others understand as well.

[08:35:46] And so this is ongoing work. I do wanna highlight for you our road to readiness, the School Performance Support Framework Resource Hub. So when you type in VDOE, you go there, it's the first thing you see, there's a link to it. And this information has educator supports, family supports, superintendent, principal.

[08:36:05] It takes every indicator we have and helps you unpack it. And it says, you know, where might your school be with the performance category? You know, what resources might you use for a needs-

intensive support school or an off-track school? And then helps you dig into the individual indicators.

[08:36:20] We've worked across the department to develop this as a one-stop shop, and we'll continue to enhance these materials. After the board reviews our piece tomorrow, we've already got things lined up to enhance or to make sure the information is updated so that people can go and have exactly what they need.

[08:36:40] So I wanna talk about some next steps. Right now, we are developing the reports for our divisions on the School Performance Support Framework. So we're in testing season through the different divisions. And so what they are accustomed to seeing preliminary reports and so we're working on those that they could start to see as data's coming in how are they doing so what will happen is those will be released we're probably early june into mid-june we're very clear it's preliminary and we need to be clear about that because our growth data for elementary and middle school is not available until august and so even to try to get ahead and say well this is exactly how we're doing is very premature because the data we need

[08:37:19] back from our vendor, Vivas SaaS, comes back to us in August. So again, it's all going to be preliminary, but they could start to see how they're doing. The next wave of reports are student rosters, and this allows divisions to drill down to the student level, which is very important for this system. This system is very much predicated on the individual student, and so divisions can look and see across all indicators how is a student doing, and then they can build up to student groups and to the school and to the division, but we want to make sure the data is accurate and that gives them a chance to validate it to check their records against our records and

[08:37:53] clean things up before things are finalized next uh the board i'll be coming back uh throughout the summer we're working across the department to provide a standards of accreditation a guidance document and so this takes the standards of accreditation uh you know chapter 132 and walks through the different sections and says you know we want to provide interpretation and have the the board's approval on that.

[08:38:17] And so we'll start bringing pieces of that to you in June, July, and August from different offices to make sure that as divisions, look at the standards of accreditation, if there were changes or if there's needed clarity that you've weighed in and that they have a resource to point to.

[08:38:33] And then finally, we have been reflecting with our stakeholder groups and we're planning for school year 25, 26. What we'll be doing is we'll be back to the board, June, July, August, and probably to September. And we'll be bringing you one amendment, Amendment 9.

[08:38:51] But we're gonna sprinkle out through those months different items for you to consider. So just like today, you have time to process, ask questions. We also want the public to be engaged. And so we're going through different conferences and talking about some of the different topics with them.

[08:39:06] But as far as a final vote and putting it all together, instead of doing separate amendments and asking USC to continuously weigh in, we're gonna package them all together under Amendment 9. I said to you September purposefully because there's data that comes to us from high schools in August, and we want to make sure we have the most data we can have to make the most informed decisions, and so we're looking at these items.

[08:39:29] And so let me list some of them for you. One that we're talking about will be alternative accountability. This is something that we've heard from the field. We've had this previously. Our standards of accreditation speak to this. Because of our unified system, we will need approval from USED. So we've got to have a stakeholder group over the summer who will have data from this year, and so we'll use some of the high school data that comes in through August.

[08:39:51] So that'll be one of the later items. There were other items the board talked about previously as they adopted this that said, we want to look at this again. One being JROTC. The board, when they voted for enlistment as far as 3E said, we want to still have further conversation.

[08:40:06] And when I get to the second presentation, you'll see that. That came up in public comments about JROTC. And so we'll talk about that this summer as well. We also, when we adopted our amendment seven to our plan, we said we would need to come back to USED with an exit criteria for our federally identified schools.

[08:40:24] We needed the baseline data from this year. So that'll be another item we talk about throughout the summer. We would, after the standard settings complete, we will need to do reading and math goals. And so that'll be another item we talk about. And so those are just a few. There are a couple others around growth, some English learner items that we'll be bringing.

[08:40:42] We have them packaged in a way that we'll bring them to the board, we'll have conversation, the public will have an opportunity to weigh in, but because also we're doing it in a way that if the public, you know, it's being summer, if they miss an opportunity, they can still speak up later. Because again, the final votes not until probably first review August, final review September.

[08:41:02] So we don't, we want people to know in advance and we'll start sharing it in June, but also if people are out or miss something, there's no secret surprises, there'll be a chance to speak up later. So I wanted to give you that overview now, because the June board meeting is in just a few weeks, and then I'll start sharing the plan and sort of the items I was just referencing.

[08:41:21] So at this time, I will take questions because I do want to be as clear as we can about where we are now in this part, and then we'll move, which is connected to the 3E readiness indicator and high quality work-based learning.

[08:41:39] Thank you, Mark. I've got several questions. I wanted to start with helping me understand your timeline so I understand some of the data that will fit in will will go into the accountability framework won't be available until august is that what i understood so the growth data so i mean the timeline is we divisions about mid-july authorize their data they basically said to us this is verified it's ready to be

[08:42:04] processed wilson after that okay thanks everyone we um are having some technical difficulties with

[08:52:08] the internet here at reynolds community college we are doing our best to hold tight to the connection uh but we will do our best so mr jennings would you like to continue with your presentation yes so we i was answering some questions about school quality profile and reporting and if the superintendent would like i would come back to a future board meeting and share updates about our development of those reports uh and our plans and sort of the stage of development with that solton so i'm glad to hear your meeting with parents and others this

[08:52:47] summer to start this conversation i guess three points and would love to hear your your thoughts the the when this is i'm guilty of uh often up here saying um our newest member hasn't heard me go back the first time we did this but i'm sort of playing historian here but when we adopted the school quality profile the current rating the former rating system and the school quality profile that went along with it we we it was at least a year of adopting the design for the school

[08:53:25] quality profile itself and the board was intimately involved in it because it was a crucial piece of how we were communicating to parents students educators and the public about our rating systems so it is our you know it is the closest thing we have to to school report cards and division report cards and state report cards so um so we we it took us a lot of time i think the product is actually quite rich the amount of information on there as you know we can zero down on

[08:53:59] test scores by subject by school by demographic group etc it's got enrollment data it's got career college and career readiness data it's got learning climate it's got teacher quality it's got a wealth of information um but it's a complicated website so figuring out how to make it more um user friendly i think it's i think it is well utilized by educators i don't know that it's that well used by parents so figuring out how to have that wealth of information there for parents but in an accessible way i think it's a i think it's a big challenge and frankly i wish

[08:54:37] we'd start i wish i would have heard the answer that we started on this a year ago because i predict it's going to take a good long while to get it right and to make sure you don't lose any of that benefit and that you then um enable us to um uh incorporate the new accountability framework into it in a useful fashion um and and and i guess the third comment that just ties into that is uh can we add other readiness other information so for instance this morning dr northern asked about

[08:55:14] that value that rich um valves data we were hearing what it tells us about elementary readiness and as we all know none of that will factor into our accountability framework because that wasn't part of what we adopted last summer but is there at least a way we can connect that information display in whatever report card we do so that's a lot yeah no i'll just respond and say absolutely and that's why again we were talking about a phase one phase two approach phase one again you honor i think what the public's used to where they can find the information especially for this first year and then build those stakeholder groups have the conversation with

[08:55:53] the board and then phase two uh bring a fuller package and that involves just talking to other vendors of course there's finances involved with that um and so going through that whole process and so we've looked at some redesign already but again um for this stage of development like i said we're thinking honoring what we are now making changes so they have the information they need but then also bringing back to the board and saying these are the requirements under the every student cc's act because there are certain things you have to have on your state report card and your school report cards uh and then beyond that what else could we add to help the public and then you get into visualizations and things like that but knowing uh when certain information

[08:56:30] has to be released and sort of what the public is used to that's where for our our conversations right now are like i said are trying to honor that and make sure that this fall the information's available we don't want to make it we want to be as clear as we can this fall we don't want to have them trying to figure out well where's that information so like i said there's there's benefits to the familiarity of the this school quality profile even if we're not miss holton even if we're not going to make dramatic changes simply to

add the information about the school the new framework ratings on there that it's a lot of work and uh superintendent gullickson

[08:57:08] this comment may be more to you than to mark but that that may i'll be gone by then off my role on the board as of june but i hope you all put this and and madam president you all put this on steroids for the board and the department because to get it to even barely minimal useful information when you are releasing ratings in mid-September you've got a long road to go between now and mid-September to in terms of how you're going to share this information with the public and and the whole point of it is communicating to parents I think or a huge part of it is what

[08:57:47] we've said all along so we're we're behind the curve and I encourage you all to work on how to accelerate that work. I have two other areas I wanted to ask about. One is a very specific question. I understand that the department has put out a guide to the divisions about the accountability framework, and it says, and I pulled it up before, and I don't have it in front of me, so I apologize, but something in the guide says that CSI schools, meaning the schools that have

[08:58:22] identified for comprehensive support under the federal accountability framework will automatically be treated as needs intensive support schools and I will tell you frankly when we were adopting this these rating systems we all thought that probably most CSI schools would already end up on the in the needs intensive support category but I am told that that is not the case that there are schools out there who are looking at their data and understand that they may well be rated on track

[08:58:54] or even distinguished uh under the new rating system but be meet the definition of csi because of a particular subgroup or or or groups um i don't think our regulations or our state plan made any provision for they did make provision for the tsi schools automatically being downgraded one level but there was no provision for csi schools automatically going to the bottom rating was there did i miss something and why does the guide say that if not right so the guidance was

[08:59:30] put out as a version one for to inform the school divisions it's filled with business rules around how the system works many many things from the board presentations so to help them understand the calculations and so it was put as a cohesive document that was again a version one to prepare them for what i just shared that what will come before the board this summer it will be embedded in the guidance document for the stands of accreditation and the board will have to take action on that so yes divisions have seen that but it's not finalized it's something the board will discuss um and then based on the board's review and approval then it would be adopted but the board absolutely could say no to that but so is that virgin one inaccurate i mean because

[09:00:09] what a school's rating is isn't determined by the guide it's determined by the regulations that we have adopted and unless those regulations are amended we the board can't even change that it's in the regs so is it inaccurate as to that and is that something you all are going to fix in version two you're talking about the guidance the current like technical document the particular language in the document that says a csi school will automatically be bumped down to needs intensive

[09:00:44] support status that is in my understanding inaccurate in in conflict with the regulations that this board has adopted i i as i see it so my question to you and i think the superintendent told me you were the right person to ask this question of is that is that guide inaccurate in making that statement and if so what are we going to do to fix it so there's good there's two guides so there's the one the public's seen now the divisions have seen the guidance we'll call it technical document to be clear there's a separate guidance

document for the stands of accreditation that the board will see and review and approve and that language you're

[09:01:21] discussing would be in there as far as what the board adopts you know i i can't you know speak to that so i i hear your question and it'll come down to the board's conversation like you're having right now to decide is that an appropriate interpretation of the regulations the the intent of the the the conversation we're having here is on the federal side a csi school comprehensive support and improvement is the most intensive designation on our state side needs intensive support is the most intensive designation and so we built a cohesive aligned system we do have schools that based on their student groups may not fit in the needs intensive support their

[09:01:58] achievement gap is so significant that after three years that the federal law requires them to move to csi status currently in virginia we have schools we gave them an additional two years so it's actually five years that student achievement gap has been so significant so the intention of this business rule is to say the public needs to be aware that you've got a student group or more that is struggling so much that this school is on track or distinguished uh it's again a misalignment say that federally their csi which is recognized under federal law but on the state side maybe they're on track or whatever the data may be now to be clear we're not going to change

[09:02:36] their score the score will reflect what they have but the performance category would change and the purpose of that is to align supports so that supports from the federal side and the state side would be aligned and they can get as much support as they can from the department to help them but if you have a csi school that is again on the federal side the most severe but on the state side they're let's say on track your supports are misaligned and i would argue that the public too might be a little misinformed to understand that you have maybe a high performing school but that student group is getting overlooked and like i said that's why federal law requires after three

[09:03:11] years of interventions if they have not improved then it triggers the csi and we report that to us or of course you can be comprehensive service right right at the without wait for three years if you if just depending on the criteria but my point is not what's best for those schools and And that's an important question.

[09:03:30] But the question is, what do our regulations state? And our regulations do not make any provision for CSI schools being labeled needs intensive support. And I hear you that there's, you know, support means help, but it also means it has consequences.

[09:03:47] And so if a school meets the definition for on track or distinguished according to our regulations, how does the department justify redefining that school as as a needs intensive support school you don't have any legal basis for what you're doing in the guide right and so i would say then when we bring that to the board i think that's the conversation to have and then i would ask our department you know board regulation team to weigh in on that and maybe even others i see um

[09:04:25] you're you're not the right one to ask this question of it's the lawyers in other words okay well i'll be gone by then but i would encourage the board to look at this because our regulations are the guide that the department has put out to the divisions is in direct conflict with our regulations i submit and so i'll leave that to you all to parse out later in the summer my last question has to do with the discussion we had this morning about the standard setting and as you heard we are going to see either double or triple the percent of the number of students

[09:04:59] failing our sols obviously our accountability system depends on student pass rates on the sols now obviously the mastery index gives some credit for students at different levels but i think it's safe to say and we've asked for modeling that we don't have yet and so i continue my request that we have modeling about what the impact of that reorienting towards nape proficiency would do to our accountability framework. But I'll ask here today, assuming that we have a vastly higher number of students failing their SOLs because of the change in the grading scale,

[09:05:38] what will that do to the number of rules rated off-track or needs intensive support? And what is the department doing to plan for that impact? Excellent question. So I would say that when we consulted with the Center for Assessment around doing modeling, they were very clear with us in their guidance that you want the assessment process to play out independently. You don't want to get ahead of your standard setting group and say, hey, based on the decisions you're going to make, here's how it impacts the accountability system. And so you want them to run independently.

[09:06:12] After those groups have met and they've decided the reasonable ranges and the proficiency levels, then it would be appropriate for us to come back and say, now based on that committee's work outside of us we can then provide for you projections of the modeling then also the board has the flexibility to say now we look at the whole picture and then the board does have under the regulations and under even our state plan can say we want to change the percentages we can change the weights so again the board was very clear about you know where the mastery thresholds were growth etc but the board can take into consideration where the standard setting is where the proficiency cuts are and then decide if they even want to adjust the weights which would impact the overall

[09:06:51] score as well we do intend and we will do modeling but like i said our guidance has been from the experts both the center for assessment and then also from our technical advisory committee for virginia made up of other experts is that you don't want to get ahead of that because we don't want to go into those committees and say hey we've already figured out these are the scores you want to do to sort of manufacture the results and so that's why we've not done any modeling to that sort um and i think personally it's good guidance but we will after the committees have met be able to provide that to the board and say now based on this here's what it would do and then the board can decide on the cut scores and then like i said the board could say these are the cut scores now

[09:07:28] let's maybe revisit some of the weights and the timing of this is good because again we're going to have amendment 9 opened and there provides us some flexibility that we could make those changes under amendment 9 and our our goal here is this when the school year starts for this fall schools will be very clear on what the targets are what's expected of them and they can start a school year year without sort of what's it going to be and so that's why we're trying to package things and have these conversations over the summer but we want clarity and transparency to start the school year and say this is what the framework is this is the feedback you provided let's start the school year off as clear as we can with your targets so i hear you that the right timing is not yet but the right

[09:08:07] timing is very soon because if the board is going to have the option to make is going to exercise an option to make any adjustments it would need to be before that amendment 9 goes in in august and september absolutely and so as soon as i mean the cut scores are available we had already planned to take those and tell school divisions this would be the result for you and so again we can take that data even before you know the board has taken action and provide modeling for them but then once they're finalized we want to tell divisions this is what would have been your result so they have this upcoming school year

to plan but that's why i want to package for you between june july august September really is meant to be final review. Any changes that we're proposing so that a school can

[09:08:47] start and say, it's closed. The technical guides are closed. Everything's closed. This is what it is. And we can have a 25-26 school year that's successful. And everybody knows this is the target. And my final question is actually to the superintendent and the president instead of you.

[09:09:03] As to the prior question, Superintendent Gullickson, you and I had discussed the CSI. I thought we were going to be able to hear an answer today. And obviously that's not fair to ask the non-lawyer to address it, but can we ask that our lawyers address that question with us, and if not this meeting, then at the June meeting, can we ask that they be directed to look at the CSI status question? Can we, is the guide in conflict with the regulations? That's my question. I'm sorry, was that a yes? Yes. Thank you. Mark, the CSI situation that she's

[09:09:42] talking about, how many schools do you think that would impact? Four. I'm sorry, four schools? Four schools. There are four schools currently that are on track that are CSI based on their current designation and based on the 23-24 partial modeling. I can't predict for this year's data, but there are four schools that were on track based on that data. Mr. Rotherham? Thank you, and thank you for that. Just a couple of quick observations on this. I think just to frame it, one i do think this is the way to do it with integrity i agree with with what you said mark and i will say you you know those of us who worked around the country in different places

[09:10:20] there's often either subtle or explicit pressure to massage the numbers make them look a certain way like perhaps the governor wants to tell a story on the way out of office that like everything's great and so you can manufacture and you kind of massage the curve and those conversations and signals happen in different ways we haven't had any of that and i think like you know i think it's important to acknowledge that we're that we're taking a step forward here as a commonwealth and doing this we're trying to do it the right way and that's going to get lost in the noise and and all that but i think we have to um i think i think we should acknowledge that it is it is unusual uh noteworthy and it's important for virginia's kids that we're not being pressured

[09:10:57] to like tell a good story we're going to figure out what's going on and then we're going to adjust and go forward so i do want to explicitly uh explicitly name that um second again just because we seem to have to keep going through this we live in a commonwealth where in eighth grade 14 of black students are proficient in math 18 of hispanic students 14 of low-income students okay all those numbers i don't need to tell you all are under 20 less than one in five and they don't all go to the same school right they're around the commonwealth and so any kind of

[09:11:35] meaningful accountability system here is going to pick up a lot of schools that has been the problem we went through the pandemic and you know we have the largest drops of anywhere in the country and yet our accreditation numbers which at that point were our accountability system barely move right that's the reason i came back on this board the governor asked me to do it and the reason i said i would be willing to do it is because he recognized that's a system that is simply not working and we need to fix it um and so we can go around around on this again again but when you look at those kinds of numbers and i can also go through the percentages that are below basic

[09:12:12] we can we can just keep doing this to make sure people understand like any meaningful system is going to identify a lot of kids that's just the math there are a lot of schools and these kids all don't go to

the same ones they're spread out we have a lot of room to do better and that's why my third I really hope at some point we will pivot to the support framework and like talking about what are we actually going to do and I'm very excited to hear we're not going to get to it today when we get to it to hear from Superintendent Gullickson on what we're doing to start to revamp these functions and I would like to think that we can have a conversation there are a lot of

[09:12:49] different views around the commonwealth on the best way to improve schools and so forth we can have a robust conversation about that because that's fundamentally what this is about not constantly arguing and pushing on measures and all of this it's once we get it right it's then what does it actually mean and what are we going to do and it we spend an inordinate amount of time on that first piece and not a lot of time on the second which is what's going to really matter here and it is important so thank you madam president i just wanted to offer that content president I found it extremely interesting, too, that we would factor in all of that as you're doing

[09:13:27] the modeling because we had the data showing that the Black students were recovering from the pandemic faster than a lot of other students. So we recognize that it is not the problems that we're having while we see significant again, issues in certain ethnic groups, financial distressed neighborhoods, that at the same time, all of that's happening, they still have an ability to recover faster than some other students.

[09:14:01] So the drill down, as much drill down as possible, is going to be important to us to try to figure out what are those factors that are causing us to have so many schools that are going to be in need of intensive support. because obviously there are some things that we apparently I think aren't looking at in a more global perspective because it's running both ways and it is important that we be able to tell the public which we often get criticized for is that we don't put enough resources in the right places

[09:14:37] are we actually putting the resources in the right places and what are the trends that we're seeing so those are the things that i think we're going to really have to look at to give us a better view as opposed to just the testing data excellent point and i'll respond and say with this we have requirements under federal ESSA every student succeeds act to provide reports around student groups with the framework one of the reports that the public will be able to see is that student group holistically so you would be able to see a student group are five racial ethnic groups economic disadvantage students with disabilities english learners if that student group made up the whole school. How would they do? What is their framework? And I say that because it's not just

[09:15:16] academics. That would include their absenteeism, that could include advanced coursework, 3E, all these other indicators that we have. And so you get to see a more holistic picture and say, if that student group by itself, how is it doing? And you'll see it in comparison to the other student groups. I'll say in response to the previous comments too about our former system, I remember working with some divisions. In the old system we had, and I won't name certain schools, but we had schools that were CSI, the bottom 5% of the state. And yet on our state accreditation system, on our school quality profile, they were solid green. And I remember meeting with some superintendents and explaining, you're in the bottom 5% here, and the federal is just being

[09:15:53] ignored. But there are requirements under federal that they had to do. And there were letters they had to send to the public. And the superintendent and I were talking, the division superintendent,

and he's trying to explain that to the parents. I'm going, your school is in the bottom 5%, chronically underperforming the whole school. But he's going, but on the state side, I'm fine.

[09:16:10] because on the state side they had masked certain things and so I share that just again this system being aligned and being cohesive our goal is that there's that transparency that clarity because the parents were very happy with that school meanwhile you know the real data was showing that the students were chronically underperforming and so that's why some of the rules we mentioned earlier is our goal here is to be clear with everyone about how we're doing and then I love I love the comments what supports are available and so this is where you are we know where you want to be, let's help you get you there. And the resource hub and Superintendent Gullickson will share aligning our resources as a department to really maximize. We have decades

[09:16:47] of research. I heard earlier the comments on science of reading. We have decades of research, evidence-based interventions. We know what works. We just need to put those things in place. And if it's not working, make adaptations. Dr. Northern. Just two quick things. The DQC, which I'm sure secretary guidera is aware of has been evaluating state report cards for their usability transparency and the data that they should be including for seven or eight years now so we do have some um

[09:17:23] benchmarks by which state report cards have been evaluated and the other thing i would encourage us to do is to involve learning heroes because they've done lots i know we've worked with them before and we know they've done lots of focus groups with parents to ask them like what what features do you want in a report card that's going to tell you the information that you want to see so okay um we are at 6 15 and we have a second presentation by mark do you want us does everybody

[09:17:54] want to just kick it till tomorrow what do we want to do i want okay can we can we move your second half it's me is that okay all right good okay so that being said tomorrow we're doing the second half which includes the three e the legislative update seat time and then a superintendent's

[09:18:33] update that we're punting no okay uh so i will entertain a motion to adjourn for the afternoon is there a second second okay

